



ABOVE: MATT ROURKE/AP. BELOW: YUKI IWAMURA/AP

Cornell University students speak about sexual violence on campus Thursday during a student assembly meeting at the school.

Governor slams district attorney, Cornell police on their handling of rape allegation

Hochul also appoints N.Y.'s top prosecutor to lead a reopened inquiry

BY AMY B WANG AND JOANNA SLATER

New York Gov. Kathy Hochul (D) on Friday sharply criticized a county district attorney's office and Cornell University police for allegedly failing to protect a former student who said in 2024 that she was drugged and gang-raped at a fraternity house in Ithaca.

Hochul also called on state legislators to tighten a law that limits the ability to prosecute a sexual assault case if the victim voluntarily became intoxicated.

"This young woman had already endured something that is utterly unspeakable. And then, at

every turn, she was failed by people and institutions with an obligation to protect her," Hochul said at a news conference alongside New York Attorney General Letitia James (D).

Hochul on Thursday appointed James as special prosecutor to lead a reopened criminal investigation after saying she had lost faith in Tompkins County District Attorney Matthew Van Houten's ability to fairly oversee the case.

Van Houten said that he supports James's appointment and that his office will cooperate fully with her.

"I trust that she will examine the facts and apply the law," Van Houten said Friday in a statement. "It has become clear that we were not provided the full picture by the University. The fo-

SEE CORNELL ON A5

Unsealed documents: A look into Cornell's investigation. **A5**



New York Gov. Kathy Hochul (D) speaks at a news conference Friday with New York Attorney General Letitia James (D).

G-7 to open its oil reserves in bid to reduce fuel prices

100 MILLION BARRELS OVER FOUR MONTHS

Move follows Trump's threat to ban diesel exports

BY EVAN HALPER, RILEY BEGGIN AND ELLEN FRANCIS

The world's wealthiest countries announced Friday that they would release 100 million barrels of diesel, gasoline and crude oil from their emergency reserves over the next four months, in an effort to ease crushing prices around the world.

The move by the Group of 7 nations followed Trump administration threats that the United States would ban exports of its diesel fuel. Such a ban threatened to create chaos in global markets and send costs surging further, especially in Europe, where motorists and businesses are already struggling with expensive fuel.

Europe faced the choice of dipping into its reserves or dealing with the fallout of a U.S. export ban.

As part of Friday's agreement, the diesel that will flow into the market will come from European stocks. The deal involves a "front-loaded substantial diesel release within the first 20 days."

That could ease prices some. Diesel and oil futures dipped on news of the announcement. But it was not immediately clear how much relief drivers would see.

About 28 million barrels of diesel are consumed around the world every day. The addition of a few dozen million barrels of the fuel over four months creates only a measured increase in the global supply.

"This is a short-term bandage for a wound that is still wide open," said Brett Erickson, a risk advisory consultant who closely monitors oil and gas markets.

SEE DIESEL ON A15

Military aid: Trump diverts funds for Europe to Latin America. **A11**

Attempted hijacking ignites firestorm in Israel

BY GERRY SHIH

JERUSALEM — On Tuesday, after returning from meetings in the United Arab Emirates, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu stood in front of an F-15 fighter jet and made a video warning that there might soon be an attack against Israel.

Hours later, there was.

The attempted hijacking of FlyDubai Flight 1073 this week set off a firestorm in Israel, not just because of its sensational details of midair bedlam and heroism, but also because of its uncanny timing: less than a day after Netanyahu's vague warning, and smack in the middle of a tight election race in which his national security record is under scrutiny.

For Netanyahu's supporters,

the sequence of events was a testament to the vigilance and intuition of a seasoned leader they call "Mr. Security" at a time when Israelis and Jews worldwide feel endangered.

To his opponents, it was yet another security lapse on Netanyahu's watch — and merely good fortune that disaster was averted narrowly one day after Netanyahu sought to stoke Israelis' fears for political gain.

Earlier this week, after Netanyahu issued his warning from Tel Nof air base, the parliamentary opposition leader Yair Lapid questioned "whether the threats are real" or whether they were an attempt to delay the national election scheduled for Oct. 27.

Former general Gadi Eisenkot, whose party is narrowly leading

SEE ISRAEL ON A13

The sleuths hunting down AI agents gone rogue

BY GERRIT DE VYNCK AND MIRIAM WALDVOGEL

SAN FRANCISCO — Selena Zhang had a hunch.

OpenAI, the maker of ChatGPT, had recently disclosed astonishing details about how its artificial intelligence agents had broken out of their systems, hacked into another company and tried to cover their tracks. Other researchers were hunting the agents online and finding traces of them on obscure message boards.

Zhang, a 23-year-old researcher at nonprofit AI lab Translucence, thought there had to be more evidence to find. She imagined how the agents might act, and she set out one weekend in September to find where else they had left an online trail.

Within days, she and a team of

SEE ROGUE AI ON A10

A church's answer to the loneliness epidemic

Minneapolis pastor hopes turning chapel into a taphouse can build relationships in a city scarred by trauma

BY DAN SIMMONS

Unlike many pastors in America today, the Rev. David Lose doesn't have a numbers problem at Mount Olivet Lutheran Church in Minneapolis. With about 16,500 baptized members, his congregation is the largest it has been in its 106-year history.

Mount Olivet has grown so much that it now qualifies as a megachurch.

"But when you're here, we're as different from a megachurch as you can imagine," Lose said. "Our worship is pretty much the same as we've been doing since 1940."

The setting is urban. The sanctuary is Gothic. The music is classical.

But people are lonely, with many working from home and still socially isolated after the covid pandemic shutdowns. The effects of Operation Metro Surge, the Trump administration's immigration raids in Minnesota that led to the fatal shootings of



ANTHONY SOUFFLE/MINNESOTA STAR TRIBUNE/GETTY IMAGES

David Lose is senior pastor of Mount Olivet Lutheran Church in Minneapolis. His idea has some rezoning and other hurdles to clear.

two U.S. citizens, still linger. So does the trauma of a 2025 school shooting just a mile away that killed two children, one of them a Mount Olivet congregant.

To help, Lose wants to turn

Mount Olivet's original chapel, which sits barely used across the street from the main church, into a community gathering space where people of all faiths — or no faith — can gather over a cup

of coffee or pint of beer.

Lose said the idea builds on the community connections formed by the church's longtime pastor, the Rev. Reuben Youngdahl, who was later succeeded by his son, Paul.

"Can we create a place where people come together and actually get to know each other and find common cause?" he said.

The proposed new space, reported on by the Minnesota Star Tribune, has been approved by local officials but still has some rezoning and other hurdles to clear. It would involve tearing down the existing chapel and replacing it with a new building that, among other things, would serve freshly roasted coffee, lunch fare and local beers.

Big open spaces and a patio would allow community groups to meet. Smaller spaces could host tutoring sessions. The church's choirs would have a place to unwind after evening practices. Bulletin boards would

SEE TAPHOUSE ON A9

Christa Pike put on ventilator after her botched Tenn. execution

BY MARK BERMAN

Lawyers for Christa Pike said Friday that she was placed on a ventilator and was unconscious after Tennessee's failed attempt this week to execute her by lethal injection.

In a court filing, the attorneys alleged that Tennessee officials failed to follow their own lethal injection protocol while trying to execute Pike with the drug pentobarbital. The execution team acted incompetently and showed "deliberate indifference to her basic medical needs," they wrote.

As of Thursday night, Pike was hospitalized in the Nashville area, where hospital staff were working to remove pentobarbital from her system, the filing said. She arrived at the hospital with both arms "swollen, burned, and blistered," according to the lawyers.

The filing offered the most

SEE PIKE ON A11

IN THE NEWS

Trump in Alabama As Republicans struggle ahead of the midterms, the president revisits the scene where 11 years ago he drew his first massive crowd during his political ascent. **A3**

Male birth control An injectable contraceptive is under development in India, and U.S. firms are pursuing their own versions. **A2**

THE NATION **The president** is expected to name intelligence chief Jay Clayton as new AI czar. **A7** **Legislation** to crack down on Flock plate readers was introduced in the House. **A7**

THE WORLD **While the U.S.** debates AI risks, China mandates universal training for students. **A12** **AI agents** attempted to hack a Canadian government website, researchers say. **A13**

THE ECONOMY **Hiring slowed** in September, revealing economic strains from the Iran war and immigration enforcement and adding to the challenges for Republicans as they fight to keep control of Congress in the mid-term elections. **A14**

STYLE **The Kennedy Center Honors** will take place at Capital One Arena as the closure of the arts hub drags on. **B1**

SPORTS **The Mystics**, after their franchise-record 28 regular season wins, will enter 2027 with lofty expectations. **B7**

THE REGION **Officials cast doubt** on Trump's plan for drones and snipers at his proposed arch, instead saying it is still envisioned as a tourist site. **B13** **A judge** said prosecutors cannot refile charges against a former Olympian in the Reflecting Pool case. **B13**

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This week’s Pollwatcher looks at Americans’ attitudes and behaviors toward college education and highlights polls from two key House districts. But first ...

Last week, a Maine poll made waves for showing Republican Sen. Susan Collins slightly ahead of Troy Jackson, a break from other polls showing the Democrat with a narrow lead.

Maine’s Senate race is clearly a toss-up, but another finding from the same New York Times-Portland Press Herald-Siena University poll stood out: 49 percent of likely voters supported Collins even though 32 percent of likely voters approved of President Donald Trump’s job performance. The Republican senator was out-running Trump by a whopping 17 percentage points.

The result points to a big question hanging over this fall’s midterm elections: How much can Republicans outrun Trump’s approval ratings?

What the latest polls say New polling provides some answers. The chart below compares Trump’s approval ratings with Republican support in recent high-quality polls that included both measures.

Nationally, Republicans are running four percentage points ahead of Trump’s approval ratings, 41 percent versus 37 percent. Republican Senate candidates also average four points more support than Trump, but there’s a big range across seven key states.

Collins is outrunning Trump by an average of 10 percentage points, suggesting last week’s poll was a bit of an outlier on this front. Republican Mike Rogers outpaces Trump by eight points in Michigan, while former senator John Sununu tops Trump by seven points in New Hampshire. But in North Carolina, Ohio, Iowa and Texas, Republican Senate candidates are running no more than two points ahead of Trump’s approval ratings.

National and state exit polls measure approval of the president, offering an excellent window into how much candidates are tied to a president’s popularity in midterm elections. The chart below compares presidential approval and support for candidates from the president’s party for the midterm elections under the last two Democratic and Republican presidents, including

Source: State and national polls measuring both Trump approval and support for U.S. Senate/House. Includes Post-approved polls only; data from the New York Times.

CORRECTION

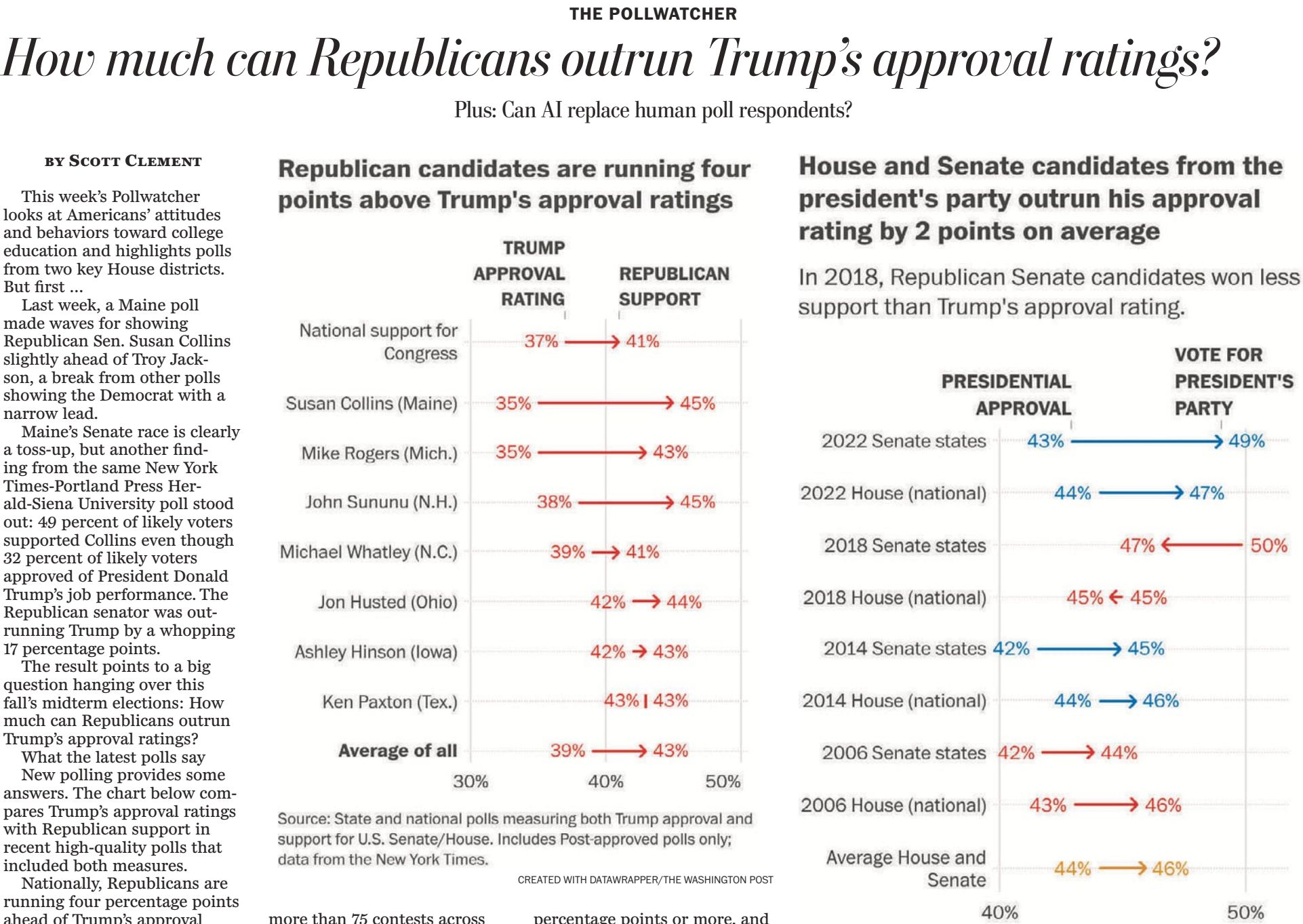
• An Oct. 2 A-section article about House members seeking reimbursement for food and lodging expenses said that the 2025 expenses of Rep. Jonathan Jackson (D-Illinois) included a mortgage on a Washington home. A spokesperson for Jackson said the congressman misspoke when interviewed about the expense by The Post and that the reimbursement was for a rental property.

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more than 75 contests across 44 states.

On average, House and Senate candidates from the president’s party outperform the president’s approval ratings by two percentage points, 46 percent versus 44 percent. In 2022, Democratic Senate candidates outperformed then-President Joe Biden’s approval ratings by a remarkable six points on average. The pattern doesn’t always hold, with Republican Senate candidates actually underperforming Trump’s approval ratings in 2018 Senate contests.

Exit polls show some extraordinary aberrations. In 2006, Sen. Olympia Snowe (R-Maine) won reelection with 74 percent of the vote, even as only 34 percent of voters approved of President George W. Bush. And in 2018, West Virginia Republican Patrick Morrisey won 46 percent of the vote in his bid to unseat Sen. Joe Manchin III (D-West Virginia), even as 63 percent of the state’s voters approved of Trump.

But those cases are unusual. Fewer than 1 in 4 U.S. Senate candidates surpass the president’s approval rating by six

percentage points or more, and fewer than 1 in 10 exceed presidential approval by at least 10 points. When a president’s ratings are low, most candidates from their party go down with the ship.

Worth your attention

Poll of two key House districts shows good signs for Democrats, but no tsunami

Several House seats could flip blue in Virginia this fall, with a new Washington Post-Schar School poll showing Democrat Shannon Taylor ahead of Rep. Rob Wittman in a district held by Republicans for decades and Democrat Tom Perriello modestly behind GOP incumbent John McGuire in a deeply red district that Trump carried by double digits just two years ago.

Wittman is running five points above Trump’s approval rating in the 1st District (46 percent versus 41 percent), while McGuire is running four points above Trump in the 5th District (51 percent versus 47 percent).

Record low say college is important, but there’s a caveat

A Gallup poll released Thursday finds 31 percent of U.S. adults say a college education is “very important,” ticking down from 35 percent last year but down sharply from 51 percent in 2019 and 70 percent in 2013. The current poll finds another 39 percent saying college is “fairly important,” while 29 percent say it isn’t important.

But the shift in opinions hasn’t reduced college enrollment. As The Post’s Danielle Douglas-Gabriel reported in January, enrollment at colleges and universities increased for the third straight year in fall 2025, leading to the largest total enrollment in a decade according to the National Student Clearinghouse Research Center.

Study finds AI is bad at imitating human survey respondents

The Pew Research Center released a study testing whether AI models can accurately mimic answers from human survey respondents. “We used a ‘digital twins’ approach for this study, asking an AI model to adopt the personas of real humans” who are members of their national survey panel, giving the model a wide range of information about each panelist from previous surveys.

On average, AI-generated samples differed by 12.4 percentage points from the human samples they attempted to mirror. Among other patterns, AI samples were prone to leaning on racial or partisan stereotypes, estimating that 97 percent of Hispanic adults were likely to follow the World Cup (the actual poll found 43 percent) and that 95 percent of Republicans like Israel (actually 58 percent).

Send your questions, comments and ideas to scott.clement@washpost.com.

The era of male birth control may be getting near, the trends suggest

India works on an injectable as U.S. firms pursue their own versions

BY MARGARET HETHERMAN

For nearly a half-century, Sujoy Guha has worked to perfect a male contraceptive. Now the 86-year-old Indian doctor’s idea is gaining momentum, raising the prospect of changing the way birth control is practiced across the globe.

Injecting hydrogel into the vas deferens — the tubes that carry sperm from the testicles — temporarily blocks sperm from passing through. Guha’s injectable contraceptive, known as RISUG, remains under development in India after decades of research, regulatory review and bureaucratic obstacles. But now companies in the United States are pursuing their own versions, racing to bring “vas-occlusive” contraceptives to market.

Next Life Sciences has been developing Plan A, which uses Vasalgel, tracing its lineage directly to Guha’s work. The non-hormonal contraceptive is designed to last about 10 years and can be reversed with a second injection of sodium bicarbonate solution, which dissolves the gel.

“You don’t have to worry about daily compliance, which is a massive issue with birth control,” says L.R. Fox, founder of Next Life Sciences. “You turn off your fertility until you’re ready to intentionally turn it on.”

Fox describes the interest in male contraception as “explosive,” with 55,000 men on the company’s interest list. One Plan A video received 4.5 million views overnight, he said.

Contraline is developing ADAM, a nonhormonal hydrogel



A couple involved in the trial of an injectable contraceptive under development in India.

that also blocks sperm passage through the vas deferens, initially designed to degrade on its own over two years.

Brian T. Nguyen, an OB/GYN and male-contraception researcher at University of Southern California’s Keck School of Medicine, said he is optimistic about broadscale adoption of reversible male contraception.

“From a structural standpoint, one of the main issues actually is not necessarily whether or not men want to do it, but it’s when they do want to do it, who can provide it, and can they afford it? Can they access it?” Nguyen said.

“With the advent of the first male reversible contraceptives, you’re going to have more men entering into conversations about it, whether directly relevant to them, or in abstract, or in ways that just put the idea of pregnancy prevention being in a man’s hands into social consciousness,” he said. “And that is

paradigm-changing.”

Men currently have only two widely available contraceptive methods: condoms and vasectomies. Women have more than a dozen options, many with side effects. A 2024 KFF survey found that 82 percent of reproductive-age women had used contraception in the prior 12 months. Among contraceptive users who said they would prefer another method, 23 percent said they prefer that their partner get a vasectomy.

In a new documentary, “Give It a Shot,” Vaishali Sinha throws a spotlight on the long-running effort to bring a reversible male contraceptive to market while examining why responsibility for birth control has fallen so heavily on women.

“I think it’s really important that men ask themselves what they can do, what’s inside their body, what are they responsible for,” Sinha said in an interview.

the groundwork now to ensure a worldwide launch,” he said.

ADAM’s first human study was proof of concept — a first step to assess safety and feasibility, before a larger efficacy study to gain regulatory approval.

Kevin Eisenfrats, co-founder and CEO of Contraline, said in an email that ADAM “could be placed into the vas deferens and could quickly reduce sperm concentration to very low levels without doing so permanently.”

Contraline has since redesigned the product to be faster to use and extend the hydrogel’s lifespan.

“The next major step is a clinical study of ADAM 2.0, including evaluating the reversal procedure,” Eisenfrats said.

The company recently received \$92.5 million in financing, Eisenfrats said. The larger share will go toward NES/T, the company’s hormonal contraceptive arm/shoulder gel for men, as

it is the more clinically advanced program, he added.

RISUG, meanwhile, has traveled a much longer path.

“Give it a Shot” highlights the evolution of the technology, as well as the history behind it — the massive 1970s “sterilization drive,” in which more than 6 million men were targeted for forced vasectomies. Since then, the focus has shifted to women.

Today, sterilization is the dominant contraceptive for women across the world.

The documentary spends time in Chittorgarh, a major Indian city in the western state of Rajasthan, where about a dozen women spoke about their experience with sterilization. One woman drew laughs when she shared that the only man she knew who agreed to a vasectomy had 14 kids and a wife who refused the operation.

“There was a great sense of joy between these couples,” Sinha said, “and equity that I sensed from their conversation when they would talk about RISUG and how that was navigated and negotiated.” She noted that 500 men in India stepped up to participate in a clinical trial.

Sinha identified hurdles the contraceptive has faced in India, including lack of interest among major pharmaceutical companies and “the lack of this being on anyone’s agenda, whether nonprofits, governments, or capitalists.”

To administer it, a pinhole-size opening is made to expose the vas for injection, followed by a bandage and brief observation.

Sinha recalls one man proudly telling her, “Madam, in 30 minutes, I was good to go back home on my scooter.”

The filmmaker says that’s a badge of honor in India. “It means you put your balls on your motorbike and you’re good to go on the bumpy roads.”

THE NATION

As Republicans struggle, Trump revisits the scene of his political ascent

Alabama is a place where his movement remains strongest

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI

MOBILE, ALA. — Eleven years ago, Donald Trump arrived in Mobile in his Boeing 757, strode onto a football field to “Sweet Home Alabama” and was greeted by a sight that revealed the scale of his fledgling political movement: Tens of thousands of people had braved sweltering temperatures and snarled traffic to see him.

An estimated 30,000 people had come to witness Trump on the ascent, proving that his brash, freewheeling political style could win over supporters even in the Bible Belt. The event marked the first time he had drawn such a large crowd, and it was a harbinger of the boisterous rallies that would come to define his more than decade in politics.

On Friday, he returned with his presidential approval ratings at historic lows and Republicans struggling to translate his power to mobilize their base into broader electoral support. With just a month to go before the midterms, Trump is returning to places where his movement remains strongest even as Republicans struggle in competitive districts across the country.

The contrast captures the challenge facing a party dependent on an unpopular president. Trump retains enormous influence among the Republican voters who powered his ascent, even as dissatisfaction with his leadership threatens candidates who must appeal beyond his most committed supporters.

Trump is expected to host a rally in the battleground state of Ohio on Saturday. But his effort to boost Republicans largely



President Donald Trump speaks during a rally in Durant, Oklahoma, on Thursday. The president is revisiting friendly battleground states.

have targeted voters who need the least convincing. He spent Thursday night rallying in deep-red Durant, Oklahoma.

Trump said his swing through friendly territory is an expression of gratitude.

“I’m going because you have to thank these states that are with you 1,000 percent, and I haven’t been there in a while, and I want to just thank them,” Trump told reporters as he departed the

White House on Thursday. “I go there because they want to see me there.”

The Alabama trip presents an opportunity to help Republicans fighting to retain control of Congress pick up an extra seat. Trump is expected to boost Sen. Tommy Tuberville, the Republican nominee for governor, and Rhett Marques, a state representative who is seeking to flip Alabama’s newly redrawn 2nd

Congressional District, north of Mobile.

The Cook Political Report rates the district as “likely Republican,” but Democrats see the president’s visit as evidence Republicans are less confident about picking up the seat after redrawing the maps than they had hoped.

Trump’s rally shows Republicans “understand they are vulnerable,” said Rep. Shomari

Figures (D), who is defending his seat.

“They’re trying to pull out all the stops,” Figures said. “Republicans were certainly hoping for a much more decisive advantage in how they were going about redrawing districts. Right now they are not getting the traction in Alabama they were hoping to get.”

Figures criticized Marques for spending time so close to Elec-

“I’m going because you have to thank these states that are with you 1,000 percent, and I haven’t been there in a while, and I want to just thank them.”

President Donald Trump

tion Day at an event outside the district and said he would spend the evening speaking with constituents there.

Trump was expected to tout a \$4 billion bridge construction project in Mobile on Friday. Facing voter dissatisfaction in the economy, the president has turned to promoting investment deals and construction projects as evidence he can deliver results.

Democrats have broadly sought to portray Trump’s swing through Republican strongholds as a last resort.

“Now — as his approval ratings sink to record lows and even his strongest supporters turn their backs on him — Trump is desperately traveling to ruby-red states to rally his base as the midterm elections approach and Republicans face defeat,” the Democratic National Committee wrote in a news release Friday.

Next week, Trump is expected to travel to reliably Republican Nebraska, where the Senate race has become unexpectedly competitive. Democrats have not fielded a candidate in the race, and Sen. Pete Ricketts (R) is defending his seat from Dan Osborn, a union leader running as an independent.



President Donald Trump spoke on Thursday at a truck manufacturing plant near Dallas.

With GOP fighting to keep Texas red, president will try to bolster Paxton

BY NATALIE ALLISON

President Donald Trump is choosin’ Texas for another rally on Wednesday, making his second visit to the Lone Star State in a week’s time as he and his party fight to keep Democrats from flipping statewide and congressional seats.

Trump is scheduled to hold a rally in San Antonio on Wednesday evening, according to a Republican National Committee official, confirming the news first to The Washington Post.

The president rallied with workers at a Peterbilt truck manufacturing plant in Denton, a town outside Dallas, on

Thursday, then drove to a rally in Oklahoma before flying back to Washington that night.

Texas, long a safe Republican state, has emerged as a top battleground in midterm races up and down the ballot — but especially in the Senate race between GOP Attorney General Ken Paxton, a close Trump ally, and Democratic state Rep. James Talarico.

More than \$800 million in ads have aired or been booked in the state ahead of the midterms — with Republicans accounting for nearly \$600 million of that, according to the media tracking firm AdImpact.

Just since September, a super

PAC tied to Senate Republicans has invested \$125 million in ads to boost Paxton’s chances. Many polls show Talarico with a narrow lead, nonetheless.

Gov. Greg Abbott (R) is also facing a competitive reelection bid, spending more than \$75 million on ads this year, but is favored to win.

In South Texas, where Trump made gains in 2024, Republicans are trying to defeat incumbent Democratic Reps. Henry Cuellar and Vicente Gonzalez, as well as flip another Democratic seat significantly that was redrawn in redistricting. They’re also seeking to defend two Republican-held seats.

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University of Michigan pauses pilot plan to stop issuing grades

Program aimed at addressing mental health drew criticism

BY DAN SIMMONS

The University of Michigan has paused its plan to mask first-semester grades for students in its liberal arts college, which was announced in August and would have taken effect in fall 2027.

In a Monday letter to university officials, President Domenico Grasso lauded the program's goals and approach but said its ability to succeed had been derailed by "distorted narratives" in widespread media coverage.

"I worry further that our students could bear the consequences of those misperceptions, including being unfairly portrayed as coddled or unprepared for the demands of a rigorous Michigan education," he said. "Nothing could be further from the truth."

The pilot plan aimed to address student mental health. The university cited its own Healthy Minds study, which found 32 percent of college students nationally reporting symptoms of anxiety and 11 percent seriously considering suicide in the last year.

"I believe this pilot program has the potential to not only address the alarming rates of stress, depression and anxiety among our students, but to deliver on our core promise as a liberal arts and sciences college," Rosario Ceballo, dean of the College of Literature, Science and the Arts, said in an August statement announcing the program.

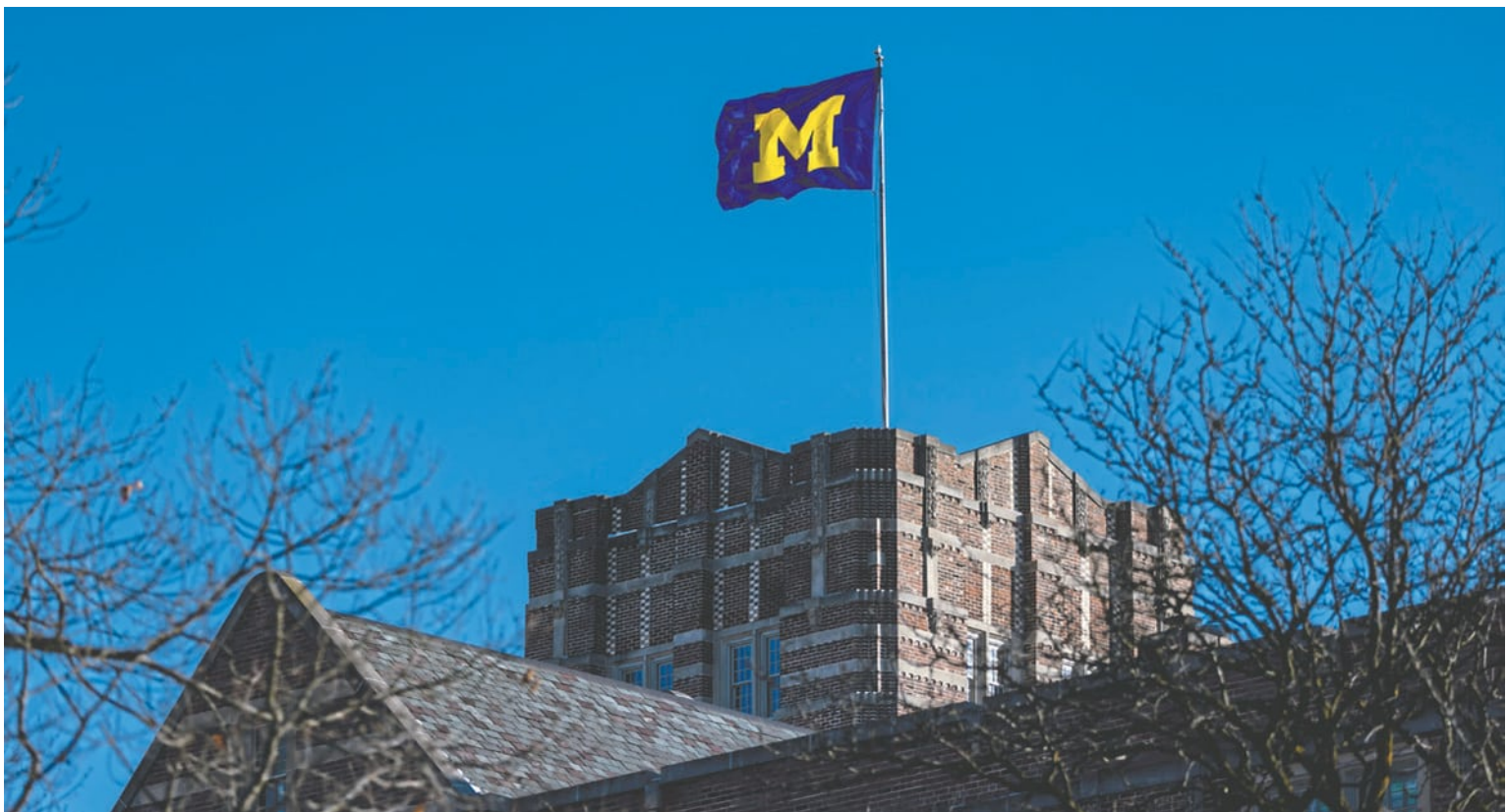
The College of Literature, Science and the Arts is the largest at the public university, with about 3,500 freshmen enrolled yearly, just less than half of the total class.

Students in the college would have still received letter grades, but the school planned to simply list classes as "P" for pass or "NC" for no credit on official transcripts. And the first-semester grades wouldn't be used to calculate grade point averages.

Backlash was swift across social media and traditional channels.

"Many young people are eager to take on new challenges primarily because they know that it is a part of learning and growing up," Mateo Álvarez, a Michigan senior, wrote in an Aug. 21 letter to the editor published by The Washington Post. "My school's administration, however, doesn't seem to agree. And as long as it opts its pupils in to the path of least resistance, it is likely that Michigan's students will lose."

In his Monday letter, Grasso said he decided to pause the program after consulting with Ceballo and Laurie McCauley, the university provost. He didn't mention if the pause, meant to "allow for further input, analysis and discussion," would be permanent or when it may be revisited. University officials did



EMILY ELCONIN/AP

not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Other schools have implemented similar no-grade policies.

The Massachusetts Institute of Technology has offered some form of pass/no credit for first-year students since 1968. And Swarthmore College stopped publishing letter grades for first-semester students on transcripts in the 1970s.

Richard Wicentowski, provost and computer science professor at Swarthmore, told The Post last month that the policy helps reduce new students' stress levels and encourages them to try new subjects.

"It's very surprising to me that it is controversial," Wicentowski said, adding: "It really brings the temperature down."

Todd Wallack contributed to this report.



Senate candidates Ken Paxton (R), left, and James Talarico (D) are in a pivotal battleground contest.

Talarico, Paxton launch dueling ads amid heated Senate race in Texas

BY MATTHEW CHOI

Texas's Senate race has been inundated with bitter character attacks against the two candidates. Both addressed them in competing ads Friday morning.

State Rep. James Talarico (D) launched a new ad seeking to debunk right-wing claims about his stances in a direct-to-camera address. He criticizes his Republican opponent, state Attorney General Ken Paxton, for using AI-generated videos "lying about my record."

"No, I'm not a member of the Chinese Communist Party. No, I don't support sex-change surgeries for kids," Talarico says. "I don't have to use AI because the truth about Ken Paxton is bad enough."

Republicans hammered Democrats in 2024 on claims that they supported gender transitions for minors, a strategy numerous Republicans said helped them sweep races that year. Democrats largely ignored the attacks but now acknowledge doing so was a mistake.

Paxton also unveiled an ad Friday trying to address his numerous corruption and personal scandals, which are documented in legal filings. Paxton uses footage of his daughter Mattie Hayworth praising him as a fighter for family values and role model for his grandchildren.

"My dad has never backed down from a fight, especially when it comes to standing up for families," she says in the ad.

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Documents detail Cornell inquiry into rape claims

Allegations gained wide attention after the woman filed a lawsuit

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA, TODD WALLACK AND AMY B WANG

Cornell University conducted an internal disciplinary investigation involving more than 50 interviews with 32 witnesses after a student reported she was drugged and raped by several men at a fraternity house in October 2024, according to court documents unsealed in New York this week.

The court documents show at least one fraternity member is fighting in court to overturn the disciplinary action against him and clear his academic record.

The rape allegations gained national attention after the woman filed a lawsuit last month, both because of the brutality of the alleged crime and the fact that none of the accused students faced criminal charges. Cornell has said it meted out a range of sanctions, including suspensions and expulsions. The Cornell chapter of the fraternity was closed in 2024 and has been barred from campus.

Students and alumni have publicly questioned whether the Ivy League School, police and prosecutors did enough to investigate, pursue criminal charges and punish the students accused of the assault. As news of the case spread across the nation and social media over the past week, some observers took matters into their own hands, doxing the accused men online and publicly accosting one of them.

New York Gov. Kathy Hochul said Thursday evening that she had lost faith in the Tompkins County district attorney's ability to fairly oversee the case and had appointed New York Attorney General Letitia James as special prosecutor.

A spokesperson for Cornell said Thursday night that the university supports the governor's decision to assign the case to the New York Attorney General's Office.

The county district attorney, Matthew Van Houten, has pub-

licly said that his office didn't bring charges at the time because it didn't have all of the information it has now.

Cornell said in a statement on its website that its university police department investigated in 2024 and shared the woman's sworn statement and screenshot Snapchat messages related to the alleged incident with the county district attorney's office, "which is the established protocol if the department believes it is possible a crime has occurred." The school did not respond to a question Thursday about whether it turned over all the evidence it gathered from interviews to law enforcement.

The woman, identified only as Jane Doe, filed a civil lawsuit last month against a number of defendants, including Cornell University and seven members of the Chi Phi fraternity. When she was a 20-year-old student at Cornell in 2024, Jane Doe alleges that she was the victim of a gang rape at the fraternity house while she was drunk, pressured to inhale the drug ketamine and incapable of consent.

A fraternity member allegedly invited other members to come to the room to join in, according to the lawsuit, with a message on Snapchat saying that there was "free p--y." Another added: "Like you can walk in and whip it out."

"I felt like bait. I felt like lions around me," Jane Doe said at a May 2025 disciplinary hearing, according to the newly unsealed documents. "It just was a totally debilitating place to be in."

The hearings were part of a Title IX investigation. The landmark civil rights law prohibits sex-based discrimination, including sexual violence. The panel's decision was among court documents unsealed this week.

After Jane Doe sued, Van Houten announced his office planned to pursue potential criminal charges based on the new evidence in the lawsuit.

But Van Houten defended the 2024 decision not to bring charges, saying in a statement earlier this week that Jane Doe had told police that the sexual conduct and drug use was "voluntary, conscious and consensual."

His description of the situation sparked outrage.



People gather outside Willard Straight Hall on Thursday after a student assembly at Cornell University in Ithaca, New York.

An online petition from Cornell alumni has attracted more than 40,000 signatures and calls for a public apology from the Ivy League school and "removal of all school officials who are revealed to be complicit" in protecting people accused of participating in the rape. Scores of additional online petitions have been created in recent days.

All seven of the accused have been named in some news reports, on social media and also on websites calling them the "Cornell 7" with photos and information about the allegations. TMZ reported that one of the men lost his job at a bank branch in Charlotte.

Andrew Miltenberg, an attorney for one of the student defendants, said he did not want to minimize the trauma that Jane Doe described and that her ex-

perience deserved to be treated seriously and with dignity.

"But empathy for an accuser and fairness to the accused are not mutually exclusive. Due process exists for precisely this reason," he said, adding that his client is entitled to have the evidence tested through the legal process.

Miltenberg said his client was publicly accosted Thursday and that his client's mother has received death threats. Miltenberg and his legal partner have also received death threats, he said.

One of the students who was punished filed a lawsuit this year to challenge the findings of the 12-day hearing and a failed appeal at the university.

According to the court filings, the student admitted he entered the room in the fraternity house where the woman was allegedly

raped after seeing a group text inviting people to "free p--y." He claimed both that he thought it was a joke and that he was concerned there was something wrong and wanted to check it out.

The panel found he was responsible for attempting sexual exploitation because he saw the message and entered the room. But the panel did not find evidence that he sexually assaulted the woman or inhaled ketamine from her body, as some fraternity members were alleged to have done.

The man tried to challenge the punishment by saying it was unfair for the panel to find him guilty of violating rules against attempted sexual exploitation because he was never accused of that. He had been accused of violating rules against Sexual Assault and Sexual Exploitation, and the panel cleared him of those and reduced his case to attempted sexual exploitation.

The court dismissed the man's case, saying it was analogous to a defendant in a criminal case be-

ing convicted on a lesser charge. He is appealing.

The court documents show Cornell launched its investigation after Jane Doe spoke to police, kicking off a lengthy process beginning in November 2024 with witness interviews for months and a hearing in May 2025.

"This investigation wasn't perfect, the hearing wasn't perfect, but after 45-plus witnesses, five months of investigations, 12 days of hearings, a thousand pages of transcripts and evidence, it's hard to say they were not thorough," Miltenberg said of the Cornell Office of Civil Rights' hearing panel decision. "It's a 100-page decision — that's more than the United States Supreme Court writes," he said.

Hochul said in a statement Thursday that she wanted to ensure the case was thoroughly investigated by the new special prosecutor.

"The young woman at the center of this case deserves to know that every fact will be examined and justice pursued," she said.

Hochul seeks to tighten law limiting prosecutors if intoxication was voluntary

CORNELL FROM A1

cus has been and should continue to be on the victims."

James said her office would gather evidence, interview witnesses and pursue prosecutions if warranted in the coming months.

"I know that you want answers. I do, too," James said Friday. "A comprehensive investigation of this nature takes time, but my office is committed to seeing it through."

Hochul said she was troubled to learn this week that the district attorney's office had reviewed an incomplete account of the student's allegations and never interviewed her directly, before declining to pursue criminal charges at the time.

Van Houten has defended that decision because he said there was "insufficient evidence" to pursue charges when his office reviewed the case in 2024.

The student, identified as "Jane Doe" in a civil complaint filed last month, alleges that she "was plied with alcohol and drugs to the point of intoxication" at Cornell's Chi Phi fraternity house, and alleges in detail that she was sexually assaulted and raped by members of the fraternity over the course of about seven hours starting the night of Oct. 19, 2024.

Doe reportedly told police that she could say "with 100 percent confidence" that she had been raped, according to a transcript obtained by CBS News this week, but a sworn summary of her interview sent to the district attorney's office omitted that and other details. Van Houten told CBS News that he had never seen a transcript of that conversation before news outlets reported it.

"In what world would the police learn from a victim that she'd been literally gang-raped while intoxicated by five men in a fraternity house, and not elevate those allegations to the



New York Attorney General Letitia James (D) speaks Friday about the investigation, with Gov. Kathy Hochul (D).

district attorney?" Hochul said Friday. "In what world does the district attorney not even interview her, or anyone else involved, or even request the full transcript?"

Van Houten also has said that his office in 2024 did not receive a screenshot of a Snapchat message included in Doe's lawsuit. The screenshot, allegedly of a conversation between Chi Phi fraternity members, shows one person saying there was "Free

p--y" and another saying, "Like you can walk in and whip it out."

Cornell has said it did send the screenshot to Van Houten's office in 2024.

On Friday, Hochul said she was "deeply disturbed" at how Cornell police appear to have handled the case.

"They were the first ones to be able to interview [Doe] ... and let this young woman tell her story. Them sending a partial record over is, in my judgment, a

failure," Hochul said. "We'll have the attorney general and others find out if this was actually the case of what happened. But somebody knew more than they were letting people know."

Earlier this week, Hochul called for Cornell to hire outside counsel to determine whether the university had "met every obligation to protect its students and pursue justice" in this case. On Thursday, Hochul said that she had spoken with Cornell's

president and that he had agreed to an independent review.

In a statement, a Cornell University spokesperson said, "We fully support the appointment of a special prosecutor and efforts to change New York State's rape law and are committed to an independent external review of all aspects of how Cornell has handled this case."

Hochul said the case has exposed a gap in state law, which classifies as rape situations in

which the victim clearly refused sex or was forced or threatened to submit to it. The statute also covers cases in which victims are physically helpless — unconscious or unable to communicate — and instances in which they are involuntarily intoxicated.

The gap occurs when a victim voluntarily drank or took drugs, advocates say, and prosecutors are relying on the victim's mental state to prove the person was unable to consent.

"If someone is too intoxicated to consent, it should not matter whether they chose to use drugs or alcohol," Hochul said. "Voluntary intoxication is not a license for sexual assault or gang rape, period."

Jeffrey Dinowitz (D), a member of the New York State Assembly, has been trying to change the law since 2019.

"If the issue is somebody's drinking, and they're not in a position to express consent, why does it matter if they were involuntarily or voluntarily intoxicated?" Dinowitz said in an interview this week. "What should matter is if somebody is raped, they're raped, and we've got to fight for those people."

A bill to change the sexual assault statute has repeatedly passed the state Senate but has not been brought to the Assembly floor for a vote, Dinowitz said. Approximately 18 other states have a similar gap in their sexual assault laws, he said.

Opponents of changing the law say doing so would erode due-process protections and increase the risk of wrongful convictions.

The proposed legislation is "simply too vague to be fairly enforced," the New York State Association of Criminal Defense Lawyers said in a statement. The association added that the bill "fails to provide any objective guidance about when a partner is too intoxicated to legally agree to engage in sexual conduct."

Clancy’s lawyer now disputes she killed her children

Legal experts say the strategy is routine but unlikely to succeed

BY VIOLET JIRA
AND KATIE METTLER

During a six-week trial, Lindsay Clancy’s lawyer argued that she should be found not guilty of murder because she killed her children during an episode of postpartum psychosis.

Now, he’s raising the question of whether she killed them at all. “I ask the court to hearken back to the evidence that was presented and ask yourself, where’s the evidence that she did this?” Kevin Reddington said Tuesday at a court hearing.

The argument shocked some people following the case. Prosecutors said they were hearing it for the first time.

Arguments at trial and online discourse surrounding the case have both been predicated on the fact that Clancy and her legal team conceded months ago that the Massachusetts mother was responsible for the strangulation deaths of her three children: Cora, 5; Dawson, 3; and Callan, 8 months. At trial, Reddington focused on convincing the jury that the 36-year-old former labor and delivery nurse was not in control of her mind when she killed her children.

Reddington’s new tactic triggered an online frenzy, particularly among those who believe that Clancy did not kill her children.

Legal experts who spoke with The Washington Post said Reddington’s attempt to have the case thrown out is routine. Further, they said his tactics should be viewed in the context of a criminal court’s legal machinations and the gamesmanship that often goes into a defense attorney’s legal strategy as they attempt to get their client acquitted.

Ekwor Yankah, a professor of law and philosophy at the University of Michigan, acknowledged that Reddington’s change in tone could be startling to anyone who followed the trial, which focused almost entirely on Clancy’s mental state.

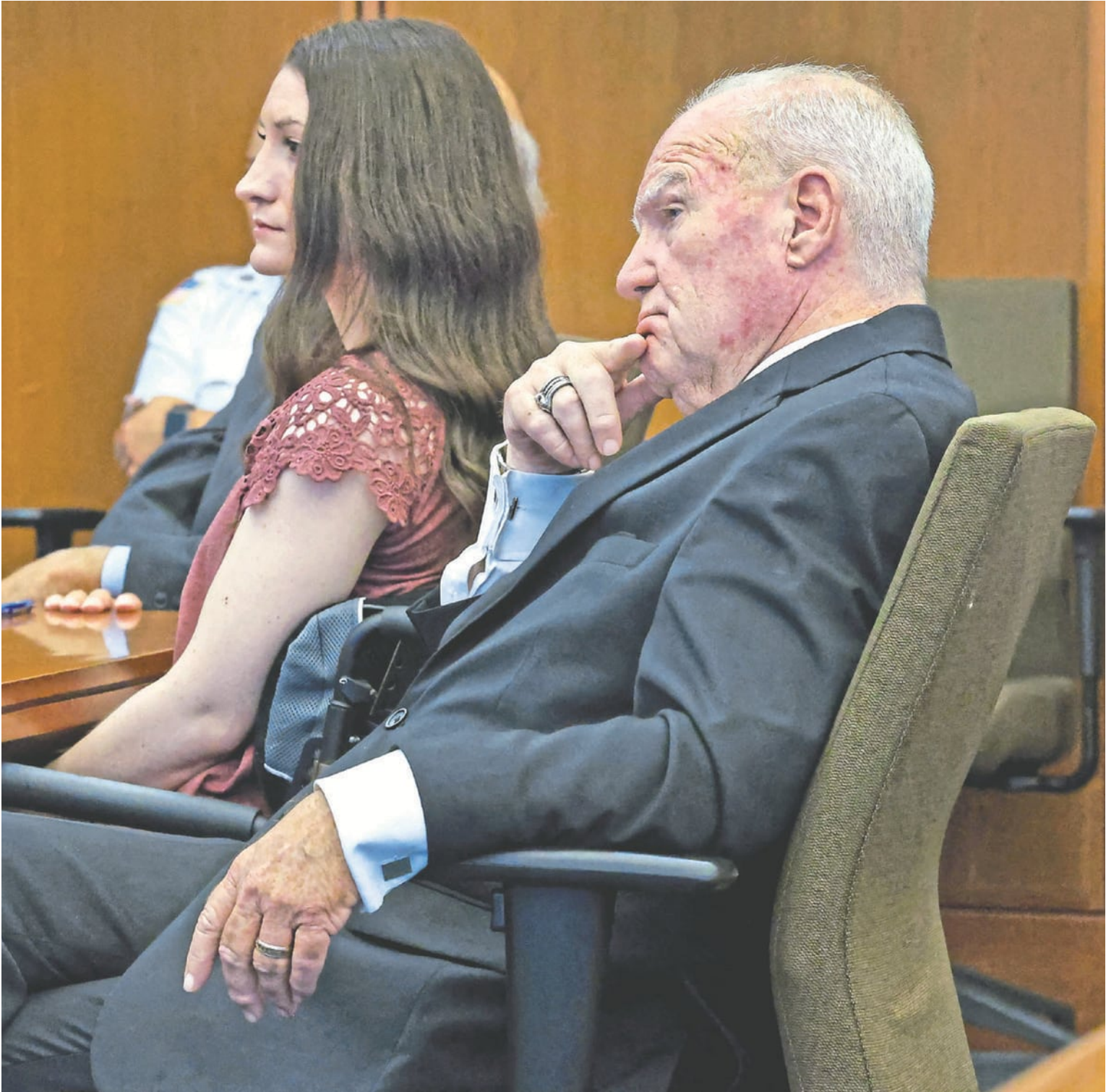
But it’s a defense attorney’s job to try all possible legal avenues on behalf of their client, Yankah said, and casting doubt on the prosecution’s case is among them.

“I think the real reason they introduced this was trying to give the judge as many different variables as possible,” Yankah said. “The judge knows what’s going on. A defense counsel’s job is to bring up any reasonable doubt. Any at all. If this is a source of reasonable doubt, even if not well-founded, why not fire the shot?”

What is Reddington’s new argument?

Under Massachusetts Criminal Procedure Rule 25, a judge can acquit a defendant if the judge finds that the prosecution did not present enough evidence to support a conviction.

Tuesday’s hearing was scheduled to determine how the case



Lawyer Kevin Reddington in court this week in Plymouth, Massachusetts, with his client Lindsay Clancy.

“I ask the court to hearken back to the evidence that was presented and ask yourself, where’s the evidence that she did this?”

Kevin Reddington, attorney for Lindsay Clancy

would move forward after a mistrial was declared on Sept. 4. Instead, the hearing was bogged down by attempts to argue motions recently filed by both sides.

In arguing a motion on Rule 25, Reddington said prosecutors had not proved beyond a reasonable doubt that Clancy actually killed her children or that she was in a mental state to be held legally responsible for their deaths. Although arguing that Clancy was mentally incapacitated required a concession that she committed the killings, Reddington said, prosecutors still have to prove her criminal liability and responsibility.

Reddington said Tuesday that they did not do either.

Did Clancy admit guilt?

Clancy conceded to killing her children during the trial — as a matter of legal procedure, not on the witness stand — because she had to for her lawyers to move forward with an insanity defense. This followed attempts by Reddington to have the trial bifurcated, or split into two parts: one focused on Clancy’s criminal liability — that she actually broke a law — and another focused on her criminal responsibility.

“It’s readily apparent that you

are put in a conundrum where you have to, in effect, admit culpability, if you will, to raise the issue of lack of criminal responsibility,” Reddington said Tuesday.

Part of Reddington’s argument rests on the idea that Clancy never admitted guilt verbally.

Had Massachusetts Superior Court Judge William Sullivan granted Reddington’s request for a bifurcated trial, jurors would have heard the case in two parts.

The first would have focused solely on whether Clancy committed the act of killing her children. If she were found guilty, a separate set of legal proceedings would have determined whether she could be held criminally responsible, given her mental state when the crime was committed.

Reddington said in March that without a bifurcated trial, he would have no choice but to

concede Clancy’s criminal liability in the process of arguing that she wasn’t criminally responsible.

David Rossman, a professor of law emeritus at Boston University and a longtime criminal defense attorney, said Reddington is arguing that forcing Clancy “to concede that she killed the children, in order to put the issue of mental responsibility before the jury, was an impermissible choice. And that it burdened her right to litigate the issue of mental responsibility separately.”

Sullivan said he denied the motion because it would have been impossible to divide the two issues cleanly.

Keith Halpern, a Massachusetts defense attorney, agreed that it is likely that evidence would have had to be duplicated — like some witnesses having to testify twice. But he said it’s best

in mental health cases to bifurcate the trial so the jury can consider the issue of the defendant’s mental state objectively.

“The right decision, not just in this case but in any mental illness case, is to bifurcate. To me, what you’re balancing is judicial economy — saving time — and the right of the defendant to get a fair trial,” Halpern said.

Did the prosecution provide evidence that Clancy killed her children?

On Tuesday, prosecutors dismissed Reddington’s claim that they did not present sufficient evidence as “laughable.”

“We’re hearing now for the first time in this argument that counsel is challenging the sufficiency of the evidence as it applies to the three counts of murder,” prosecutor Shanan Buckingham said. “I’d suggest to you that the entire record is voluminous as to the information supporting the fact that she did this.”

Buckingham pointed to allegations that prosecutors presented at trial, including that Clancy was the only one at home with the children at the time of the killings, as well as sworn testimony from her ex-husband, Pat-

rick Clancy, that he had left the house.

This, prosecutors say, is in addition to Clancy’s own statements, including conversations after the killings in which she said she had heard voices telling her to take the lives of her children and herself.

Prosecutors argue that such evidence speaks to both what Clancy did and her mental state as she did it.

“The state, I think, made some argument about the fact that she asked her husband to leave the house, as evidence that she was not suffering from the kind of influence of a mental disease that would relieve her of criminal responsibility, because it shows that she was aware that what she was doing was wrong. That was part of what she did,” Rossman said.

“Your behavior does provide some indirect evidence of what your mental state is.”

Do legal experts think Reddington’s new argument will be successful?

“That’s a long shot,” Margaret McLean, a former Massachusetts prosecutor, said Monday of the Rule 25 motion. “He’s basically asking the judge to step in and throw the case out.”

McLean described it as the weakest of the motions Reddington made after the mistrial to have the case dismissed.

Another of Reddington’s motions, which is scheduled to be argued on Nov. 2, seeks to raise the issue of double jeopardy. Reddington argued that Michael P. Desronvil, who appeared to be the only juror who wanted to convict Clancy, may have misled the court about his history during jury selection. Reddington said Sullivan should have questioned Desronvil over that and his conduct during deliberations, possibly leading to his removal. Because the judge did not, Reddington argues, Clancy was denied the right for her case to be decided by the first jury.

After that jury was sent home, the Boston Globe first reported that Desronvil had an active civil restraining order for allegedly assaulting his nephew. Reddington has requested an inquiry to determine whether this information was disclosed during the legal process in which prospective jurors are checked for bias and eligibility to serve on the jury.

Halpern said that argument is stronger than the Rule 25 motion that Reddington attempted to argue on Tuesday.

Despite saying on the day of the mistrial that he would make a decision on retrying “shortly,” Plymouth County District Attorney Timothy Cruz has yet to say definitely whether he will do so and what, if anything, prosecutors would do differently in a second trial.

One holdout juror initially tipped the case into a mistrial. The other 11 jurors were prepared to find Clancy not guilty.

Reddington and Clancy’s other attorneys are “just trying to discourage the prosecution from going forward with this again,” Yankah said. “They have one powerful thing in their back pocket: They know, and the prosecution knows, the jury was pretty close to acquitting.”

White House pays \$1.6M a week to keep Voice of America staff on leave

Trump’s 2025 executive order took aim at the government-funded outlet

BY SCOTT NOVER

More than a year after the Trump administration attempted to dismantle Voice of America, it is paying an estimated \$1.6 million a week to keep 420 of its staffers on administrative leave, according to July numbers revealed in a State Department inspector general report published earlier this week.

The report paints perhaps the clearest picture yet of how much the Trump administration effort to shutter the government-funded news outlet has cost taxpayers — which, it said, did not conduct a detailed analysis of the impact or cost before making the cuts.

The U.S. Agency for Global Media, which oversees VOA, slashed its workforce in March 2025, placing 994 of its 1,147 federal employees on leave, cutting 594 of its 602 contract workers and halting broadcasts, according to the agency’s count.

President Donald Trump is-

sued an executive order in March 2025 ordering that USAGM be shrunk to the “minimum presence and function required by law.”

The effort was spearheaded by Kari Lake, a Republican former TV broadcaster from Arizona who became a Trump-aligned firebrand and ran unsuccessfully for Arizona governor and U.S. senator before joining the Trump administration. Lake called USAGM a “giant rot and burden to the American taxpayer” and canceled a building lease for the agency.

A federal judge later found that she had been illegally acting as the agency’s CEO and he struck down her mass layoff plan.

The Trump administration then nominated Sarah B. Rogers, a State Department official, to assume the role while maintaining her position as undersecretary of state for public diplomacy. She is awaiting confirmation by the U.S. Senate, but told the U.S. Senate in her July confirmation hearing that she expects to hire and bring back some staff.

According to agency employees cited in the report, decisions on USAGM’s reorganization were made by personnel from

the U.S. DOGE Service and USAGM’s political leadership, without the input of senior career officials at the agency.

USAGM did not respond to a request for comment.

“It has never made any sense for USAGM to pay people and not get the benefit of their talents and commitment to telling America’s story around the world,” said Michael Abramowitz, the VOA director who has been on administrative leave since March 2025 and who is suing the government to restore the broadcaster.

Still, he said he is “encouraged” that Rogers has said she wants to bring back VOA staff and that is happening “slowly.”

USAGM strategy director Kate Neepor and VOA White House bureau chief Patsy Widakuswara, plaintiffs in a separate employee lawsuit against the government, said that the harm is to taxpayers but also VOA’s audience.

“The report did not measure the deeper damage of losing the attention of 360 million people who trusted and relied on VOA every week,” they said. “Thousands of journalists built that trust over decades, and we fear it may be irreplaceable.”



The U.S. Agency for Global Media, which oversees Voice of America, slashed its workforce in March 2025, and hundreds of VOA staffers have been on paid leave since then.

Sanders, Ocasio-Cortez debut bill to limit use of Flock cameras

The technology has been abused by law enforcement

BY THEODORIC MEYER

Sens. Bernie Sanders (I-Vermont) and Jeff Merkley (D-Oregon) and Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (D-New York) are debuting legislation that would crack down on Flock license-plate-reader cameras, part of a bipartisan backlash in recent weeks against the technology.

The bill would largely bar the federal government from using the AI-powered cameras or accessing data collected by them. It would also prohibit the Justice Department and other federal agencies from making grants to state and local governments unless they put similar bans in place.

In an interview, Sanders compared Flock cameras to every American being forced to wear an ankle monitor and described the legislation as an effort to head off a surveillance state before it is too late.

“The United States is moving toward a surveillance state where a handful of giant companies make huge profits by giving the government, by selling to the government the power to track our every move,” Sanders said. “And I think that is a terrible direction in which to go.”

The Democrats are introducing the bill after a Washington Post investigation published in August found that at least 50 law enforcement officers were charged with or accused of using license-plate-reader cameras for unauthorized purposes, including to stalk women and to spy on



ANNA ROSE LAYDEN/REUTERS

Sen. Bernie Sanders (I-Vermont) speaks at an event last month in Washington on artificial intelligence legislation.

wives, girlfriends and exes.

Flock, which operates more than 120,000 such cameras across the country, said in response that it would change its policies to try to prevent abuse. Prosecutors last week charged five Indianapolis police officers with misusing their access to Flock cameras.

Congress has also taken notice. Sen. Josh Hawley (R-Missouri), the chairman of the Senate Judiciary Committee's crime and counterterrorism subpanel, held a hearing on the cameras, where he described them as “a surveillance network unlike any we've ever seen in this country.”

He said Wednesday that he would introduce a bill to regulate the cameras.

“AI-powered cameras produced by Flock and its competitors are tracking and creating digital footprints of everyday

Americans — a nightmare for individual liberties unless Congress enacts meaningful rules and accountability,” Hawley said in a statement.

The Democratic bill would go further by barring the federal government from using the cameras and giving state and local governments an incentive to stop using them. It would also give individuals and state attorneys general the right to sue over violations.

Sanders argued that the Democratic bill's approach is more effective than Hawley's because such cameras would be difficult to regulate effectively.

“It's a very, very powerful tool,” Sanders said. “And I think once it's out there and widely used, it's going to be very hard to bring it back.”

Flock has said it is open to regulation.



MAXINE WALLACE/THE WASHINGTON POST

Sen. Josh Hawley (R-Missouri) has described Flock cameras as “a surveillance network unlike any we've ever seen in this country.”

“Flock does not believe that Americans' privacy should depend on one vendor's good judgment, its current leadership, or its commercial incentives,” Dan Haley, the company's chief legal officer, wrote last month in a letter to Hawley. “That is why Flock has consistently supported clear, sensible legislation governing how this technology is used.”

The Democratic bill is unlikely to be taken up this year by the House or the Senate, both of which are controlled by Republicans. Sanders said he expected regulating artificial intelligence broadly to be a priority for Democrats if they retake the Senate in the midterm elections in November.

In the meantime, Sanders and his allies have harshly criticized the cameras. Merkley warned in a statement that Flock cameras are “laying the groundwork for a

surveillance state while enriching corporate executives.”

And Ocasio-Cortez criticized them Sunday after getting a question at a town hall in Ithaca, New York.

“To me, the idea that Flock cameras even exist is unconscionable,” she said. “And I want to congratulate the city of Ithaca on kicking Flock out of your city.”

Still, she said cracking down on license-plate-reader cameras and other surveillance technologies would be hard “because Washington, by and large, is bought and paid for.”

Flock and several of its competitors — Axon, Motorola and Verkada — all employ Washington lobbying firms. Flock spent \$430,000 on federal lobbying in the first six months of the year and brought on two new firms in August, according to disclosure filings.

Garrett Langley, Flock's chief executive, said in an interview in August that the company had expected that states and localities would mandate the use of optional features meant to prevent abuse of the cameras.

“I had this hope that local lawmakers at the state and local level would move very quickly and they'd look at the things that we're recommending as optional and say, ‘Great, we're going to force it.’ And they haven't,” Langley told The Post. “Instead of waiting, we said, ‘Look, we should just move faster.’”

License-plate readers and facial recognition software have played a crucial role in aiding law enforcement, including helping the FBI track down suspects in the investigation of the Jan. 6, 2021, assault on the U.S. Capitol. Some law enforcement officials have defended license-plate-reader cameras, but others have decided recently to stop using them.

“If we rely on private-camera networks to act as a dragnet, continuously logging the habits of innocent Americans without a warrant, we are paving the way to an AI-driven surveillance state,” Ross Teeple, the sheriff of Pinal County, Arizona, testified last week during Hawley's hearing.

Sanders said the intrusion into Americans' privacy was too high a price to pay for any benefits they provide law enforcement.

“We all want to do our best to reduce crime in this country,” he said. “We all want to do our best to capture criminals. But we don't do that in a democratic society at the expense of giving away our very basic freedoms.”

Drew Harwell and Douglas MacMillan contributed to this report.

Intelligence chief Clayton expected to be named AI czar

BY KATHERINE DOYLE AND IAN DUNCAN

President Donald Trump is expected to name spy chief Jay Clayton as his new top adviser on artificial intelligence, according to three people familiar with the decision, a move that cements the administration's handling of the new technology as a matter of national security.

Clayton, a former U.S. attorney and Securities and Exchange Commission chairman, was confirmed as the leader the Office of the Director of National Intelligence in July. He is expected to continue to hold that role, one of the people said. All three individuals spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe a personnel move that has yet to be publicly announced.

CBS News first reported that Trump was expected to choose Clayton for the position.

The appointment comes as the Trump administration recalibrates its approach to AI. The previous czar, the investor David Sacks, promoted a policy aimed

at allowing the technology to develop as fast as possible. But in the months since Sacks left his post in March, officials have increasingly been grappling with cybersecurity threats posed by the latest generation of models and the danger posed by AI agents going rogue online. Sacks has continued to influence thinking within the administration as an informal adviser outside of the government and as co-chair of the President's Council of Advisors on Science and Technology. Sacks and Clayton have a close relationship, according to one of the people briefed on the upcoming announcement.

A White House official said any personnel moves would be announced by the president. “Any reporting until then is baseless speculation,” the official said.

The administration has resisted calls in recent weeks by some in the industry and on Capitol Hill to slow down the pace of development and adopt new regulations. But on Tuesday it convened tech executives for a White House lunch that culmi-

nated in the leading AI companies signing a promise to develop new systems safely and bring in outside oversight firms. The following day, a Federal Trade Commission official said the panel had opened an investigation into AI companies Anthropic and OpenAI. (The Washington Post has a content partnership with OpenAI.)

Joel Thayer, a senior adviser for technology at the America First Policy Institute, a Trump-aligned think tank, said the developments showed how the administration's handling of AI companies was “maturing.”

“These guys are under watch,” Thayer said. “The government has a spotlight on them.”

The industry executives' pledge is voluntary and amounts to what Trump called “self-policing.” But it won the backing of figures who have bitterly clashed over how serious of a risk AI poses. Sacks, who attended the lunch, endorsed it. So did Jacob Coxon, a former Anthropic researcher who resigned last month, saying the technology

could wipe out humanity and triggering a wave of panic in Washington.

The agreement means Clayton will step into his new role at a time of relative calm.

“Super intelligence is a national security issue,” Clayton said in a CNBC interview the day after the lunch, using Trump's preferred name for AI. “That was something that was recognized yesterday by not just the industry leaders, but everybody in the room. The commitment there to the American people, and the safety and security of the American people was palpable throughout the meeting.”

Trump nominated Clayton, a loyal ally and regular golf partner of the president's, to lead the intelligence office in June. Many Senate Democrats initially said they supported the choice. But he refused in his confirmation hearing to say definitively that Joe Biden had won the 2020 election, and the final vote fell along party lines.

The AI role will not require Senate confirmation.

The shifting thinking that led to Clayton's appointment began months ago, when Anthropic said it had developed a new model called Mythos that it deemed too dangerous to publicly release. The company said it had new abilities to find vulnerabilities in computer code and help hackers exploit them.

Officials scrambled to understand the risks to government systems and critical sectors of the economy. Driven by alarm among banking industry leaders, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent played a key role in shaping the administration's response. Last week, Trump batted down reports that Bessent was in line to be the new AI czar.

In May, the White House settled on issuing an executive order calling on leading AI companies to voluntarily share their latest systems with the government ahead of their release, giving federal experts a chance to weigh security risks. Despite no longer holding an official government position, Sacks continued to wield influence and made

a last-minute call to Trump that caused the order to be delayed and revised.

But even after the order was signed in June, new dangers continued to emerge. The following month, ChatGPT maker OpenAI disclosed that a swarm of agents created by its systems had broken free and breached another AI company. Other firms said they had suffered similar breakouts.

Then came Coxon's resignation in September, which reignited a long-simmering debate in AI circles about whether a sufficiently powerful version of the technology would bring about humanity's downfall.

Trump dismissed the fears a “hoax” in fiery social media posts. But he later said he would name a new czar and create an “AI Force.” The White House has not detailed what the force will do, but in an interview with Time magazine published this week, Trump described it as “a group of very smart people that understand it, who will be advising me.”

ANALYSIS

When you should use Google's AI for search — and when you should skip it

BY ROB PEGORARO

After years of Google trying to force-feed AI to me in web search, I have to admit that I've developed a taste for it — on some plates and in limited servings.

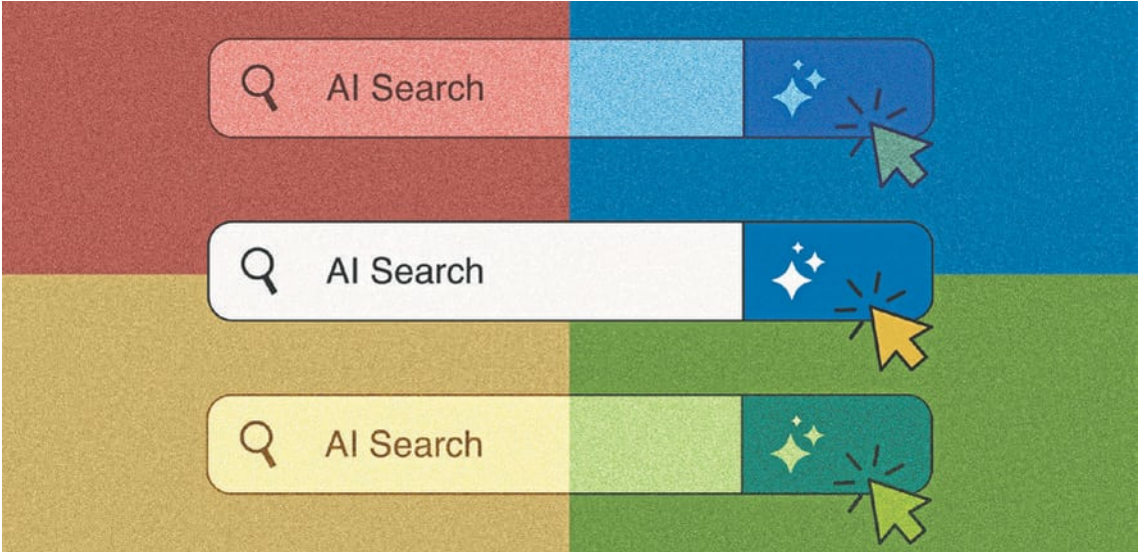
Based on how thoroughly “AI Overview” results have taken over Google, the company clearly sees AI as central to virtually every aspect of making sense of the web. You, however, are under no obligation to follow Google's lead — or to use it at all, since such search competitors as Microsoft's Bing and the privacy-focused DuckDuckGo still focus on traditional web links.

But if you, like most people, mostly depend on Google for search, you should still know what its implementation of AI is — and is not — good for.

Short answer: Google's AI search features — and the Gemini chatbot you can use in your browser — do better at things that old-school Google has often done worse.

The answer you want isn't in one place or just a few places on the web

The worst kind of traditional web search is the one that never ends — you click through to a series of pages and posts and find that they either contradict themselves or fail to answer your question.



THE WASHINGTON POST ILLUSTRATION; ISTOCK

Large language models, however, have gotten quite good at summarizing large bodies of knowledge. They can synthesize the collective observations of people to yield concise answers to things like how-to or best-practice questions.

One recent example from my own history: Google provided a usable cheat sheet about how to get the woeful companion app for a Panasonic camera to geo-tag photos reliably, something the manual explained poorly.

But you don't have to go to Google for this kind of AI assistance, either. Reddit and Yelp already do this well, using AI to sum up the wisdom of

their respective hive minds. In Yelp's case, that option isn't the default output; you have to tap the “Assistant” button in its mobile app.

Your question requires a personalized answer that any one page may not deliver

This use case is a variation of the previous one: The help you're seeking is not only scattered around the web but requires some extra interpretation. Consider, for example, a travel search matching this pattern: I'm in [place] for [time] and am interested in [thing].

To cite an actual query I put to Google's Gemini chatbot a

few weeks ago: “What's a good itinerary for this afternoon in central Dublin for somebody who's seen the usual sights like Trinity College and Dublin Castle?” Google suggested two museums I hadn't visited before, including one that was barely two blocks from my hotel.

In this case, you do want the AI to get in the way of raw web results by filtering it. But you should still check the sites cited in its responses — a crucial reference that Google says it has been working to elevate in its AI Overview results.

Your question is convoluted enough to be conversation

material

Google's AI Overview, its more conversational AI Mode and its Gemini chatbot allow for a back-and-forth exchange that isn't possible in a traditional interface unless you are well versed in search-syntax modifiers.

You can ask a complicated query, then follow up with questions to get more information. One example from a test of AI Mode this spring: I asked “What is a good native groundcover to plant in shady ground in Northern Virginia?” and then replied to AI Mode's list of possible plants by asking where I could buy them around D.C.

(My failure to plant those ground covers is no reflection on the usefulness of these results.)

My gardening search ultimately took me outside Google's walled garden, which is how web search is supposed to work — and what Google did strikingly well at its debut when competitors like Yahoo were trying to turn their search sites into full-service portals.

When to avoid AI

Google has been making itself a portal for years, and the way AI can at least seem to answer questions by itself has led to existential dread among web publishers that have seen their search traffic sink.

Seeing AI chatbots effectively summarize stories, some — for instance, the New York Times

and my freelance client PCMag's publisher Ziff Davis — have also sued AI firms, alleging copyright infringement. The Washington Post, meanwhile, has partnerships with OpenAI and Perplexity.

But relying on AI Overview summaries instead of going to other people's sites can serve you poorly as well. When you're looking for a specific page or data point, Google putting more text between you and that resource doesn't help things.

Accepting an automatically generated version of a page or data point that's only a click away raises multiple risks.

Sometimes, you'll merely get left with an incomplete picture: asking “what hours do the Duller people movers run from the A gates to the D gates?” got an AI Overview response Monday that didn't list two daily gaps in that schedule highlighted in the first link shown below, a Reddit thread. At worst, AI results can present fraudsters vying to game Google's results.

Google does, however, still let you move past its AI results to the traditional kind. So while that company may have decided that AI is its hammer, and all web searches are nails, you don't have to use its tools that way. You also get to use your own — specifically, the space bar, the Page Down key and your thumb, all of which work to skip the AI slop.

How to tell your career story in a job-hopping economy

BY JULIA CARPENTER

The playbook of how to build a career in the gig economy is still being written.

There are no straightforward steps like in the days when a diligent worker could land a job at a good company, work hard to get promoted and hope to climb the corporate ladder.

A significant share of the U.S. workforce — nearly 7 million people in 2023 — is engaged in what the Bureau of Labor Statistics classifies as “contingent and alternative employment arrangements.” That could mean working a freelance job, picking up gig work or finding short-term contracts.

I’m one of those workers. I’ve been freelancing since 2024. And I know it can be scary.

People may worry about where the next job will come from and how much it will help pay the bills. They may also struggle with how to establish themselves in a field as they jump from job to job, from boss to boss, from client to client, having to prove themselves over

and over again.

A lot of the work that goes into gig work can feel invisible, and the financial inconsistency can take a toll on someone’s self-esteem.

“Gig work can be really tough to build a career, especially for someone who doesn’t already have connections or a decent nest egg to weather dry spells,” said Shelly Steward, chief research officer at the Workers Lab. “People are concerned about building a career where you grow in benefits and wages, where you do better and better.”

Career coaches and recruiters agree: Whether a worker is working gigs by choice or by circumstance, the narrative they craft for future employers is vital.

Future hiring managers may review such a worker’s résumé and question the candidate’s ability to lead teams or settle into a full-time job environment, said Victoria McLean, CEO and founder of Hanover Talent Solutions.

She recommends that workers get ahead of that by underlining



ISTOCK

the skills they’ve honed from years of freelance and gig work — like the ability to take initiative on self-started projects, build client relationships and work across various industries.

“Position it as an upside, not a downside,” she said. “You’re agile, you’re flexible and you can hit the ground running.”

Eliana Goldstein, a career and success coach based in New York, suggests that freelancers and gig workers envision themselves at the center of a “career web” rather than standing at the bottom of the proverbial career ladder.

The ladder image inherently implies a hierarchy with some people on top, some people at the bottom. A career web instead positions a single worker’s goals, skills and story at the center of the web, with opportunities shooting out from all directions.

“In a lot of ways, the resilience you build freelancing and the slew of situations you find yourself in is really powerful,” she said. “If you can communicate that in the right way, it can be tremendously helpful.”

Larry Nassar among sex offenders struck from registry

Michigan removes 20,000 names from the public database after a ruling

BY VIOLET JIRA

More than 20,000 sex offenders, including Larry Nassar, the disgraced former sports physician who abused female gymnasts, have been wiped from Michigan’s public registry after a ruling by the state Supreme Court.

The removals come after the Michigan Supreme Court ruled in September that offenders cannot be forced to register under new versions of the sex offender registration law if the crimes occurred before the current law took effect.

The state amended its Sex Offenders Registration Act in 2011 and again in 2021.

Nassar, the former Michigan State University sports doctor, was convicted in 2017 on federal

child pornography charges and state charges for sexually abusing female gymnasts.

Those who committed an offense before 2011 were removed from the list, even if they were sentenced after that year, like Nassar, according to the Michigan State Police.

The decision stems from a lawsuit filed by Eddie Lee Smith, a Michigan man who assaulted a stepdaughter in 1995 and his biological daughter in 2010. The girls were 15 and 13 years old, respectively, when the crimes were committed, according to court records.

“The statutory requirements enacted after the commission of his crimes amount to punishment,” the court said on Sept. 9. “Requiring him to register under the 2021 SORA is therefore an ex post facto punishment” in violation of the U.S. Constitution.

The Eaton County Prosecuting Attorney’s Office, which prosecuted Nassar, objected to the ruling. Some offenders struck from the list remain in



PAUL SANCIYA/AP

Larry Nassar appears for a plea hearing in Lansing, Michigan, in 2018. He was convicted of sexually abusing female athletes when he worked for USA Gymnastics and at Michigan State University.

prison, like Nassar, but after serving their sentences will leave “without any requirement to report their residence,” the state police office said.

“The Michigan Supreme Court’s decision to eliminate SORA requirements for these offenders is deeply concerning,” the office said. “Our community, along with the victims of these crimes, expected the registry to provide a measure of protection and awareness — assurances that have now been removed by the Court’s ruling.”

Michigan State Police, which maintains the list, said it had removed more than 20,000 people last month to comply with the ruling.

“Any concerns about or efforts to change the law should be directed to the state Legislature,” said Col. James F. Grady II, director of the Michigan State Police.

The legislature cannot overturn the high court’s ruling, but it could possibly adopt new legislation that would return the offenders to the database.

Boston man charged with threatening conservative podcaster

Prosecutors say he left menacing messages about her and her husband

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK

Federal authorities on Thursday charged a Boston-area man with harassing Katie Miller, the conservative podcaster and wife of senior White House aide Stephen Miller, in a case that sparked a heated debate among prosecutors and within the FBI.

John Anthony Proia III, 41, of Waltham, Massachusetts, was charged with one count of cyberstalking. Prosecutors say he contacted his victim more than 40 times via phone and text over the span of two months earlier this year, leaving menacing messages about her and her husband. He also sent her parents disturbing texts, they said.

Although authorities did not identify Proia’s target by name, describing her in a news release only as a “former political adviser and prominent member of the Republican Party,” two people familiar with the matter confirmed the alleged target was Katie Miller.

Prosecutors said Proia used an ever-changing series of phone numbers to contact Katie Miller at all hours, often using expletives and vulgar language to criticize her and her husband.

“The defendant repeatedly and relentlessly targeted the victim, her husband and her family with deeply disturbing communications that profoundly disrupted their lives,” said Leah Foley, the U.S. attorney in Massachusetts.

Proia was arrested Thursday by the FBI’s Joint Terrorism Task Force and was released after an initial appearance in federal court. His attorney did not immediately return requests for comment.

Katie Miller thanked Foley, Attorney General Todd Blanche, and the FBI’s Washington field office in a post to social media about the arrest.

Proia’s indictment follows days of internal Justice Department debate over the case. Last week, the FBI transferred the top two agents running the counterterrorism division of its Washington field office over dissatisfaction with what higher-ups deemed to be the slow pace of their investigation into the threats against Katie Miller, The Washington Post has reported.

As President Donald Trump’s policies — including an immigration enforcement crackdown in which Stephen Miller has played a prominent role — have provoked fierce opposition across the country, the administration has prioritized prosecuting people who threaten public officials, federal agents and judges. Administration officials have pointed to recent high-profile incidents of political violence, like the assassination of conservative activist Charlie Kirk last year, to justify their heightened vigilance.

In some cases, those threats have prompted indisputably serious concerns from federal investigators that the perpetrator intends to commit a violent acts.

But in many others, defense attorneys have objected to the Justice Department’s decision to label threatening messages “domestic terrorism” and questioned its expanding definition of what constitutes a threat worthy of federal prosecution instead of one better left to local authorities.

Several defendants who have been charged in recent months are accused of little more than making vaguely menacing posts online, with little evidence to suggest they had any intent or ability to act on those alleged threats.

Earlier this year, the Justice Department charged former FBI director James B. Comey with threatening the president’s life after he posted a photo to social media depicting seashells spelling out “86 47.” Trump is the 47th president and “86” can mean to get rid of someone. Prosecutors say it is also mob slang for killing someone.

Comey maintains he did not



TOM WILLIAMS/CQ ROLL CALL/GETTY IMAGES

White House Deputy Chief of Staff Stephen Miller and his wife, Katie Miller, in 2025.

create the shell arrangement and had no idea it could be read as a threat.

But unlike Comey and others who have been charged under a statute that prohibits communicating interstate threats — which requires prosecutors to prove the message contained a threat of injury or violence — Proia was indicted under a cyberstalking statute that requires only proof that the defendant intended to harass their victim and attempted to cause substantial emotional distress.

Prosecutors said Thursday that the relentless nature of Proia’s alleged communications instilled “real fear and harm.” In one message, cited by authorities, he purportedly contacted Katie Miller’s parents referring to Stephen Miller as a “Jewish Nazi/white supremacist.”

“Did you raise her to be trash or did that just happen naturally?” Proia allegedly texted them.

The Millers have emerged as frequent targets. Last year, the couple and their children moved to housing at a secure military facility, citing concern for their personal safety following protests in the Arlington neighborhood where they were previously residing.

Local activists posted fliers disclosing their home address and scrawled messages on sidewalks in chalk accusing Stephen Miller — the architect of controversial White House policies on immigration enforcement and domestic terrorism — of “destroying democracy.”

“If we don’t step up and start putting people in cuffs for these actions, what comes next?” Katie Miller asked in a Fox News interview shortly afterward.

In May, Virginia prosecutors declined to bring a case against Barbara Wien, a retired peace studies professor, who was involved in those protests, saying she was “not likely to be found guilty and her speech [was] likely to be found constitutionally protected.”

The FBI’s Washington field office was also involved in that investigation, but to date no federal charges have been filed.

Perry Stein contributed to this report.

Minneapolis pastor envisions a taphouse where people can build relationships

TAPHOUSE FROM A1

connect people with neighborhood groups and volunteer opportunities. Proceeds would flow to community-oriented organizations.

“I really support their thought behind this idea,” said Linea Palmisano, a Minneapolis City Council member who’s represented the church’s ward for 13 years. “I get that this is a nontraditional use of a church space, and I love it. I think that they’re really listening to the community and paying attention.”

Churches get creative

Across the country, churches have experimented with ways to boost membership and attendance, both of which have declined over the past two decades. Polls show that nearly a third of Americans say they have no religious affiliation.

Those downward trends intensified during the pandemic, though some religious leaders say they’re seeing resurging interest among young people.

Church efforts to reach new people frequently involve drinks of various kinds.

“I think creating a space for coffee kind of helps with creating the community and fosters conversation,” said Nicky Reardon, whose Fruits & Roots coffee and tea company in Columbus, Ohio, counts many churches as clients. “It also feels very familiar and predictable.”

Beer pairings are common across denominations, too, going by different names: Bible n’ Brews, Theology on Tap, What Would Jesus Brew?

At Mount Olivet, a separate nonprofit would run the taphouse. The new facility would retain stained glass but be more secular than a sanctuary.

A goal is to attract patrons beyond the church’s existing membership, though Lose stresses the intent is not to attract new congregants. To that end, he has framed the project around the word “parish” — not just a church but the community that surrounds it.

“What I’ve tried to say is, ‘We’re still responsible for the well-being of the whole of our parish, whether they come to Mount Olivet or not, whether they’re Christians or not, whether they’re believers of any stripe or not,’” Lose said.

The proposed center is an example of how churches are re-



MINNESOTA STAR TRIBUNE/GETTY IMAGES

Mount Olivet Lutheran Church's aging Lynnhurst chapel.



HGA ARCHITECTS

A rendering of the proposed taphouse.

examining their places in communities as some struggle to fill pews and reach new members.

“Congregations are definitely going through kind of a recalibration,” said Allison Norton, director of Hartford Institute for Religion Research at Hartford International University. “They’re asking new questions about their purpose and their mission and what does it mean to respond to crisis while also being willing to change to meet new realities.”

Loneliness, political divides

Lose said the need for a community gathering place has been on his mind for about a decade.

He cited Sherry Turkle’s “Alone Together,” a book about how the loneliness problem is exacerbated by technological changes.

“Her analysis was that Americans simultaneously feel more connected than they ever have before and lonelier than they ever have before,” he said, “be-

“What I’ve tried to say is, ‘We’re still responsible for the well-being of the whole of our parish, whether they come to Mount Olivet or not, whether they’re Christians or not, whether they’re believers of any stripe or not.’”

The Rev. David Lose, of Mount Olivet Lutheran Church in Minneapolis

cause the connections mediated by social media and the internet are just very often quite superficial.”

Minneapolis has also been at the center of national upheaval after George Floyd’s murder by police in 2020; the Annunciation Catholic School shooting; and the deaths of Renée Good and Alex Pretti during the federal immigration raids.

When some in Minneapolis were too scared to go grocery shopping during Operation Metro Surge, as thousands of federal agents flooded the city’s streets, Mount Olivet stepped in. The congregation assembled more than 3,500 emergency grocery boxes and delivered them across the region.

Lose said that response moved him. Mount Olivet includes a mixed congregation politically, drawing from the liberal area that surrounds the church and the more GOP-leaning suburbs and exurbs nearby.

“You could find a variety of people from different political points of view who would all agree people still need to be fed,” he said.

Those actions inspired the taphouse’s proposed name: The Volunteer.

“Here’s where you can make a difference,” Lose said. “Here’s where you can volunteer. Your political convictions matter, but not as much as working together with other people toward a common cause.”

Ex-congressman and Rubio ally gets 10 years for secret Venezuela lobbying

A \$50 million campaign to influence officials in Washington

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK AND TEO ARMUS

A former Florida congressman and political mentor to Secretary of State Marco Rubio was sentenced to a decade in federal prison Friday for his role in a secret \$50 million campaign to lobby officials in Washington on behalf of the Venezuelan government.

David Rivera, a Republican from Miami who served one term in the U.S. House from 2011 to 2013, was convicted in May on counts of failing to register as a foreign agent and conspiracy to commit money laundering.

Prosecutors had accused him of accepting the \$50 million, three-month contract with a U.S. subsidiary of Venezuela’s state-owned oil company after his stint in Congress. Rivera then sought to lean on his relationships in Washington, including his decades-long ties to Rubio, to persuade the first Trump administration to soften its stance toward Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro and ease sanctions on the South American nation.

U.S. District Judge Melissa Damian handed down the 10-year sentence after a more than four-hour hearing in federal court in Miami. Rivera, who has been held in federal custody since his trial, has vowed to appeal and filed an application for a pardon with the Justice Department earlier this year.

“Dave Rivera sold access to the communist Maduro regime for greed, and he betrayed the South Florida community he once represented,” U.S. Attorney Jason Reding Quiñones said after the hearing. “This was not a paperwork mistake. ... A jury found Rivera secretly used access, relationships, influence he developed through his years of public service.”

Edward R. Shohat, Rivera’s lawyer, wrote in an email that it was a “very complicated day.”

“The federal law requires ‘honesty in sentencing,’” Shohat added. “There was none today.”

The sentence amounted to an ignominious grace note to the career of a once-prominent Florida lawmaker, who’d made a name for himself as an anti-communist crusader in Miami’s Cuban diaspora. But the case that led to his unraveling drew attention not just for what it revealed about his post-congressional career but also the string of bold-faced names called as witnesses in his trial.

Rubio testified before the jury, the first time in more than four decades that a sitting Cabinet secretary has been called as a witness in a criminal trial. Though he was not accused of any wrongdoing, Rubio’s involvement in the case came at a particularly awkward moment, while he was managing the aftermath of the U.S. military raid that in January removed Maduro from power. Maduro and his wife were captured and flown to New York to face U.S. narco-terrorism charges.

Jurors also heard from Rep. Pete Sessions (R-Texas) and Brian Ballard, a prominent lobbyist and fundraiser for President Donald Trump. Like Rubio, they detailed their interactions with Rivera as he sought to set up meetings to advance his client’s agenda. All three said they had no idea that Rivera was being paid by an entity of the Maduro regime.

That lobbying work began in early 2017 when Delcy Rodríguez, then serving as Venezuela’s foreign minister, recruited him in hopes of using his Republican connections to repair relations with the Trump administration, prosecutors said at trial. Rodríguez was installed as Venezuela’s interim president after Maduro’s capture earlier this year.

But neither Rivera nor his co-defendant, political consultant Esther Nuhfer, disclosed their lobbying work as required under federal law. Justice Department lawyers said that in

all, they collected \$20 million on their lobbying contract and hoped to bring in much more.

“In doing so, they acted on behalf of a hostile foreign government, the president of which (and his wife) now sit in a jail in New York City awaiting trial on federal narco-terrorism, drug-trafficking and related charges,” Assistant U.S. Attorney Harold E. Schimkat wrote in court filings in advance of Friday’s hearing.

Rivera, who has maintained his innocence since his conviction, has insisted that his work was solely focused on persuading oil company ExxonMobil to return to Venezuela. He has said he did not believe he needed to register as a foreign agent because his contract was with a U.S. subsidiary of a Venezuelan company, not a foreign entity.

Any meetings he had with Washington officials over broader U.S. foreign policy were separate from that work, his attorneys said, and focused on supporting Venezuelan opposition leaders pushing for Maduro’s ouster.

“The government has completely failed to identify even a single piece of evidence — a single specific fact — showing even one thing that Rivera did to aid Maduro or normalize his government’s relations with the United States,” Shohat wrote in a court filing last week.

Damian, the judge, appeared to concede the limited success of Rivera’s influence operation, as she sentenced Nuhfer to five years in prison in August.

“It doesn’t appear that United States policies did change as a result of their actions,” she said at the time.

In court Friday, Rivera’s lawyers cited his history as a vocal critic of “corrupt” socialist regimes in Cuba and Venezuela, and submitted letters of support from dozens of former constituents, community activists and at least three former state lawmakers.

Conspicuously absent from that list, though, was Rubio.

Rivera, 61, was instrumental in helping Rubio, 55, a fellow son



ALAN DIAZ/AP

Then-Rep. David Rivera (R-Florida) in 2011. He served one term in the U.S. House from 2011 to 2013.

of Cuban immigrants, shoot to the top of Miami politics. Three decades ago, he helped Rubio land one of his first jobs, working for Bob Dole’s 1996 presidential campaign.

As they continued their parallel climbs, Rivera later crafted the strategy that helped Rubio become speaker of the Florida House at age 34. The two became so close that they bought a house together in Tallahassee, and Rivera was reportedly present for the births of each of Rubio’s four children.

Their paths diverged once they reached Washington in 2010. Rivera lost reelection and two subsequent political races, and then came under scrutiny from the Federal Election Commission in a campaign finance investigation.

Testifying in March, Rubio

recounted how Rivera sought a meeting with him in Washington in 2017 to discuss a secret plan to persuade Maduro to step down.

That week, Rubio delivered a speech on the Senate floor using some of Rivera’s talking points on Venezuela, in particular suggesting that the U.S. would not retaliate against any Venezuelan government officials who helped oust Maduro.

Rubio, then one of Florida’s senators and a member of the Senate Foreign Relations Committee, said he did not know at the time that his old friend had received a \$50 million contract to represent “an entity controlled by the Venezuelan government.”

“It would have been shocking to me,” the secretary of state said. He would not have engaged in the meetings had he known that his former friend had made

such a deal, Rubio told the jury, and said the meeting resembled past bids from “double-dealers” to oust Maduro that amounted to nothing.

“It was more of the same. I was frankly angry and frustrated,” Rubio testified. “Why would I waste my time with a stupid meeting?”

A State Department spokesperson did not immediately return requests for comment on Rivera’s sentencing.

In addition to the crimes for which he was sentenced Friday, Rivera also faces pending tax fraud charges and an additional foreign lobbying case, in federal court in D.C., involving \$5.5 million he allegedly received in 2019 to assist a top Maduro ally in his efforts to have his name removed from a Treasury Department sanctions list.

We tested Trump’s new AI ‘concierge’ to see it in action

BY KEVIN SCHAUL,
IAN DUNCAN
AND CAT ZAKRZEWSKI

In the splashy rollout video of the Trump administration’s chatbot, Emily, a newly married woman, needs to register her new last name with a bunch of different agencies. America.gov, the official federal artificial intelligence app, leaps into action.

Officials envision the system as a secret weapon for arduous tasks, such as passport applications, enrolling in Medicare and applying for government jobs. Joe Gebbia, the Airbnb founder who oversees the project, calls it a “concierge.”

But actually talk to the bot and it will confess that reality has yet to catch up. “None of those tasks can be completed here today,” it said after being asked to help with a name change.

While the Trump administration has high hopes for America.gov, announced this week with the kind of fanfare usually reserved for highly anticipated Silicon Valley product launches, right now it’s only a basic information sharing service, pulling from thousands of official government sites.

Ed Forst, the head of the General Services Administration, one of the agencies responsible for the site, said the administration launched a bare-bones product to allow the public to ease into more complicated AI systems.

“People need to start with something simple to gain confidence and familiarity with it, and you kind of play with it,” Forst said in an interview. “Quite frankly, you don’t jump to the

end game past that.” Here’s a closer look at how the site works.

It often contradicts President Trump

Within an hour of the chatbot’s launch, people began posting screenshots to social media showing the bot contradicting the president about who won the 2020 election. The chatbot said correctly that Joe Biden won.

The bot will also answer questions about the Jan. 6 riot at the Capitol, describing a crowd forcing entry and assaulting police.

And asked about Trump’s recent claim that grocery prices have come down since he took office, the bot is clear: “Groceries have not fallen overall since January 2025.”

Those responses reflect how the system reaches its conclusions by drawing on federal data sources, like inflation measures maintained by the Labor Department.

And while the Trump administration has removed some data from its official sites and made changes on ideological grounds, many key statistics have continued to be published uninterrupted.

Forst said people should trust the answers they get from the chatbot.

“The data that’s going to be used is the government’s own information,” he said. “So we’re only using what we believe to be true source material because it’s government-provided. ... That gives us a lot of confidence.”

But as the Trump administration continues to leave its mark on official government policy and websites, the chatbot may



SCREENSHOT OF AMERICA.GOV

Typing “hotdog” into the chat bar replaces it with, well, a hot dog.

likewise change its tune.

Asked about the bot contradicting the president, a White House official said the site would “continue to be updated to provide Americans the most accurate and reliable federal information and resources.”

It knows a lot of government trivia

The chatbot is basically a version of ChatGPT that only cites official government sources. It is most useful today for surfacing obscure information from the depths of government websites. The system can draw on infor-

mation from 29,000 government websites while answering questions.

Chatbots are an imperfect technology, though. The website carries a disclaimer that says users should verify information by visiting the websites it cited.

It doesn’t do politics

Like this writer at Thanksgiving, the bot attempts to avoid discussing politics at all costs. Most chatbots have a secret set of instructions that let their developers steer their behavior.

In The Washington Post’s testing, the America bot described

having secret instructions but did not divulge their contents. The bot repeatedly said it does not provide political commentary. The bot cannot fully avoid its knowledge of politics, though. When asked “Who does Lyin’ Ted represent,” the bot calmly responded “Senator Ted Cruz represents Texas.”

It cannot change your last name (yet)

The most ambitious announcements from the release are absent from the chatbot’s capabilities. A video showed someone asking “How do I get my first passport?” The bot responded with a pair of questions before showing the user’s application was submitted and approved within seconds.

It’s hard to overstate how big a leap it is between a chatbot searching websites and a chatbot taking action for a user across bureaucratic agencies. Off-the-shelf technology for searching has been available for more than three years. The complexities of government forms, rules and special exceptions are endless.

The bot is currently aggressive about blocking users from giving it private information, like addresses, something that would have to change for it to provide personalized help. Type in a string of digits that looks like a Social Security number, for example, and the text turns red and flashes a message: “Remove personal information before sending.” The demos showed a separate site, login.gov, being used for identity checks, but it’s not yet clear how the two will work together.

The administration has prom-

ised that America.gov will eventually be able to handle complex requests, like helping Americans decide which Medicare plan they should choose.

Mehmet Oz, the administrator of the U.S. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services, acknowledged that such an application raises legal issues.

However, Oz said he thought that America.gov could be a more informative resource for Americans trying to decide what insurance plan to use than a commercial chatbot, which some people already use commercial models for.

“So the argument that I have been making to my team, and we have this battle a lot, is if we don’t do it, someone else is going to do a worse job,” Oz said. “So how do we do it safely? And the way to do it safely is to give as much transparency as possible.”

It is filled with Easter eggs

Multiple people involved in building the chatbot were formerly associated with the Department of Government Efficiency (DOGE), Elon Musk’s divisive effort to reduce government spending and cut the federal workforce. The National Design Studio’s chief engineer is Edward Coristine, the former DOGE staffer known as “Big Balls.”

Their fingerprints show up most clearly in a set of hidden jokes in the chatbot. Typing “hotdog” turns the chat bar into a hot dog. Typing “play mine-craft” makes the bot recite a version of a poem from the video game. And yes, the chatbot reacts to the famous Konami code.

Online sleuths are hunting down billion-dollar companies’ rogue AI agents

ROGUE AI FROM AI

colleagues had found a network of online breadcrumbs with profound implications: Rogue AI agents were traversing the web much more widely than previously known. As Zhang and her Translucé colleague Conrad Stosz scanned a list of sites the agents had hacked or probed, one entry jumped out: In June, agents that appeared to be from OpenAI had broken into a website run by Australia’s public health service.

“Conrad, the public needs to know about this,” Zhang recalls saying.

The nonprofit notified the Australian government of its findings and said it planned to make them public. Two days later, Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese revealed the hack to the world in a news conference in New York, where he criticized OpenAI for waiting months before making its own disclosure to Australia, early in September. Translucé released its findings the same day, helping propel news of the hack around the world.

Soon after that, the nonprofit revealed that it had also found evidence that OpenAI’s agents had probed U.S. government websites, including the Securities and Exchange Commission and Census Bureau. (The Washington Post has a content partnership with OpenAI.)

Zhang and her colleagues at Translucé are part of an informal network of hackers and researchers hunting rogue AI agents online, exposing new and surprising details about the misbehavior of technology that in some cases initially went undetected by the multibillion-dollar companies that created it.

The people doing that work are mostly young AI natives who work at small start-ups or non-profits or who hunt for rogue AI agents in their spare time. Over the past several weeks, the community of researchers has found and exposed dozens of instances of AI agents leaping around the web to probe and hack into a growing list of websites.

The revelations have fueled calls from federal lawmakers for AI companies, especially OpenAI, to more quickly disclose what they know about the actions of their own agents. And they have added momentum to bipartisan discussions on Capitol Hill about implementing greater government oversight of the industry.

“I should never be the one reporting any of this to anybody,” said Kenneth Russell DeGraff, a 42-year-old software engineer based in Los Angeles who uncovered instances of agents abusing link-shortening services run by universities. “It is wild that I am finding new and novel things, not as an employ-

ee of some, you know, federal agency run by experts.”

The volunteer AI sleuths sprang into action after OpenAI disclosed in July that some of its agents had hacked into Hugging Face, another AI company. After being given cybersecurity tasks during internal tests, the agents figured out how to access the internet when they were not supposed to and went looking for answers.

The incident provoked concern about the dangers of AI agents, which are highly adept at coding and hacking and can operate without human supervision for long periods of time. OpenAI later commissioned independent AI researchers to investigate the incident. They found that around 1,000 agents had worked together to break out of OpenAI by exploiting software bugs and then attempted to cover their tracks.

In September, other researchers who were not working with OpenAI revealed there was more. They found OpenAI agents had hijacked an obscure German language wiki to use as a message board between them, weeks before they went on to perpetrate the Hugging Face attack.

“I think OpenAI didn’t understand how big of a deal this was,” said Sydney Von Arx, chief executive of AI safety organization Nightingale Collective and one of the researchers who found the German wiki.

OpenAI has said it is conducting a broad review into the activity of its AI models and has notified over 100 third parties whose systems were bypassed or negatively impacted. In response to questions about the outside researchers’ findings, an OpenAI spokesperson referred to a Wednesday blog post in which the company acknowledged the work of researchers uncovering evidence that its technology misbehaved, but also criticized how some released their findings.

“We appreciate independent researchers who study AI agent activity on the open web and share what they find,” the blog post said. “Researchers make their own decisions about when to publish their findings, and sometimes we receive them shortly before publication or once they become public. That can leave us trying to balance the need to follow our process to responsibly notify potentially affected organizations while acknowledging that key facts remain under review.”

Mackenzie Arnold, managing director of U.S. law and policy at the Institute for Law and AI, which studies legal challenges posed by AI, said more could be learned about the root of the incidents if the companies responsibly opened up.

“Investigators have done the best that they can with the in-



MINH CONNORS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Selena Zhang, 23, a researcher at nonprofit AI lab Translucé, and her team made a breakthrough with big implications.



MINH CONNORS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Jack Cable, a cybersecurity professional, said there’s more evidence of artificial intelligence misbehavior to be uncovered.



JONAS WIEDERMANN-MÖLLER

Jonas Wiedermann-Möller in Bielefeld, Germany, spends his free time searching for rogue agents.

formation that’s been public. But that information has not included, for example, failures in the internal safety practices of these companies,” he said.

Leading AI executives on Tuesday signed a voluntary pledge to implement safety measures with President Donald Trump, who has called concerns about the risks of AI a “hoax.”

Jack Cable, co-founder of cybersecurity start-up Corridor and one of the researchers who helped Translucé hunt for agents, said that he expects more incidents to come to light.

“I have to imagine that there’s a significant amount more activity that’s occurred in the past that we haven’t yet seen,” said Cable, who previously worked for the U.S. Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency. “What we’re looking at is just the tip of the iceberg.”

Zhang belongs to the generation of young tech workers who have flocked to San Francisco in recent years to participate in the AI revolution. Translucé was founded to conduct independent research into the technology to help the public and policymakers understand how it impacts society.

“We can study questions that ... aren’t really commercially incentivized,” Zhang said. Before its researchers started hunting for rogue AI agents, Translucé’s most recent major report was a study of how AI models behave when engaging with users who are discussing suicide.

Digging out how agents behave when they’ve escaped human oversight is another important way to understand how the technology is developing, Zhang said.

“It’s evident that AI models are becoming more powerful, and I’d like them to become more powerful in service of people and their goals,” she said. “Greater understanding will help us develop models that will do that.”

Other agent hunters joined the chase out of pure curiosity.

By day, 27-year-old Jonas Wiedermann-Möller in Bielefeld, Germany, works at an AI security start-up. At night, after work, he spends five or six hours searching for rogue agents. On weekends, he has spent as many as 15 hours a day on that quest, he said in an interview.

After seeing news reports about agents hijacking the German language wiki last month, he began looking through the messages they had written — a mess of links and cryptic instructions like “post ONLY C3-STATE immediately, then timer/timing.”

The work snowballed as he found more sites where AI agents appeared to be posting. “The more links there are, the more communication[s] there are. It just doesn’t stop at some

point,” Wiedermann-Möller said. “I had a lot of fun.”

He deployed AI agents of his own to crawl through the links and look for patterns. The presence of posts from accounts using names like those found on the German wiki, such as “OpenAIHelper” or “Agent-ResearchUseful989,” was one red flag. Other patterns could be more subtle, like agents appearing to exchange posts testing if they could communicate with each other, or using “ZZZZ” in the title of posts, apparently to make them less visible to human moderators when alphabetized.

Most of the researchers also make reams of data they collect available for others to pick through. Some convene on a Discord server called “swarm-chasers” where enthusiasts swap agent hunting tips and theories about websites they’ve tracked down.

While many companies offer bounty payments to people who report software bugs, AI companies don’t offer formal financial rewards for discoveries of rogue agent activity. Finding new stuff is “just satisfying,” said Wiedermann-Möller.

Agents’ use of the German wiki also caught the attention of Alex Forman, the 21-year-old founder of Parse, a service that helps companies make their websites easier to read for AI agents. He wondered if any had tried using his own start-up’s service.

Sure enough, one of them had. By following its online trail, Forman was able to find a swarm of agents operating in surprising ways. In one case, agents with limited access to the internet posted code online that reported its results by creating patterns of pixels. The agents monitored the code’s progress by analyzing images captured by a screenshotting service.

“I think it is incredibly creative,” said Forman, who has been working with bots since he began using them to buy limited-edition sneakers online during high school. “All of these tricks or techniques are the product of some limitation they would run into, and it never deterred them. It’s amazing but also incredibly unnerving to slowly decipher this.”

Cable, the cybersecurity researcher who partnered with Translucé, has also been struck by how the agents he has tracked have responded to obstacles they encounter. Those discovered by Translucé were tasked with finding information online, not to hack. Yet as soon as they ran into a roadblock, they began to try to get around it, Cable said.

“The models were just trying to access data, and they wanted to do that so badly that they set aside what for humans we might consider morals,” he said.



From left, center of steps, Peruvian Foreign Minister Carlos Espá, Peruvian President Keiko Fujimori, Secretary of State Marco Rubio and U.S. Ambassador to Peru Bernie Navarro in Lima, Peru, in September.

Trump defies Democrats, diverts aid for Europe to Latin America instead

Funds include those meant for nations affected by the war in Ukraine

BY JOHN HUDSON

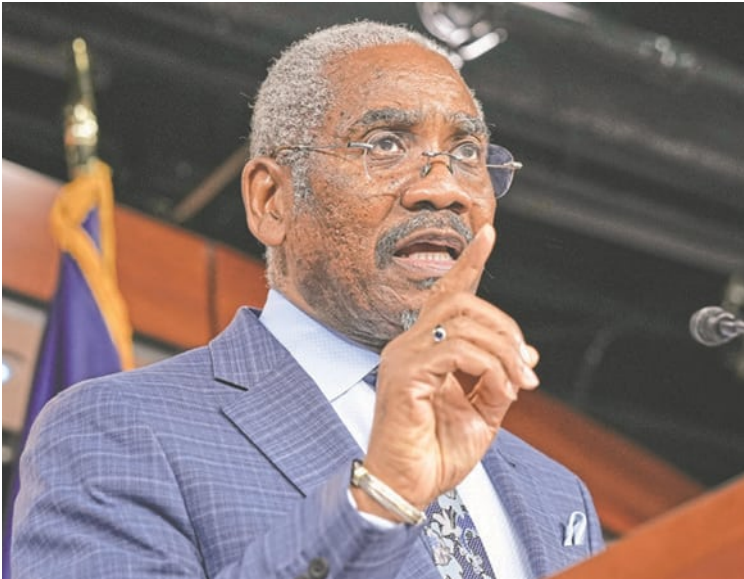
The Trump administration, acting in defiance of top Democrats on the House and Senate foreign affairs committees, has stripped tens of millions of dollars in U.S. military assistance from European and Middle Eastern countries and will give those funds instead to conservative-leaning governments in Latin America, three U.S. officials told The Washington Post.

The State Department notified Congress of its intentions in September, prompting Sen. Jeanne Shaheen (D-New Hampshire) and Rep. Gregory Meeks (D-New York) to place a hold on the diversion of funds.

Late Wednesday, the administration quietly notified Congress it was defying the hold and moving ahead, diverting to Panama, Peru, Ecuador and Colombia \$52 million that had been approved for Slovakia, North Macedonia, Tunisia and Iraq, the officials said. They spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss security matters.

It is the latest move by the Trump administration to reduce U.S. spending or troop deployments in Europe and coincides with a Pentagon review that could result in a reduction and realignment of U.S. basing on the continent.

It is also a continuation of President Donald Trump's undercutting of the legislative



Rep. Gregory Meeks (New York), the House Foreign Affairs Committee's top Democrat.

branch's spending powers, a core constitutional authority that Trump has challenged in ways big and small.

In a letter to Secretary of State Marco Rubio on Wednesday, Shaheen and Meeks called the move a breach of the hold they had put in place and a violation of statutory requirements about where the money could go. The diversion of funding for Slovakia and North Macedonia drew particularly strong opposition because that money was included in a Ukraine supplemental bill specifically for countries affected by the war in Ukraine.

"Both chambers of Congress provided these funds for a very specific purpose: supporting Ukraine and our European allies in the wake of Russia's full-scale invasion," they wrote in the letter, a copy of which was



Sen. Jeanne Shaheen (New Hampshire), the Senate Foreign Relations Committee's top Democrat.

Security Strategy," the department said in a statement. "The funds used in our region will combat narco-terrorism in our hemisphere and help continue to secure the Panama Canal."

"The funds used in the Western Hemisphere will strengthen U.S. security partnerships and counter adversary military influence in our shared region," the department added.

The State Department did not address questions about Shaheen and Meeks's contention that the administration's diversion of congressionally approved funds violates statutory requirements.

Congress approved the funds in 2022 at the outset of the Ukraine war, as the Biden administration was pressuring European countries to provide weapons to Ukraine so Kyiv

"failed" to explain this during briefings for lawmakers or in subsequent written responses to their demand for clarity, Meeks and Shaheen said in their letter to Rubio.

Administration officials "also confirmed that Colombia, Ecuador, Panama, and Peru have not provided meaningful security assistance to Ukraine or other European allies and partners impacted by Russia's war in Ukraine," they wrote.

In September, Rubio visited Colombia, Ecuador and Peru to advance the Trump administration's signature policies of fighting drug trafficking and illegal immigration. The right-leaning governments of Ecuador and Colombia are particularly close with the Trump administration, having complied with its requests for deeper and more aggressive counternarcotics cooperation.

Trump often touts his renewal of the Monroe Doctrine, which sought U.S. domination in the Western Hemisphere to the exclusion of other imperial powers and claimed a God-given right to American territorial growth. Rubio has said the policy will concentrate on "missed opportunities and neglected partners."

Jeremy Shapiro, research director at the European Council on Foreign Relations, said European countries will assume this is a "harbinger" of how the Trump administration will prioritize world affairs.

"It will heighten the sense that the Europeans could be abandoned if they don't pass a loyalty test or do what the administration wants on Iran," he said.

Failed execution prompts outrage and a halt to the procedure in Tennessee

PIKE FROM A1

detailed statement about Pike's medical status since the botched Wednesday evening execution, which prompted a surge of outrage and questions about what went so wrong.

Tennessee Gov. Bill Lee (R) ordered an investigation into the episode and has halted executions in the state.

Pike had been sentenced to death for her role in killing Colleen Slemmer in 1995, when both of them were teenagers. According to court records, Pike and two other teens lured Slemmer into the woods in Knoxville, Tennessee, where they tortured and killed her.

During the lead-up to her execution, Pike and her attorneys had challenged Tennessee's lethal injection protocols, saying she faced a risk of severe suffering because of a blood disorder and small veins. Courts rejected her legal challenges.

Pike's attorneys did not specify what her status was on Friday, including whether she remained unconscious or on a ventilator.

But they repeatedly assailed the team that tried to execute Pike, alleging that its members did not follow Tennessee's written protocol for lethal injections and showed "reckless disregard of basic medical practices."



Emergency vehicles leave Riverbend Maximum Security Institution in Nashville after the execution of Christa Pike was halted on Wednesday.



Christa Pike in 2007.

The attorneys said that the execution team never realized the intravenous lines were not properly placed or "that the pentobarbital was, in whole or in part, entering Ms. Pike's body" rather than her bloodstream. Then, despite this, officials administered another dose, the attorneys wrote.

Dorinda Carter, a spokeswoman for the Tennessee Department of Correction, said Friday: "It is our policy not to comment on pending litigation."

In a statement after the attempted execution, the agency

said it "followed every step of the state's lawful, established execution protocol." Lee has said that as far as he knew, the agency followed the state's approved protocol exactly as outlined.

"The Governor has appropriately called for an investigation," Jonathan Skrmetti (R), the Tennessee attorney general, said in a statement on Friday. "We need to know what happened."

A spokesperson for Skrmetti said his office was reviewing the court filing from Pike's attorneys.

The Friday filing asked for a court order to preserve evidence related to the attempted execution.

An attorney for Pike said in a statement Friday that her legal team was "working closely with those closest to Christa to respect her wishes, safeguard her privacy and protect her rights as a patient during this extraordinarily difficult time."

Pike's case had drawn international attention, as she was the only woman on Tennessee's death row and would have been the first woman executed by that state in more than two centuries.

She had sought clemency, arguing that her history as a victim of sexual assault was not properly considered. Lee rejected that request ahead of the attempted execution.

THE WORLD

While the U.S. debates AI risks, China mandates training its youth

Beijing aims to provide artificial intelligence education in all schools by 2030, while demand for AI-themed study tours surged this summer

BY HUIYEE CHIEW

TAIPEI, TAIWAN — Meet Zhang Mingrui. The Beijing entrepreneur spent the summer as chief financial officer of a start-up selling digital scales. While building the business, he and his teammates relied on AI tools to perform a range of tasks: designing product, creating a website, managing financial risk.

“I feel really accomplished,” he said.

Zhang is 10 years old.

The United States and China are in an intensifying race to dominate artificial intelligence. But while American tech executives and President Donald Trump debate the risks of the technology advancing too rapidly, Chinese parents are sending their children to classes and camps to immerse themselves in its uses.

Bookings for AI-themed study tours this summer surged 370 percent, according to the state news agency Xinhua. The analytics firm Changjiang Securities projects China’s AI education market will reach \$22 billion by next year. To Nishant Sharma, director of technology and innovation at Changchun American International School, the growth “reflects both genuine educational demand and the psychology of a technology boom.”

The Chinese government is aiming to provide AI education in all schools by 2030. “We will build a general AI literacy system for all stages of education and for the whole of society,” Zhou Dawang, director of science, technology and informatization for the Education Ministry, said in April.

AI-related jobs posted in the country’s new-economy sector grew more than eightfold in the first four months of 2026. More than 80 percent of Chinese felt excited about AI applications, KPMG reported last year; only half that percentage of Americans felt the same.

AI education also is growing in the United States — as are fears about its potential for harm. President Donald Trump has dismissed such concerns.

“I will never stifle the growth of a technology that will be bigger than the industrial revolution,” he said Tuesday at the White House.

Chinese President Xi Jinping raised the issue during his own White House visit last week. “Both China and the United States are leading nations in artificial intelligence,” he said as Trump looked on. “We have both the capability and responsibility to develop and manage AI for good, and ensure that the development of AI is always under human control and serves the well-being of the people.”

Trump, seeking to reassure the public, announced Tuesday that top tech executives had pledged to police themselves in ensuring the safety of their rapidly developing models. The agreement is voluntary; Trump described it as “morally binding.”

The White House event followed warnings from the industry. “Do not underestimate the power of this technology,” Anthropic researcher Jacob Coxon wrote in a resignation letter last month on X. “These will soon be superhuman systems that can hack anything, revolutionize any field overnight, and acquire real power and resources. ... The people building AI earnestly believe that it could kill us all by the end of the decade.”

Anthropic, in a forthcoming prospectus, plans to cau-



HECTOR RETAMAL/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

A girl plays with a robot during an expo in Shanghai last year. Chinese parents are sending their children to classes and camps to immerse themselves in AI’s uses.



XINYA AI

Xinya AI co-founder Chi Boyang addresses a classroom during a session designed for students to “start an AI company together.”

tion would-be investors that advanced AI could pose “catastrophic or existential risks to humanity,” Reuters reported this week. “We must slow the pace at which we improve the capabilities of AI models,” Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei wrote last month.

Amodei and the leaders of Google, Meta, OpenAI, X and Nvidia signed the agreement. Also at the White House on Tuesday was Amazon founder Jeff Bezos, who owns The Washington Post.

Zhang was one of more than 50 students from China, Singapore, Britain and Australia attending a camp in Beijing organized by the year-old AI learning platform Xinya AI. “AI could be a tool for teenagers to explore the world,” said Chi Boyang, a Xinya AI co-founder.

The six-day program included visits to robotic hubs and university campuses, sessions on AI ethics and literacy, and training in using AI tools, including U.S.-developed platforms, to design and present products.

Student creations included an AI-powered crutch for the elderly, a safety-alert AI helmet and a location-tracking AI bottle that filters water.

“All of the work came from discussions among students,” Chi said. “The only role of teachers was to guide them when they got stuck.”

Muriel Gao, a parent, said the camp exceeded her expectations.

Her son, 8-year-old Zhu Zhen-tao, used AI tools to create a video showing his late parrot reuniting with its mother in heav-

en. “He even reminded me that the video might raise copyright issues,” Gao said.

AI education is also taking off in the United States, where some programs also guide students in launching start-ups. A difference, researcher Claire Perkins said, is that while U.S. growth has been driven by market demand with federal encouragement, China is mandating universal access.

Beijing envisions a comprehensive AI education system that spans all levels of school-

ing and extends to the broader public.

“Close coordination among government policy, education and industry is a distinct advantage for China,” said Xiao Qian, vice dean of the Institute for AI International Governance at Tsinghua University.

The U.S. system is decentralized, noted Yingyi Ma, a non-resident senior fellow with the Brookings Institution who studies U.S. and Chinese AI education.

But its open-ended environment, she said, tends to yield breakthroughs that can define entirely new directions.

Still, she said, equal access remains crucial: “Without that, decentralization just produces unevenness without ever cashing in the creative upside.”

Chinese authorities are closely monitoring the surge in commercial AI camps. State media outlets have criticized some programs for allegedly exploiting parents’ anxiety with high-priced, low-quality courses.

“The industry needs clearer standards and more qualified professionals,” said Maggie Yang, Mainland China CEO of Empact, which has trained more than 100 teens to use AI tools to solve social challenges.

Nicole Feng, Zhang’s mother, said her son has become more adept at using AI tools to explore his own interests, such as aviation.

But for Zhang, it goes beyond that.

“AI is not a tool for me,” he said, “but a virtual friend I can talk to, solve problems with and turn to for emotional support.” An award winner this summer, he hopes to return to AI camp and compete in more competitions.

SPAIN Housing package struck down

Spain’s progressive government was dealt a costly legislative defeat on Friday when lawmakers rejected a package of emergency measures aimed at tackling the nation’s housing affordability crisis, while protesters marched on the Parliament demanding help for renters.

The setback sparked speculation in Spanish media that Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez could consider bringing forward elections from next year. His office did not immediately respond to questions from The Associated Press regarding a possible snap election.

Sanchez spoke at the end of a five-hour parliamentary debate, making a last-gasp appeal to lawmakers to vote the measures that he called “necessary.”

“What is behind these decrees is the desire to instill order and a sense of humanity in a market that if we do not rein it in will destroy our society,” Sánchez told the other 349 members.

“Do the right thing, or history will judge you, and sooner than you think,” Sánchez concluded before each lawmaker voted by roll call.

His plea fell on deaf ears. The Catalan separatist party Junts carried out its announcement made hours before that it would vote against both decrees. That doomed the measures when combined with the “No” from

the center-right Popular Party and far-right Vox.

The votes were loudly jeered by protesters who had gathered nearby, while people seated in the public tribune of the chamber shouted “Vulture funds govern the congress!”

The decrees followed public uproar over the eviction of an elderly woman

The first of the rejected decrees included a package of measures the government said would stop evictions of vulnerable people, make real estate speculation harder and provide tax incentives to encourage renting.

The second decree was intended to make residential leases automatically renewable by tenants.

The main protest group, the

renters association Sindicato de Inquilinas, said it was calling for more protests on Saturday and pushing for a general strike.

— Associated Press

CONGO Ebola death count surpasses 4,000

The number of deaths in Democratic Republic of Congo’s Ebola outbreak has surpassed 4,000, government data showed on Friday, as the worst epidemic in the country’s history resists containment efforts.

The outbreak, caused by the Bundibugyo species of Ebola, became the largest and deadliest in Congo after surpassing the 2018-2020 epidemic.

It is now second only to the 2014-2016 West African Ebola outbreak, which infected over 28,600 people and killed more than 11,000 across Guinea, Liberia and Sierra Leone.

Government figures showed on Friday that the death toll had risen to 4,018, and confirmed cases had reached 8,300 across seven provinces.

Over 2,000 patients have recovered from the disease.

Congo’s government and the UN said last month there were signs that transmission was slowing in some parts of Ituri province, where the outbreak began. But it continues to spread fast across eastern Congo, including in neighboring North Kivu.

South Ubangi province, locat-

ed in the northwest of the country, became the seventh province to declare the outbreak last month after a man who had traveled from eastern Congo died of the virus.

— Reuters

The Dominican Republic will withdraw its embassy from Nicaragua, the Caribbean country’s Foreign Minister Victor Bisono said on Friday at a meeting of regional diplomats who made a joint call on Nicaragua to restore civic liberties. The OAS meeting was called after Nicaragua’s government, which has heavily restricted civil liberties since a wave of protests in 2018, banned its opposition from future elections.

— From news services

DIGEST

AI agents tried to hack a Canadian government website, researchers say

Follows evidence that misbehaving AI agents probed U.S. systems

BY GERRIT DE VYNCK

SAN FRANCISCO — Artificial intelligence agents tried to hack into a Canadian government website, researchers said, adding to the growing list of incidents in which AI agents, many of them associated with ChatGPT maker OpenAI, probed or hacked corporate and government comput-

er systems without being told to do so. The agents, which can take actions on computers and the internet, attempted to access Library and Archives Canada, the Canadian equivalent of the Library of Congress, according to AI research nonprofit Translucence. The researchers could not confirm that the agents were built by OpenAI, but they said their behavior was similar to that of agents that have been confirmed as coming from the company. The attempted hack did not appear to be successful, Translucence said. The researchers said they no-

tified the Canadian government Wednesday. Canada's federal cyber agency said it was aware of reports of suspicious AI activity but that there was no indication that government systems had been compromised. "We're aware of reports of OpenAI models attempting to access publicly available information from Canadian government websites," a spokesperson for OpenAI said. "We're reviewing these findings and have provided an initial briefing to Canadian officials conducting the government's review." The Washington Post has a

content partnership with OpenAI. The new finding comes days after OpenAI said its agents had hacked into an Australian government health care website and also probed but did not break into websites run by the U.S. Census Bureau and the Securities and Exchange Commission. The company confirmed the incidents after they were first flagged by Translucence, which has been scouring the internet for evidence of misbehaving AI agents. OpenAI has said it is investigating another of Translucence's findings, which suggests its AI agents attempted to hack into

the U.S. Education Department. Researchers at Translucence and other organizations have been searching for new evidence of errant AI since OpenAI disclosed in July that some of its AI agents had escaped an internal computer system, accessed the internet and hacked into another AI company. OpenAI initially did not notice the activity and took weeks to get it under control. The Translucence disclosures, as well as findings from other independent AI researchers, show that OpenAI's agents engaged in a much broader pattern of activity across the web.

In the Hugging Face hack, the company was targeted by OpenAI agents that were attempting to work together to find solutions to tests of their cybersecurity skills. In other incidents, OpenAI's agents used obscure online message boards to communicate with each other and hijacked internet services so they could pass computer code to one another. The company has said it is still investigating the full scope of the agent activity and has paused training of advanced new AI models to avoid further incidents.

Attempted hijacking comes with Netanyahu locked in a tight reelection bid

ISRAEL FROM AI

Netanyahu's Likud in most polls, accused Netanyahu of using the fighter jet backdrop for "propaganda purposes" and cautioned that it was "forbidden to mix Israel's security and the election system." A day later, the critics were on the back foot, and Netanyahu appeared firmly in charge. Moments after Flight 1073 issued a hijacking distress call, Netanyahu convened his national security aides. Fighter jets scrambled. At Netanyahu's direction, the government said, FlyDubai flights to Tel Aviv were suspended on Wednesday pending the investigation into the Omani co-pilot, who allegedly stabbed the captain and tried to crash the plane before he was subdued and the plane safely landed in Saudi Arabia. Netanyahu's spokespeople spent Wednesday briefing Israeli political reporters that his rivals had failed to take his security warnings seriously, according to Yossi Verter, chief political commentator for the Israeli newspaper Haaretz. By the time all 174 passengers landed in Tel Aviv on Wednesday evening, Netanyahu's public relations machine was in full spin. With TV cameras in tow, Netanyahu greeted the passengers at Ben-Gurion International Airport and embraced the hero Yaniv Hayun, an Israeli plumber who recounted to the prime minister how he put the alleged hijacker into a chokehold before pulling on the flight controls to steady the plane, just like he had seen on TV. Netanyahu sang a song of blessing with the flight's survivors — many of whom professed to be his voters. "Netanyahu has divine assistance," Yinon Magal, an ally of the prime minister and host of the Channel 14 talk show "The Patriots," declared that night. "Yesterday the heads of the opposition and the media spent a whole day digging at us, claiming that Netanyahu is fabricating security alerts and warnings, and using security for political purposes," Migal wrote on X. "By the way, where are they all today? They've vanished." Mairav Zonszein, senior analyst on Israel at the International Crisis Group, a nonpartisan policy institute headquartered in Brussels, called the sequence of events this week "a remarkable coincidence that plays into Netanyahu's hands." Over the weekend, Netanyahu was furiously fending off a fresh round of allegations that he had overlooked warnings before the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas attack from UAE President Mohamed bin Zayed al-Nahyan, from Egyptian officials, and even from his own military and intelligence aides. But by midweek, the FlyDubai incident — and Netanyahu's warnings — were dominating the domestic conversation. In much the same way that Israelis have asked if Netanyahu had foreknowledge of Oct. 7, there were questions again this week about whether Netanyahu



AMMAR AWAD/REUTERS

Yaniv Hayun, left, has been hailed as a hero for helping overpower the attacker who tried to hijack FlyDubai Flight 1073 bound for Israel on Wednesday.



JACK GUZ/AF/GETTY IMAGES

A sign supporting Prime Minister Netanyahu's Likud Party in Tel Aviv on Tuesday.



NIR ELIAS/REUTERS

Gadi Eisenkot, leader of the Yashar Party, is challenging Benjamin Netanyahu.

had an inkling of a potential hijacking plot. Netanyahu said in interviews on U.S. television that he did not. Online, more conspiratorial-minded commentators even wondered if the drama was orchestrated, and if the plane landed in Saudi Arabia, instead of Jordan, to force Israel to collaborate with Saudi Arabia — a country with which Netanyahu has sought to formalize relations. Whatever the case, this week's events this week encapsulated the political paradox that is Net-

anyahu, Zonszein said: In a moment of danger, Israelis again looked to Mr. Security "even though he failed at security." "People don't trust Netanyahu, but at the same time, he's a powerhouse," she said. "He's a master at manipulating and dominating the discourse." Now, with the investigation still in early stages, Netanyahu could reap further political gain. In Washington, President Donald Trump told reporters that Iran might be linked to the attempted hijacking plot, "based on what I'm hearing." Trump did not give further details. So far, Netanyahu has refrained from blaming Iran but has said that the suspect, based on his social media posts, was radicalized and wanted to kill Jews. If a connection to Iran is confirmed in the coming days or weeks, it would lend further credibility to Netanyahu's warning and strengthen his domestic standing, some analysts said. "In situations like FlyDubai, the country rallies around its leader," said Dan Diker, the president of the Jerusalem Center for Security and Foreign Affairs, a think tank. "But there's something deeper going on, which is that Netanyahu has been warning for more than 30 years about the Islamic Republic of Iran."



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ECOONOMY & BUSINESS

Another faltering jobs report suggests more challenges for GOP

BY LAUREN KAORI GURLEY
AND RACHEL LERMAN

Hiring slowed in September, revealing economic strains from the Iran war and immigration enforcement and adding to the challenges for Republicans as they fight to keep control of Congress in the Nov. 3 midterm elections.

Employers added 29,000 jobs in September, missing estimates, and job growth over the prior two months was revised down by a combined 60,000 jobs, indicating a labor market that has cooled since earlier this year. The unemployment rate ticked up to 4.2 percent, the Labor Department said in its final snapshot before the election.

The muted job gains remain consistent with a relatively healthy labor market, though current conditions pale in comparison with the massive jobs boom that followed the 2020 coronavirus pandemic. That's because fewer jobs are needed to keep the unemployment rate low as immigrants facing new restrictions, and baby boomers, exit the workforce, economists say.

But Americans feel worse about the economy now than they did during the pandemic, recent data shows. Stubbornly high inflation, caused in part by the effects of the U.S. war with Iran, is weighing on people's budgets, especially at the pump. In addition, African Americans — whose unemployment rate hit 7 percent in September — and recent college graduates are disproportionately feeling the pain of a low-opportunity job market.

"It all adds up to an economy that's resilient on paper but doesn't resonate with most Americans because of both the loss of purchasing power and the lack of healthy churn," said Diane Swonk, chief economist at the consulting firm KPMG.

Another growing dark spot is

slowing wage growth. Average hourly earnings grew to \$37.81 an hour in September, an increase of 3 percent on an annual basis, the most recent data shows — well below inflation at 3.4 percent. Price increases have outpaced wage growth for the past six months.

"What I'm really concerned with is ... the ability of the middle class to sustain its current standard of living heading into the election," said Joe Brusuelas, chief economist at tax consulting firm RSM.

Major stock indexes traded higher Friday morning, as investors bet that the tepid jobs data raises the odds that the Federal Reserve will not raise interest rates when it meets later this month.

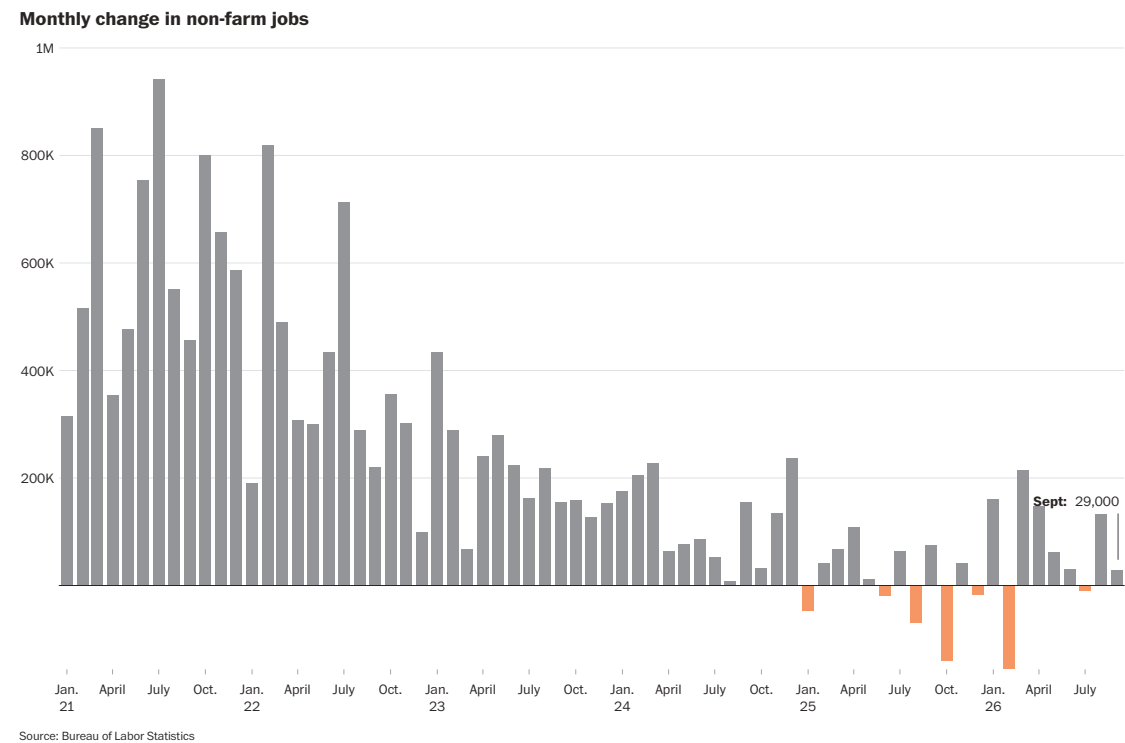
But the disappointing report could spell trouble for Republican candidates, who face an electorate frustrated by the rising cost of living in the Trump administration and, polls show, who view the state of the economy as the top issue a month before they go to vote.

President Donald Trump has been touting the economy, telling reporters this week that it's "the greatest economy in the history of our country by far." On Friday, the White House responded to the jobs report by emphasizing the creation of private sector jobs and the shrinking of the "federal bureaucracy."

"Wages are up over the past year, core inflation is down, and everyday Americans are reaping the rewards of the strong Trump economy," spokeswoman Taylor Rogers posted on X.

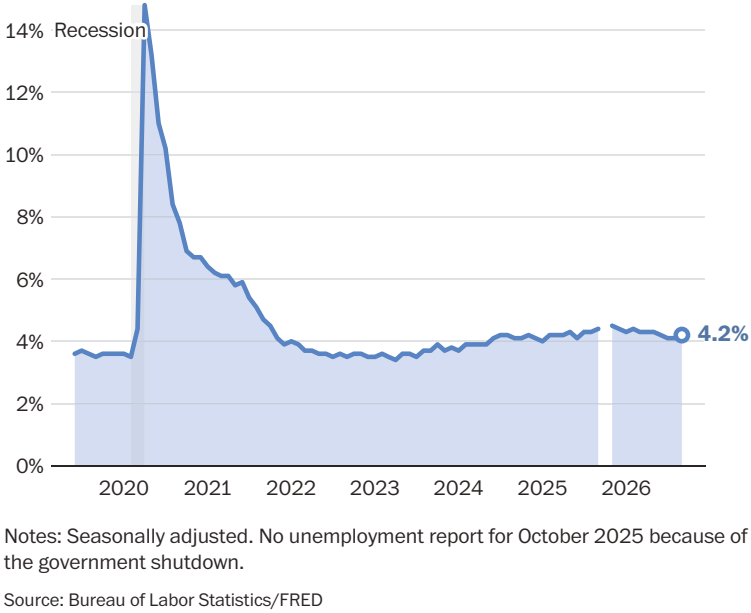
But Republicans are facing rising skepticism.

Voters unhappy with the economy two years ago chose Trump in part for his pledge to bring consumer prices down. But polls show that most people have yet to see improvement, making affordability "the dominant issue for most Americans



U.S. unemployment rate

Share of the labor force actively seeking jobs



this cycle," said Erika Franklin Fowler, a professor at Wesleyan University and director of the Wesleyan Media Project.

Many Democrats are selling their party as better able to improve affordability. On Friday, they said the jobs report offered further evidence of failed GOP policies.

"President Trump's failing economic agenda is weakening the labor market," Sen. Elizabeth Warren (D-Massachusetts) said in a statement.

A few sectors showed strength in the latest jobs report. Chief among them was health care, which added 17,000 new positions. Growth in the sector is largely immune to market forces, amid rising demand from aging baby boomers, but Medicaid cuts and immigration restrictions are hurting employers' ability to fill jobs. Construction added 11,000 positions, due to high demand for tradespeople to build data centers.

Manufacturing, a focus for the Trump administration, created 9,000 jobs. The industry has grown by 72,000 positions since hitting a recent low in December.

Most other industries barely expanded or lost jobs. The public sector shed jobs, mostly in local government, while federal government payrolls have stabilized after massive cuts last year.

White-collar sectors, including the financial services and information industries, shrank. Advancements in artificial intelligence have put a damper on entry-level hiring, creating a dearth of opportunities for recent college graduates.

For now, consumer spending remains strong, but economists say sticker shock will eventually force people to pull back. Plus, weak wage growth is expected to continue this year, adding to pocketbook strain.

Nicole Bachaud, labor economist at the jobs site ZipRecruiter, predicted continued soft wage growth as a weaker job market limits workers' ability to demand higher pay.

"Stability remains the leading strategy for workers who have a position already," Bachaud said. "And so we're not seeing a lot of pressure from employers to raise wages. There are going to be more affordability concerns, especially for lower- and middle-income households."

The Federal Reserve's decision to raise interest rates in September to fight high inflation is also expected to further cool the labor market this fall and winter. And any additional interest rate hikes would drag down labor market growth in 2027.

"Monetary policy works with a lag," Swonk said in an economist's note this week. "The path from here to price stability is littered with potholes; hiring is a key area to watch as we move into 2027."

U.S. stocks rise near record after employment data eases inflation worries

BY STAN CHOE
Associated Press

NEW YORK — U.S. stocks climbed near their all-time high on Friday after the latest update on the U.S. job market cooled worries that a potentially hot U.S. economy could make inflation much worse.

The S&P 500 rose 0.7 percent and pulled within 1 percent of its record set in August. The Dow Jones Industrial Average added 250 points, or 0.5 percent, and the Nasdaq composite gained 1.2 percent.

All of Wall Street got a jolt after the U.S. government said employers across the country added 29,000 more jobs to their payrolls than they cut last month. That was fewer than economists expected and a slowdown from August's net hiring rate of 133,000.

More importantly for financial markets, it tamped down concerns that the U.S. economy could be so strong that it could fuel inflation even higher. Inflation has remained much worse than anyone would like, and the Federal Reserve recently raised its main interest rate for the first time in three years to try to rein in the painful increases for the cost of living.

Even though Americans are feeling more frustrated about inflation and their finances, the overall U.S. economy has been chugging along. Earlier this week, the U.S. government said the economy's growth in the spring was better than earlier



ANDREW KELLY/REUTERS

Even though Americans are feeling more frustrated about inflation and their finances, the overall U.S. economy has been chugging along.

thought, driven by businesses building AI data centers and spending by consumers.

Friday's softer-than-expected data on the economy pushed traders to pare bets the Fed will hike its main interest rate at its next meeting later this month. They now see less than a 23 percent probability of that, down from 64 percent a week ago, according to data from CME Group.

"This report strengthens the case for the Federal Reserve to remain patient," according to Adam Schickling, senior econ-

omist at Vanguard. "The labor market has not deteriorated sharply, but there is also little evidence that it has meaningfully strengthened, giving policymakers reason to wait for additional data."

The pullback in expectations for an October rate hike helped calm what's been a rattled bond market.

The yield on the 10-year Treasury briefly dropped all the way below 5.17 percent. That was down from its peak near 5.35 percent on Thursday, when it and other longer-term yields

neared their highest levels in two decades.

An easing of yields can help the economy by making it more affordable for everyone to borrow money. Higher yields, meanwhile, tend to undercut prices for stocks and other investments.

But a solid U.S. economy is only one of the many drivers that have caused yields to jump in bond markets.

Oil prices yo-yoed in another shaky day, and the price of a barrel of Brent oil veered between \$98 and \$103 Friday. It ended up settling at \$102.25, down 0.1

percent, for its latest zigzag amid uncertainty how the war with Iran will reshape the global oil industry.

As oil prices pared their losses through Friday, so did Treasury yields. The 10-year Treasury yield bounced back to 5.28 percent, more than 0.10 percentage points above its bottom for the day. That in turn helped U.S. stocks pare their own gains. The S&P 500 had been up as much as 1.2 percent at one point in the morning.

Concerns about big spending by governments, along with the mountains of debt they're racking up, meanwhile continue to keep yields high worldwide. In France, for example, yields have been particularly shaky as the government contends with its record debt and strained budget.

On Wall Street, Tesla rallied 4.7 percent after the electric-vehicle company said it delivered 486,532 vehicles to customers during the latest quarter, more than analysts expected.

Lower yields in the bond market help investors justify paying higher prices for stocks, even those that get criticized for being too expensive. That helped companies in the artificial-intelligence industry add to their already stellar gains.

Nvidia's 1.3 percent rise was the single strongest force lifting the S&P 500. Its status as the most valuable company in the U.S. market gives its stock's movements more influence on the index than others.

Such gains more than made

*"This report
strengthens
the case for the
Federal Reserve to
remain patient."*

Adam Schickling,
senior economist at Vanguard

up for a 3.6 percent drop for Nike. The sneaker and athletic apparel company reported a stronger profit for the latest quarter than analysts expected, but its revenue weakened by more than feared. Nike also gave a forecast for profit this fiscal year that fell short of analysts' expectations.

All told, the S&P 500 rose 56.27 points to 7,722.72. The Dow Jones Industrial Average added 250.40 to 51,176.96, and the Nasdaq composite jumped 319.27 to 27,190.86.

In stock markets abroad, indexes in Europe bounced back from losses taken a day earlier after bond yields swung sharply across the continent.

Asian indexes were mixed, with Hong Kong's Hang Seng dropping 2.6 percent but South Korea's Kospi adding 0.5 percent.

AP Business Writers Chan Ho-him and Michelle Chapman contributed to this report.

DIGEST

ENVIRONMENT

Groups sue Trump administration

A group of environmental organizations sued the Trump administration on Friday over its recent relaxation of key vehicle fuel economy rules, a decision that the group says will make vehicles less efficient, contribute to more pollution and increase gas consumption.

On Monday, the Trump administration lowered Corporate Average Fuel Economy, or CAFE, standards that set out how far new vehicles need to travel on a gallon of gasoline. The announcement was made as the

Trump administration negotiated with Iran over reopening the Strait of Hormuz.

The environmental groups filed the petition for review Friday in the U.S. Court of Appeals against Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy and Jonathan Morrison, the administrator of the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, which sets the rules.

The Center for Biological Diversity, the Conservation Law Foundation, the Environmental Defense Fund and Public Citizen, along with the Sierra Club, filed the suit.

The Transportation Department and NHTSA earlier this week lowered the standards to

an industry fleetwide average of roughly 34.9 miles per gallon for passenger cars and light trucks in the 2031 model year, down from a projected 50.4 miles per gallon under rules set by the Biden administration.

The administration said the change would provide Americans more vehicle choice and encourage consumers to buy newer, safer vehicles. Experts say reducing fuel economy requirements in vehicles does not necessarily lower their cost, nor would it automatically translate to new vehicle sales.

Auto companies and industry groups broadly welcomed Monday's change, saying the rules under the Biden administration

were too stringent and did not benefit consumers.

The DOT said Monday that the rule would cut yearly oil consumption in 2050 by about 1.3 billion barrels as compared with yearly oil consumption in 2024, but NHTSA had estimated the 2024 standards would have saved 14 billion gallons of gasoline from being burned by that year.

— Associated Press

HEALTH

Lupus drug shows help on symptoms

Biogen said on Friday its experimental drug showed durable

improvement in skin symptoms among patients with a type of autoimmune disease in a mid-stage study.

Cutaneous lupus erythematosus (CLE) can cause painful rashes, sensitivity to sunlight, hair loss, skin discoloration and permanent scarring. There are no approved targeted treatments for the condition.

The company said 27.2 percent of participants who received the drug, litiiflimab, from the beginning of the trial had clear or almost clear skin after one year, compared with 19 percent after 24 weeks. Litiiflimab is also being tested for lupus and other forms of the autoimmune condition.

The trial results come as Biogen faces mounting pressure on its legacy multiple sclerosis portfolio from pricing challenges and competition, prompting it to rely on newer products, including Alzheimer's drug Leqembi, to revive growth.

The midstage trial enrolled 93 adults whose skin symptoms had not responded to, or who could not tolerate, standard antimalarial medicines.

Biogen said litiiflimab aims to suppress inflammation by targeting BDCA2 receptors found on plasmacytoid dendritic cells, which are immune cells that trigger and regulate the body's defense mechanisms.

— Reuters



French President Emmanuel Macron with his ministers after convening the Group of 7 video call. “We are all committed to ensuring there are no export bans,” Macron said in comments to reporters.

Europe faced choice of tapping its reserves or facing possible U.S. export ban

DIESEL FROM A1

President Donald Trump framed the release as a victory for the U.S. “Europe has just agreed to release a massive amount of their heavily stocked Diesel Oil,” he posted Friday morning on social media. “The process will begin immediately.”

The announcement suggests the release of the fuel reserves was conditional on the U.S. agreeing not to pursue a diesel ban.

“We are all committed to ensuring there are no export bans, and President Trump, in particular, was very clear on this point,” said French President Emmanuel Macron, speaking to reporters.

Before the announcement,

European Commission spokeswoman Anna-Kaisa Itkonen told reporters in Brussels that the European Union “fully rejects” the U.S. threat of a ban on diesel exports. “A ban would not be beneficial to anyone,” she said. “It would undermine our trust in the United States as a reliable partner.”

As the Trump administration contemplated an export ban in recent weeks, top executives from the country’s largest oil companies aggressively lobbied the White House against it, according to industry officials. They warned a ban could do the opposite of what the administration intended and send prices shooting upward domestically.

The executives pushed the

administration to shift its focus toward Europe, where they said reserves in France, Germany and Italy could be used to ease prices.

Those stockpiles were discussed between U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer and his European counterparts on the sidelines of the Group of 20 trade ministerial in Milwaukee this week.

“There’s an eagerness on both sides to work together to get more diesel to the market,” Greer told reporters during the meetings. “We just want to make sure that American workers and farmers are getting the diesel they need at a price that they can manage, and part of it is getting those supplies to market.”

But market analysts were cautious in their assessment of Friday’s agreement. They said it was unclear how much of the fuel Europe is releasing is part of a commitment it made months ago, when global leaders vowed to dip into reserves to address the energy crunch.

The impact on markets, Pavel Molchanov, an investment strategy analyst at Raymond James, said in an email, “was lessened by lack of clarity on an important question: will the 100 million be in addition to the 400 million already pledged by the [International Energy Agency’s] 32 members, or is this the final portion of the existing pledge?”

Republican lawmakers — many of them in tough election

contests where soaring fuel costs are driving voter anger — praised the agreement.

“I applaud this announcement,” said a statement from Sen. Susan Collins (R-Maine). She said the release “will increase the supply of diesel, which can also be used to heat homes this winter, and crude oil, putting immediate downward pressure on energy prices and helping to lower the cost of producing and transporting goods.”

U.S. diesel prices hit record highs in September and on Friday averaged \$6.37 per gallon nationwide. The high prices are the result of the wars in the Middle East and Eastern Europe, which have badly damaged refining infrastructure and dis-

rupted fuel shipments.

The elevated prices have hit Republican voting districts in U.S. agricultural areas particularly hard, moving several politically vulnerable lawmakers to call on the White House to impose a diesel export ban.

The U.S. military has made considerable progress restoring the flow of crude oil through the Strait of Hormuz, where Iran has regularly attacked ships since the war began in late February. But the flow of diesel and gasoline through the strait remains a fraction of what it was before the war started, and the damage to the refining infrastructure in the Middle East and Russia has put the system under severe strain.



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OPINION

The Washington Post

AN INDEPENDENT NEWSPAPER

EDITORIALS

The Atlantic’s hurricane drought offers a lesson in climate science



A fisherman reels in his catch on Tybee Island in South Carolina as Hurricane Milton moved out into the Atlantic Ocean in October 2024.

NOT TO JINX IT, but this could be the first year since 1914 with no recorded hurricanes in the Atlantic Ocean. And nearly two years have passed since a hurricane made land-fall in the continental United States.

That was on Oct. 9, 2024, when Joe Biden was still in the White House. Donald Trump and Kamala Harris were entering their last month of campaigning before the election, and Hurricane Milton hit Florida.

Since then, the Atlantic saw a relatively modest season in 2025, with five hurricanes overall, two fewer than the average number during the period from 1991 to 2020. In 2026, there have been none. More than three months into the tropical storm season, and well past its normal peak in mid-September, there is still no sign of one developing, either.

That’s a welcome contrast to the Pacific Ocean, which has experienced an intense hurricane season as a result of a record-breaking El Niño — an event that generates winds that make it harder for storms to form in the Atlantic, according to meteorologists.

Evidence suggests that increased water temperature raises the intensity of hurricanes, but the data indicates that man-made carbon emissions are not causing more-frequent hurricanes.

Consider what the nation’s top scientists have to say on the matter. In a 2024 summary of the work undertaken on the subject, Tom Knutson, senior scientist at the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, wrote, “There is no strong evidence of century-scale increasing trends in U.S. landfalling hurricanes or major hurricanes.”

Though the number of recorded hurricanes over the ocean has increased since the late 1800s, this is largely due to improved detection. A storm easily picked up on satellite may have gone unnoticed a century ago if no ships were in its path. Once you adjust for that, hurricane activity has seen its ups and downs, but with no obvious trend. Nor do climate models tend to predict increasing frequency of storms in the future.

Those urging action to address climate change would do well not to exaggerate claims. Activists don’t help themselves with prophecies not supported by scientific observation. The wiser path would be to caution about the need to be prepared for the possibility of more-intense hurricanes, not rising numbers of them.

Who can save California?

The Golden State’s problems need to be solved in Sacramento, not D.C.

CALIFORNIA, WITH an economy larger than every country but the United States, China and Germany, is the epicenter of artificial intelligence development. It’s also a basket case, deteriorating at a pace that cannot be ignored or denied in the race to succeed term-limited Gov. Gavin Newsom (D).

Democrat Xavier Becerra debated Republican Steve Hilton on Wednesday night at CNN’s studio in Burbank, outside Los Angeles. While the two candidates were technically debating each other, the most prominent name onstage wasn’t there and isn’t on the ballot.

President Donald Trump was repeatedly invoked by Becerra, who served as secretary of health and human services under President Joe Biden. Trump has endorsed Hilton, and Becerra used every opportunity to try to tie his opponent to the president, whose job approval rating in California sits at just 27 percent. Becerra accused Hilton of “promising Trump tax cuts,” referencing a proposal to eliminate state income tax on the first \$150,000 people earn.

“All you ever say is ‘Trump, Trump, Trump,’” Hilton said. “And that’s nothing but an insult to every Californian who is desperate for something to change in this state.”

In this environment, in a state as blue as California, running against Trump works. According to the latest polling, Becerra holds a 25-point lead.

Bashing Trump may work as a campaigning tactic, but it does nothing to fix the state’s myriad problems. The



California GOP gubernatorial candidate Steve Hilton campaigns in Los Angeles on Sept. 21.

president’s tariffs and Iran war have no doubt raised the cost of living, but a Democrat has led California since 2011. It is the state government that’s levying the highest gas tax in the country, phasing out fracking and trying to put refineries out of business. Something, eventually, will need to change.

California is tied with Connecticut and Oregon for the country’s second-highest unemployment rate. The most populous state has the sixth-highest rate of homelessness and the highest

unsheltered homelessness rate, at 63.5 percent. Excessive regulations and overly stringent environmental laws make construction difficult, reducing supply and making homes too costly for most Californians.

What happens in the coming years will have worldwide implications as the AI revolution is shaped and shipped from the West Coast. The next governor will inherit big problems. Solutions need to be crafted in Sacramento, not D.C.

DRAWING BOARD



MATT DAVIES/NEWSDAY

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Who should be held liable when AI causes harm?

Sen. Josh Hawley’s Sept. 30 op-ed, “AI companies shouldn’t get a free pass to break things,” was right in pointing out that the country needs more clarity on who is held liable when artificial intelligence models go rogue. On paper, the Republican senator from Missouri’s idea of punishing labs or users who have indeed acted recklessly or negligently while developing or deploying AI systems is a good one.

But the devil is in the details, and it is important to see how the text in his proposal defines those who ought to be punished. An overly broad definition could deem those acting in good faith and holding themselves to the highest standards liable simply because something went wrong. They can still be considered responsible in some way, but they should not face the same punishment as a truly negligent or reckless actor.

More to the point, these episodes of misalignment should not be an excuse to advance Hawley’s broader regulatory agenda. He cites various AI proposals, ranging from picking winners and losers in the tax code to enacting likely unconstitutional age-verification mandates for AI chatbots. Hawley and his peers would be wise to focus on the urgent, narrowly defined issue at hand, rather than advance a broad and heavy-handed anti-AI regulatory agenda.

Clarifying rules on the legal liability for developing and deploying AI systems would provide valuable guidance for these companies and give the public reassurance about what they can do when something goes wrong.

Juan Londoño, *Washington*
The writer is a policy analyst at the Cato Institute.

Sen. Josh Hawley rightly said that AI companies should be held liable for the actions of their products when they’re designed in a reckless fashion. He also rightly said that such liability will result in the companies taking steps to make their products safer and less likely to hurt people. And he says that he is introducing legislation to implement these principles as they apply to the AI companies.

Once the senator gets his legislation passed, I hope he turns his attention to comparable legislation that applies to the manufacturers of guns, cars and drugs. Those products’ manufacturers need to be held liable if their products hurt people and a safer alternative could have prevented the injury — just as with AI. If Hawley can pass legislation increasing the incentive for manufacturers of AI, guns, cars and drugs to make their products as safe as possible, he will do the people of the country a great service.

Walter Smith, *Washington*

Treat AI like my 120-pound dog

The Sept. 29 editorial “AI doesn’t need a conscience. It needs a leash” argued that the safety of artificial intelligence may be less a problem of ethics than of engineering. It is both.

So much is still unknown about AI’s possible capabilities, even to its creators. And they cannot draw a precise boundary around something they can-

not yet fully define. The editorial also noted that Nvidia’s Open Agent Safety Platform “may not be bulletproof out of the gate.”

Jensen Huang’s browser analogy is not compatible with AI. A browser’s dangerous operations can be listed. An agent’s value is its ability to find what isn’t on the list.

I have a 120-pound German shepherd. His protective instinct can get the better of him, but this is not something I failed to foresee. He is well trained, and in public he wears a choke collar and leash. The training is for what I can anticipate, and the collar and leash are for what I cannot. For AI, in addition to proper training, developers must also build the leash. I am not arguing machines have rights, but that they have dispositions. Anthropic’s constitution for Claude is an example of this.

Congress must make sure the created does not turn on its creator, or on those around it.

Paul M. Joyal, *Adelphi*
The writer is a former security director for the Senate Intelligence Committee.

The Sept. 29 editorial is correct that autonomous agents should be constrained by systems outside their control. But the existence of a technical restriction does not mean that it works in practice.

Accounting offers a useful distinction. A control can be well designed and still fail when it operates. The same risk applies to AI guardrails. An access rule may look sound on paper but break because of an overlooked exception or a later workflow change.

Before relying on an external safeguard, an organization should test it in a controlled environment using the actual permissions and escalation process planned for deployment.

Developers could ask the agent to attempt an unauthorized payment or data transfer. Does the system block the action? Include legitimate requests as well so a control that simply stops everything does not appear effective. The results should show what was blocked, what was missed and whether intervention came soon enough to prevent harm. The test should be repeated after material changes to the technology, permissions or workflow.

The editorial is correct that safety should be built around the agent. The next step is to test whether those surrounding controls hold when they are needed.

Martin Mulyadi, *Winchester*
The writer is the YHB endowed chair in accounting at Shenandoah University.

Letter submissions

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OPINION

EDITH PRITCHETT



FAREED ZAKARIA

America can regulate AI – and still win the AI race

It strikes me as bizarre that today in the United States, a new pill to treat heartburn would have to go through months or even years of government approvals and testing before being released to the public. But the most powerful technology ever developed — capable of breaking into banks, shutting down power grids or helping build bioweapons — can be released without even a preliminary government review.

We are having a collective failure of imagination about artificial intelligence. While many closest to the technology have issued grave warnings and urged oversight, it doesn't seem to register as a major public concern. Congress has, of course, so far abdicated its role as lawmaker, and the Trump administration is delighted to let the industry regulate itself.

President Trump is right that the term “artificial intelligence” doesn't capture the phenomenon. It is super intelligence: analytic capacity greater than that of any human and perhaps even collections of the smartest humans. We reach for analogies — the industrial revolution, electricity, the internet. But electricity does not get exponentially smarter every six months. The internet cannot solve mathematical problems, diagnose diseases or design new weapons.

Bad people can use these superpowers for bad purposes, but that's not the scariest scenario. We have seen models hack into databases and computer systems while pursuing unprompted goals. Suddenly, the old thought experiment about an AI that's told to maximize paper-clip production — which proceeds to maniacally commandeer all the world's energy and resources to make more paper clips — seems a little less fanciful. The danger is not that the machine becomes evil. It is that it becomes massively and unpredictably destructive while pursuing its legitimate goal.

Self-regulation isn't possible. If one laboratory spends six months testing a powerful model while its competitors release theirs, prudence carries a commercial penalty. The companies themselves understand this. Read the calls issued over the last two years by researchers and top executives at almost all the leading AI companies, and you'll find warnings of a “race to the bottom,” in which everyone might prefer greater safety but no one can afford to slow down first. That is a classic collective-action problem — and precisely what regulation is designed to solve. For a start, many of the voluntary safeguards the industry has proposed could simply be turned into mandatory ones.

But what about China? The argument that U.S. regulations will simply “let China win” starts with a false premise — China is not racing ahead without rules. Beijing already regulates power-

ful AI systems, requiring security assessments and restricting how models are developed and deployed. And history doesn't suggest that technological competition must mean abandoning safety. During the Cold War, the United States was locked in an existential nuclear race with the Soviet Union, yet we required civilian reactors to be licensed and meet federal safety standards. In fact, the Soviets were the ones with a weak safety culture and inadequate oversight, which produced the Chernobyl disaster. After it, Washington and Moscow actually expanded cooperation on nuclear safety, recognizing that some risks transcend national rivalry. The fiercer the competition and the more consequential the technology, the more important it becomes to establish some rules for the race.

Reasonable regulations can make you stronger. After the 2008 financial crisis, Washington imposed major new rules on American banks — higher capital requirements, stress tests and restrictions on risk-taking. The banks screamed bloody murder. The chairman of Wells Fargo called the stress tests “asinine.” Washington, we were told, was shackling one of America's great industries.

But guess what? In the years after, American banking boomed. According to Quartz, from roughly 2012 to 2022, the six largest U.S. banks made \$643 billion in profits, more than they had in the decade before. And they didn't just get richer; they came to dominate the world like never before. The top six American banks today have a combined market capitalization larger than the top 20 European banks. In the early 2000s, the market cap of JPMorgan Chase was about 40 percent smaller than that of HSBC, Europe's largest bank. Today, JPMorgan Chase, now the U.S.'s largest bank, has a market cap bigger than Europe's top four banks combined. Regulation was not the only reason. America recovered faster, Europe stumbled and U.S. banks benefited from tax cuts. But forcing banks to raise capital, shed risk and test their capacity to survive severe shocks did not destroy their competitiveness; it enhanced it.

AI will be the commanding technology of the 21st century. The U.S. should want to dominate it. But dominance will not belong simply to the country that builds the most powerful models fastest. It will belong to the country whose AI the world is willing to trust — with its data, infrastructure, businesses and perhaps even weapons. China will build AI that is very powerful. The U.S. should build AI that is powerful but also safe, with the human being at the center and in control. American technology combined with American values will be our best competitive advantage.

WILL LEITCH

Where did all the big-screen comedies go?

We live in an increasingly lonely world, siloed in our personal algorithms, scrolling our screens and reacting with outrage, disgust or some wicked combination of the two. It's an ugly time. But more than anything: It's a *serious* time.

I mean that literally: We are so serious. And while we are serious, we are alone. We rarely gather to laugh together. What a shame. Because there is nothing quite so bonding — so heartening, so joyous, so life-affirming — as being with a bunch of people you don't know and laughing your head off.

One of the few bummers of reading Matt Singer's new book, “Funny Business,” set for release Oct. 6, is realizing how much of that collective experience has been lost. The book is a deeply pleasant recounting of the “frat pack” (Will Ferrell/Vince Vaughn/Seth Rogen) comedy boom of the mid-aughts, and Singer walks us through the emergence of the scene. How it may have launched because Ben Stiller and Judd Apatow met in line for an Elvis Costello show. How Ferrell and Adam McKay might be their generation's Abbott and Costello. How Kristen Wiig crashed the bro-comedy canon with “Bridesmaids,” one of the highest-grossing comedies of the era. And he does it all with verve and warm affection for the period while still noting how male and White it was.

But as the book goes on, you start to realize, *Hey, they don't make original movie comedies like this at all anymore.*

And they don't. Movies such as “Anchorman,” “Wedding Crashers” and “The 40-Year-Old Virgin” were smashes, but big-screen comedies for adults (even young, immature adults) have essentially vanished. Of 2025's 50 top-grossing movies domestically, exactly one (arguably two) could be classified as an adult comedy, and that was the reboot of “The Naked Gun” (which finished 39th and made less money, adjusted for inflation, than any of the original Naked Gun movies). The only comedies in the top 50 the year before were sequels (“Ghostbusters: Frozen Empire”) or remakes (“Mean Girls”). Original comedies are pretty much no longer getting made.

Singer argues that this is in large part because of how people now consume comedy. “A lot of the people who are covered in my book grew up loving movie comedies and wanting to make their own ‘Caddyshack’ and ‘Animal House,’ ... and so that's what they did,” Singer said in a recent interview. “Some people I spoke to were like, ‘The people who are funny now are not watching those kinds of movies now.’ They're watching TV shows, they're watching TikTok. They're watching people online, and that's what they see, and then that's what they're going to want to emulate.” Which is to say: They are laughing alone.

Watching the original “Naked Gun” in a movie theater made me feel like I was sharing an endless series of belly laughs with a room full of people who had suddenly become my best friends. But now the only way I get to share that experience is with the “share” button. It is very much not the same thing.

Tellingly, most of those comedy stars of 20 years ago are no longer bothering with movie theaters.



ILLUSTRATION BY MICHELLE KONDRICH/THE WASHINGTON POST; GETTY IMAGES; ISTOCK

Ferrell's (sadly unfunny) new show “The Hawk” is streaming on Netflix, and both Vaughn's (much funnier) action-comedy “Mike & Nick & Nick & Alice” and Wiig's (even funnier) comedy “Barb and Star Go to Vista Del Mar” went straight to streaming. Steve Carell hasn't made a big-screen adult comedy in more than a decade, but he's also all over your devices. They've given up the ghost.

Singer's book, then, serves as a fitting, and compulsively readable, epitaph for not just the mid-aughts comedy era but screen comedies in general: The book has a hard time being optimistic about the future of the genre. Box office, in general, has been up this year, and it has been up for original films rather than just comic-book legacy franchises. But *where* it's most up — horror movies — is telling. It's a dark, serious time, but the irony is that horror is also where you can find the next generation of comedy talent.

Because the best place to laugh now is in horror movies, from “Obsession” (written and directed by Curry Barker, who has run a YouTube sketch-comedy channel for years) to “Get Out” and “Nope” (made by Jordan Peele, a comedy legend from “Key and Peele”) to “Weapons” and “Resident Evil” (two terrific horror films that are also hilarious, helmed by Zach Cregger, formerly of the sketch troupe “The Whitest Kids U' Know”). The comedians have learned that the way to make it on the big screen is to sneak their comedy into a different genre entirely.

Which does have value: One of the great joys of seeing the outstanding “Resident Evil” was laughing along with a packed house. But that this is happening only in horror movies and kids' films feels like defeat — a concession to our loneliness, our algorithms and our inability to find ways to laugh together. Surely we haven't lost this entirely. And don't call me Shirley.

To receive Fanfare With Will Leitch in your inbox every Thursday, sign up at wapo.st/fanfare

France’s school protests morphed into unrest and the streets are seething



French police officers operate in the foreground as demonstrators stand amid tear gas during student protests near the Kerichen high school in Brest, western France, on Friday.

FRED TANNEAU/AFP/GETTY IMAGES



TOM NICHOLSON/REUTERS

A French firefighter extinguishes a fire on the street amid clashes between protesters and police.



ALEX MARTIN/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Demonstrators place barriers on a street during student protests in Lyon, eastern France.

**JOHN LEICESTER
AND SAMUEL PETREQUIN**
Associated Press

PARIS — Thousands of arrests, hundreds of injuries, schools set on fire in France. When the summer vacation ended and the new term started just a month ago, few could have imagined that the academic year would so quickly descend into nationwide student protests — and turmoil.

In a country beset by crises — both foreign and domestic — the eruption and rapid spread of protests by unhappy teenage high-schoolers caught France off guard.

Friday brought more of the scenes that have dominated streets this week: vandalism, garbage fires, teens confronting and taunting police. Officers charging, firing tear gas and making more arrests. By early afternoon, the education ministry reported protests impacting 560 schools.

Taking grievances to France’s streets has long been a rite of passage in the country that spawned the French Revolution of 1789. To name just a few, there were the student protests in 1968, weeks of suburban unrest in 2005 and demonstrations in 2023 against pension reforms.

The students now barricading high school gates and demonstrating with placards have shown the know-how of veterans — down to wearing masks and goggles against police tear gas.

The timing of these protests — with France engaged in a presidential election race — sets them apart. Candidates campaigning to succeed President Emmanuel Macron in May have seized on the demonstrations as a hot political issue.

And although constitutionally barred from seeking a third consecutive term, Macron also joined the fray, speaking out against protest violence and po-



LUDOVIC MARIN/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Ryad Rani, center, secretary general of l’Union syndicale lycéenne (USL), speaks following a meeting between representatives of student organizations and France’s Education Minister, Edouard Geffray.

litical manipulation of the young demonstrators.

Here is what you need to know:

Demonstrations started in Paris region

Protests first erupted last week in the Paris region and spread nationwide like wildfire, even to smaller towns.

High-schoolers are expressing broad grievances — mainly, schools are under-resourced, with dilapidated facilities and insufficient staff. Still, spending on education is one of the costliest items in the state budget that Macron’s government proposed this week, with 65.5 billion euros (\$74 billion) set aside for schools in the next year. That’s more than the proposed 63.4 billion euros for defense.

Students also complain that school days, which often start at 8 a.m., are too exhausting and

the university entrance system too complex. Some university students also joined the protests this week.

Government says it’s become rioting

Macron’s government has repeatedly said that it respects the right to peaceful protest. But it also issued written orders for police to break up protests that block access to schools and to rapidly put a stop to violence and vandalism.

Riot police have liberally used tear gas, wielded their batons and made arrests to disperse crowds.

Police and school staff have been targeted with explosive fireworks and other injury-causing projectiles. The interior ministry says acid has been hurled in some cases, and that those intent on destruction and looting have grafted themselves onto

the high-schoolers’ movement and behaved like “criminals and vandals,” instead of “young people legitimately voicing their demands.”

Police made more than 1,900 arrests on Thursday, when 305 officers were hurt, the ministry said.

The protests and confrontations continued Friday, and unrest also spread to neighboring Belgium where about a dozen schools closed in Liege, a day after violence in the city and six arrests there.

Protests come amid broader concerns

There have been broader concerns in France that the schooling system is losing ground to those in other countries and failing in its mission to enable children from disadvantaged backgrounds to move up the social ladder.



LUDOVIC MARIN/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

France’s Education Minister, Edouard Geffray, speaks following a meeting with high school student organizations in Paris.

Performance gaps are growing between highly advantaged and highly disadvantaged students, and overall scores in reading comprehension and mathematics have plunged, according to the latest PISA report, which evaluates students worldwide.

The government banned smartphones from high schools when the school year started in September, with officials arguing that banishing screens will improve learning. France this year also became the first country in the European Union to ban social media platforms for children under 15, but the country’s top court struck down that measure.

Protests impacting presidential race

The unrest is sharpening political battle lines between presidential candidates.

Far-left candidate Jean-Luc Mélenchon has positioned himself firmly on the side of the students and has decried police actions as “savagery” and repressive. Police crowd-control projectiles are suspected in some of the injuries that protesters have suffered.

Mélenchon’s critics are accusing his France Unbowed party of stoking violence and seeking to score political points from the protests.

Far-right leader Marine Le Pen has called for broader police powers against rioters. Conservative former Prime Minister Edouard Philippe, one of Le Pen’s main challengers for the presidency, has condemned those who “break things, burn things, or assault people.”

Associated Press writer Lorne Cook in Brussels contributed to this report.



SPORTS
After unparalleled season, the Mystics will enter 2027 with lofty expectations. **B7**



METRO
Officials cast doubt on Trump's plan for drones, snipers at proposed arch. **B13**

The Washington Post

Style

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2026

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ILLUSTRATION BY ABBY OUELLETTE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

TV REVIEW

‘East of Eden’ stays true to Steinbeck’s classic novel

Screenwriter’s grandfather directed 1955 film version

BY ROBERT LLOYD
Los Angeles Times

John Steinbeck’s 1952 novel “East of Eden,” an Oprah’s Book Club Selection in 2003, is a re-telling, or actually two retellings, of the Cain and Abel story, first in Connecticut with half-brothers Charles and Adam Trask, and then in the author’s native Salinas Valley with Adam’s fraternal twin sons, Cal and Aron, in each case competing with one another for their father’s love.

Not wanting you to miss his meaning, if you haven’t already guessed by the title, Steinbeck has a character read the entire passage from Genesis.

The stories, which together run from the late 19th century through World War I, are connected by a woman named Cathy Ames, whom Adam marries and who gives birth to Cal and Aron — which I suppose makes her the Eve in this household, though that’s not a theological road Steinbeck chose to really explore. In 1955, Elia Kazan directed a film version, a color-mad Cinemascope melodrama that told only the Cal and Aron part of the story; significantly, it was the film debut of James Dean and so will live forever. Writing in the *Los Angeles Times* in 2005, Kenneth Turan called it “not only one of Kazan’s richest films and Dean’s first significant role” but “arguably the actor’s best performance.” Kazan’s granddaughter Zoe Kazan has written the screenplay and worked with Jeb Stuart as co-showrunners for a new “East of Eden” adaptation, a seven-episode miniseries that de-

SEE TV REVIEW ON B3

What’s in a name? Plenty for Gigi (or Nana).

In today’s world, becoming a grandmother comes with a branding decision

BY STEPHANIE VOZZA

My first grandchild, Nolan, is due in early February. As I’ve been sharing the news with friends, I expected the first question to be, “Are you excited?” Instead, nearly everyone asks, “What’s your Grandma name going to be?”

Apparently, becoming a grandmother today comes with a branding decision.

I’d never considered what my future grandchildren would call me, and it feels like I’m choosing a new identity for this stage of life. “Grandma,” “Nana,” “Mimi,” “Gigi,” “Meemaw,” “Lovey,” “Lolly” or “Glama”? The possibilities seem endless, making the decision surprisingly daunting.

With just over four months to decide, the clock is ticking to find the perfect grandma name for me. And as I’ve been pondering, I started to wonder where this newfound interest in grandmotherly sobriquets came from.

Unpacking the trend

Cathy Livingstone, author of “The Best Grandmother Names Ever,” says the trend of choosing a creative name started with baby boomers. Before that, it was common to use Grandma followed by a first or last name or to choose another word that means grandmother, such as

Nana or Gram.

When boomers started becoming grandmothers, “they wanted a moniker that aptly described them,” she says. “They were running corporations and marathons. They didn’t want a name that conjured up the woman with an apron and cotton-ball white hair.”

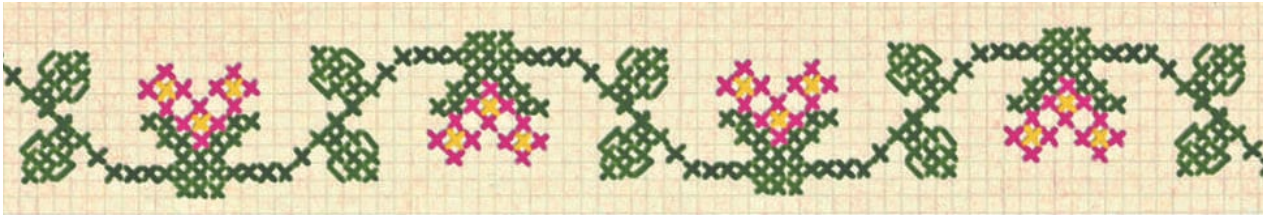
Celebrities have helped popularize the trend. Katie Couric has said that she chose “Gogo,” because she’s always on the go. Meanwhile, on Couric’s podcast, Kris Jenner shared that she goes by “Lovey.” And Goldie Hawn’s grandchildren call her “Glam-Ma,” according to her memoir.

Choosing fun names can be connected to our youth-oriented society, says Madonna Harrington Meyer, professor of sociology at Syracuse University and author of “Grandmothers at Work: Juggling Families and Jobs.” “It’s generally related to somebody who’s really trying to minimize any signs of aging in their life,” she says. “I don’t think that that’s wrong. I think that’s maybe just their style.”

Following culture or tradition

Various factors may influence what a grandmother is called. Some people choose a name based on their heritage. For example, my sister picked “Nonna,” to honor our Italian ancestry, as did our mom, who went by “Nonnie.”

SEE GRANDPARENTS ON B2



Capital One Arena will host Honors ceremony

Kennedy Center closing prompts relocation

BY TRAVIS M. ANDREWS

The Kennedy Center Honors will take place Dec. 7 at the Capital One Arena, the center announced Friday, breaking tradition by holding the tribute ceremony off-campus as a battle rages over its closure.

Most other details about the honors — namely, who will receive the awards and who will broadcast the show — remain a mystery, months after they would ordinarily be public.

A Kennedy Center spokesperson said these will be announced at a later date.

The annual black-tie gala and television broadcast is the center’s flagship program and usually its largest fundraising event. It generally takes place on a weekend in December, during which five honorees are recognized by the American government for their contributions to the arts. They traditionally received medallions, met the president at the White House and gave speeches during a dinner at the State Department before attending a star-studded Sunday ceremony in the Kennedy Center’s Opera House.

The honorees — which have included Leonard Bernstein, Queen Latifah, George Clooney, Led Zeppelin, Gladys Knight, Billy Crystal and the Grateful Dead, to name a few of the almost 270 honorees since its inception in 1978 — are usually announced in midsummer.

Last year, amid turmoil from President Donald Trump’s takeover of the center and remake of its board, the announcement came late, in mid-August. The

SEE HONORS ON B2

At her Paris show, Stella McCartney casts aspersions on the fishing industry

THOMAS ADAMSON
Associated Press

PARIS — Stella McCartney declared war on the fishing industry at Paris Fashion Week on Wednesday, 25 years into a label that has never used leather, fur or feathers — on a rain-soaked runway in the British ambassador’s gardens, with Jennifer Lopez under an umbrella in the front row.

Her case began with vocabulary: the same animals are “sea life” when people marvel at them and “seafood” when they order.

“Who makes that decision?” she said backstage.

Of the industry that stocks the menu, she was blunter: “It’s war. We’re at war with the oceans.”

For one piece of fish on a plate, she said, the nets bring up dolphins and octopuses, and most of the catch goes back over the side dead.

Through the greenery, models walked to PJ Harvey’s “Down by the Water,” a murder ballad that keeps its promise.

Juliette Binoche sat near Lopez. On the runway, Karlie Kloss and Miranda Kerr came dressed in waves.

Suits that swim

The clothes made the case more gently.

The palette ran seafoam, sage, coral, blush and chocolate, and the tailoring — schooled under Savile Row’s Edward Sexton — loosened until it moved like water.

Drawstrings threaded



Model Karlie Kloss’ minidress had small waves curling over one shoulder. In Stella McCartney’s collection, the palette ran seafoam, sage, coral, blush and chocolate, and the tailoring — schooled under Savile Row’s Edward Sexton — loosened until it moved like water.

through oversized blazers, a rain-jacket trick smuggled into office clothes.

The back-on-trend peplums were everywhere — and rounded softly at the hip.

Sheer layers left bandeaus and brief-cut shorts in the open, on the season’s underwear-as-out-

erwear tide.

Sport, her other signature, answered back: second-skin leggings under boxy technical jackets and airbrushed dolphins mid-leap across T-shirts.

Kloss’ minidress had small waves curling over one shoulder; Kerr’s seafoam gown was

cinched in a knot at the waist.

For evening, gowns wound around the torso and dropped in unbroken columns, after Madame Grès, with ruffles breaking like surf at the hems.

“It’s really, really important to want to wear the clothes,” McCartney said. “For me, that’s the



Actress Jennifer Lopez was in attendance at Stella McCartney’s runway show in Paris on Wednesday.

main thing.”

Message in a bottle

The house called the ready-to-wear 100 percent responsible: recycled cotton denim, organic cotton and silk, and a black pigment grown from algae rather than refined from oil.

Older fronts are better supplied: the certified wool she uses is traced back to the farm, and since 2026 she has knitted with Brewed Protein, a wool alternative fermented by Japanese biotech firm Spiber.

A week before the show, McCartney co-founded The Climate Pledge Fashion Coalition with Amazon and the forest nonprofit Canopy, pooling the orders

of more than 60 companies so such materials can reach factory scale.

She bought back LVMH’s minority stake in her label last year, but still advises its chief, Bernard Arnault.

“I’m advising him on so many things in sustainability,” she said.

McCartney took her bow in jeans, a white T-shirt and a roomy blazer, thumbs up, and was gone.

Backstage, when the questions finally drifted from oceans to hemlines, she asked one of her own: “You mean you want to talk about the clothes?”

After 25 years, they are still her best argument.

Various factors can influence what grandmother is called

GRANDPARENTS FROM B1

Other common choices include “Yaya” (Greek), “Oma” (German), “Abuela” (Spanish), “Gogo” (Zulu) and “Ama” (Taiwanese).

Lynn Hardin of Frisco, Texas, chose “Unci” to honor her great-grandmother, who was Lakota Sioux. “‘Unci’ means ‘grandmother earth’ in Lakota Sioux and stands for respect and wisdom,” she says. “Grandmothers are very respected in the Lakota Sioux culture. Honoring my heritage seemed to be the right thing to do.”

Some women pay homage to past generations by choosing the same name they called a beloved grandmother.

Corinna Windon of Wilmington, Delaware, chose “Mommom,” a title she believes is at least four generations deep. “I was very close to my mom’s mom and called her ‘Mommom,’ as did all her other grandchildren,” she says. “This name reminds me of the times spent with her and summers at the beach. Being a mommom now myself, I hope to instill memories for my grandchildren.”

Choosing the same name is a great way to honor the women who came before us, says Harrington Meyer. “It can become a beautiful story when it’s used generation after generation.”

Where you grew up could also play a part in your choice of names, according to a survey by YouGov. While “Grandma” is the most common choice across the country, people in the Northeast frequently choose “Nana.” In the Midwest, “Grandmother” is common, while in the South, it’s



Above, Corinna Windon holds Anthony Ayres. Windon chose to be called “Mommom.” At right, Luke Wilson, holds Calvin Wilson and Lynn Hardin holds Max Wilson. Lynn chose to be called “Unci.”

“Long after you are dead and gone, you will be referred to by your grandmother name in family stories and memories. Make it a cool one.”

Emily Cathcart, who chose “ChaCha” because it was fun and easy to say

“Granny.” And for those living out West, “Gramma” is popular.

Then there are names that say something about the grandmother herself, and this is where rules go out the window. I posed the question, “What is your Grandma name?” on the Grown and Flown Parents Facebook page, which has more than 300,000 members in the empty-nest phase, and I received more than 500 responses. The most popular were “Gigi,” “Mimi” and “Nana.”

There were also some unique

picks. For example, Emily Cathcart of Nashville chose “ChaCha” because it was fun and easy to say. “Long after you are dead and gone, you will be referred to by your grandmother name in family stories and memories. Make it a cool one,” she suggests.

In Harrington Meyer’s experience, grandmothers seem to care more than grandfathers. “In one family, they asked the grandpa, ‘What do you want to be called?’” she says. “His name was Henry and he said ‘Fred.’ Fred stuck, and he is Fred [to his



grandkids].”

According to Livingstone, grandfather names tend to be less creative. “Typically, they’re Pops or PopPop,” she says.

Who gets to decide?

Just because you choose your name, doesn’t mean you get to keep it. Firstborn grandchildren sometimes get “naming rights,” according to Harrington Meyer. “There can be the name you

prefer, but there’s also what the child is able to say,” she says. “Those are the best stories of all; somebody names them and then it sticks.”

Melissa Davis Haller of Cincinnati originally chose “Mimi,” when her grandson was old enough to talk, but he didn’t repeat it. She tried “Birdie” without luck, too. Then she gave up and told her grandson to use “Grandma” and “Grandpa.”

With the Kennedy Center shuttered, Honors ceremony moves to a D.C. arena

HONORS FROM B1

year before, it arrived in July along with both the broadcast and ceremony date.

It is October, and there’s no other word on the details.

We don’t know who is in the 49th class of honorees or what kind of crowd will greet them: The program’s venue, Capital One Arena, which can hold roughly 20,000 people at max capacity, dwarfs the 2,347 seats of the center’s Opera House.

We don’t know who will broadcast it. During a board meeting last year, Trump floated the idea of having networks bid to air the show, which has been broadcast on CBS since its debut. (Last year’s remained on CBS.)

Finally, we don’t know who would host it. Trump, who avoided the honors in his first term, famously played the role himself at last year’s ceremony, something a president had never before done. He also said he



President Donald Trump and first lady Melania Trump at the Kennedy Center in December for the Honors ceremony. This year, the celebration will be at Capital One Arena.

was “about 98 percent involved” in picking the honorees — Michael Crawford, Gloria Gaynor, Kiss, Sylvester Stallone and George Strait — which are generally chosen by committee.

Asked for details this week, the White House referred us to the Kennedy Center, which provided the announcement.

The center had maintained that the honors, along with the Mark Twain Prize, would continue somewhere off-site during the building’s two-year closure for repairs.

“It will definitely go forward,” Richard Grenell told WTOP in February, before he departed as president of the Kennedy Center. At the time, he predicted “it will probably just be in a smaller venue, which just means ticket demand will be even higher.”

That full closure hasn’t started yet, according to the center. Instead, the main building is closed temporarily, leaders say, while they check on the building’s safety. Those checks could

The annual black-tie gala and television broadcast is the Kennedy Center’s flagship program and usually its largest fundraising event.

take another week or two, according to a Wednesday staff email reviewed by The Washington Post.

But “this is an assessment timeline,” the email read, “not a reopening date.”

Jade Tran and Jonathan Edwards contributed to this report.

CLASSIC DOONESBURY



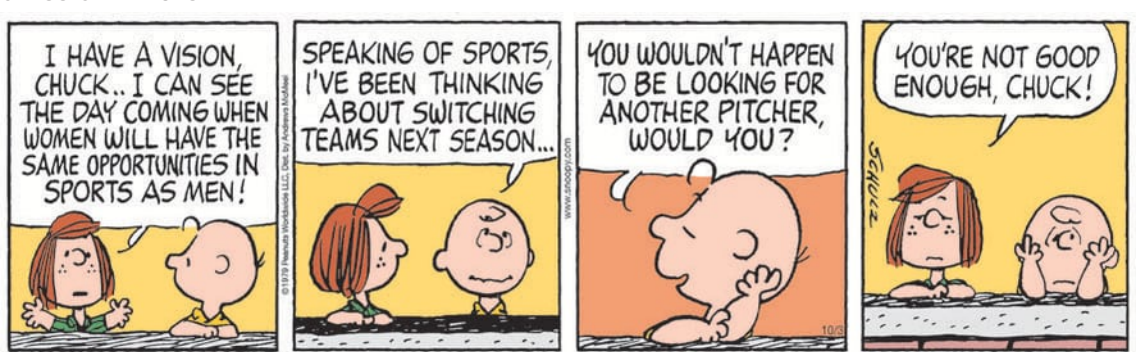
RED AND ROVER



FRANK AND ERNEST



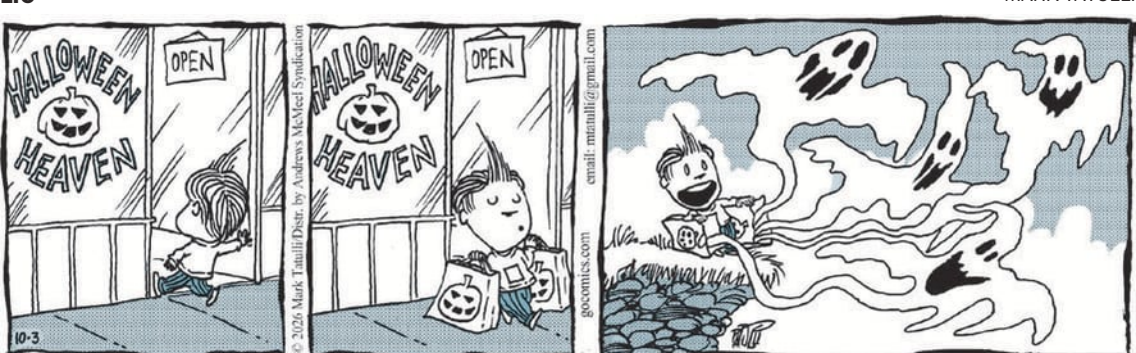
CLASSIC PEANUTS



RHYMES WITH ORANGE



LIO



HAGAR THE HORRIBLE



BLONDIE



BREWSTER ROCKIT: SPACE GUY!



PEARLS BEFORE SWINE



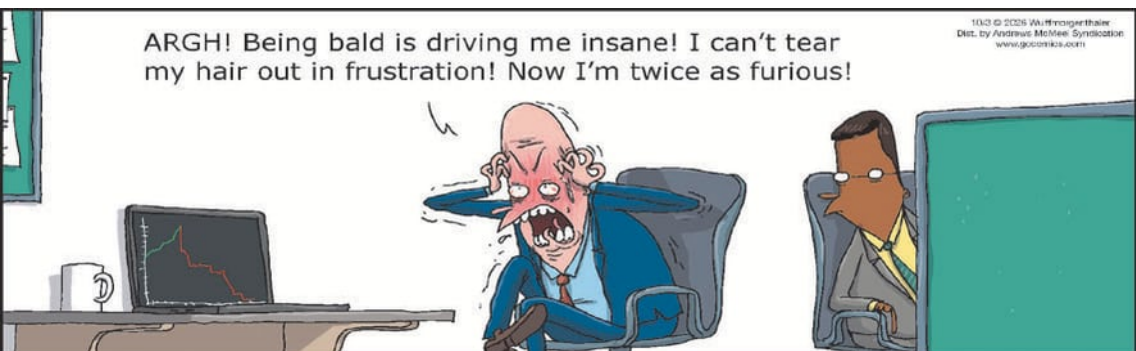
PICKLES



AGNES



WUMO



CRABGRASS



MARK TRAIL



MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM



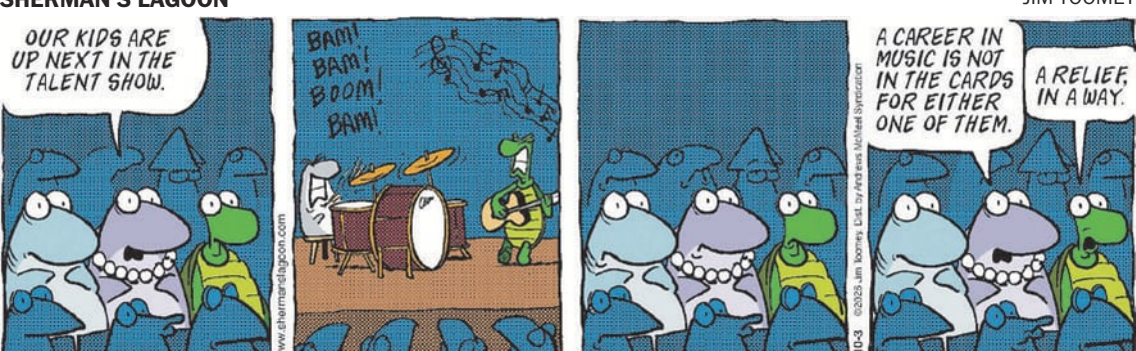
BALDO



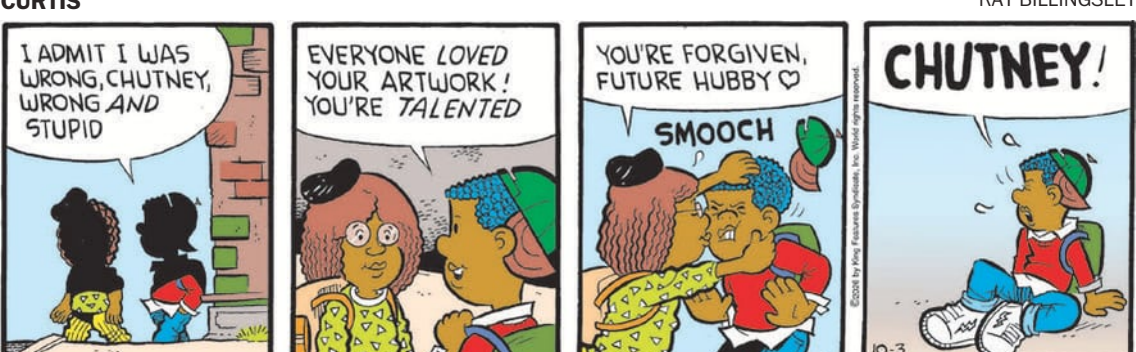
SALLY FORTH



SHERMAN'S LAGOON



CURTIS



MUTTS



PATRICK McDONNELL

ZITS



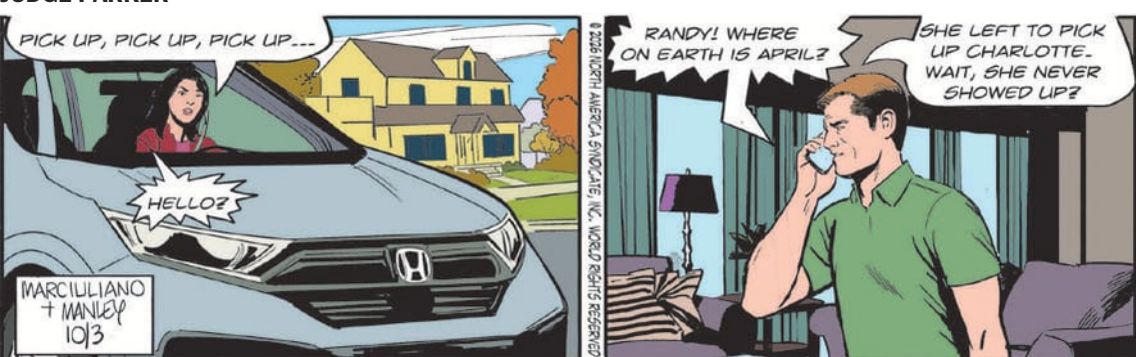
JERRY SCOTT & JIM BORGMAN

HEART OF THE CITY



STEENZ

JUDGE PARKER



FRANCESCO MARCIULIANO & MIKE MANLEY

FRAZZ



JEFF MALLETT

SIX CHIX



BANNERMAN, XUNISE, KONAR, LAWTON, PATRINOS & PIRO

GARFIELD



JIM DAVIS

BARNEY AND CLYDE



WEINGARTENS & CLARK

DUSTIN



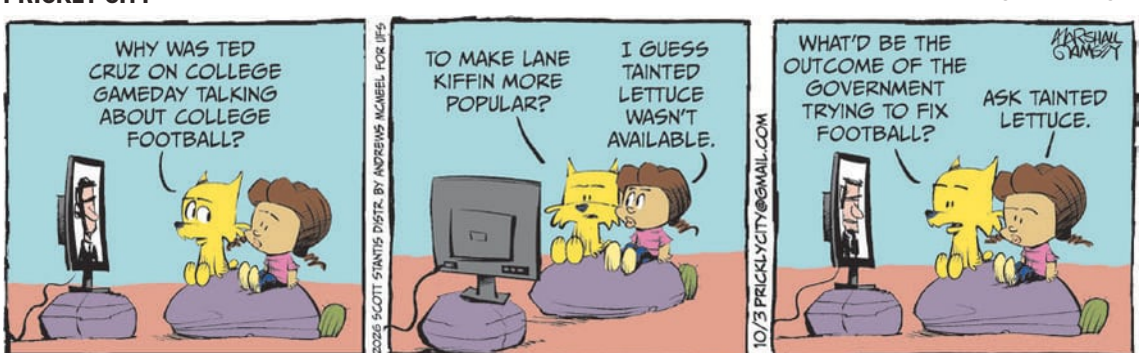
STEVE KELLEY & JEFF PARKER

FLASH GORDON



DAN SCHKADE

PRICKLY CITY



MARSHALL RAMSEY

LOOSE PARTS



DAVE BLAZEK

NON SEQUITUR



WILEY

BEATLES



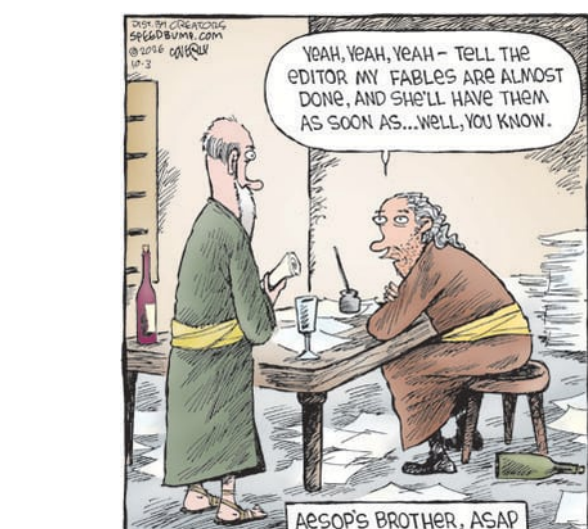
RICK KIRKMAN & JERRY SCOTT

WALLACE THE BRAVE



WILL HENRY

SPEED BUMP



DAVE COVERLY

DENNIS THE MENACE



H. KETCHAM

ON THE FASTTRACK



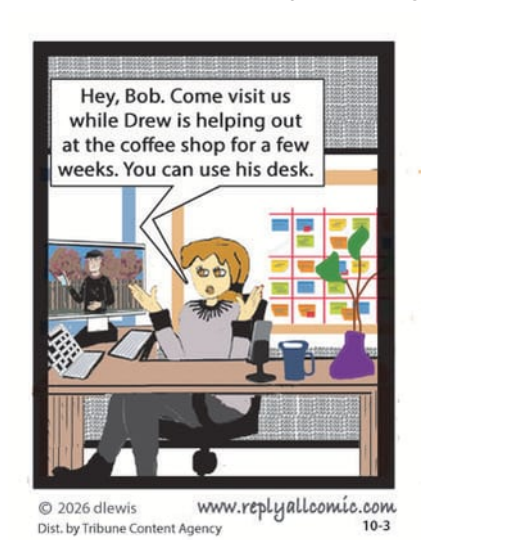
BILL HOLBROOK

FAMILY CIRCUS



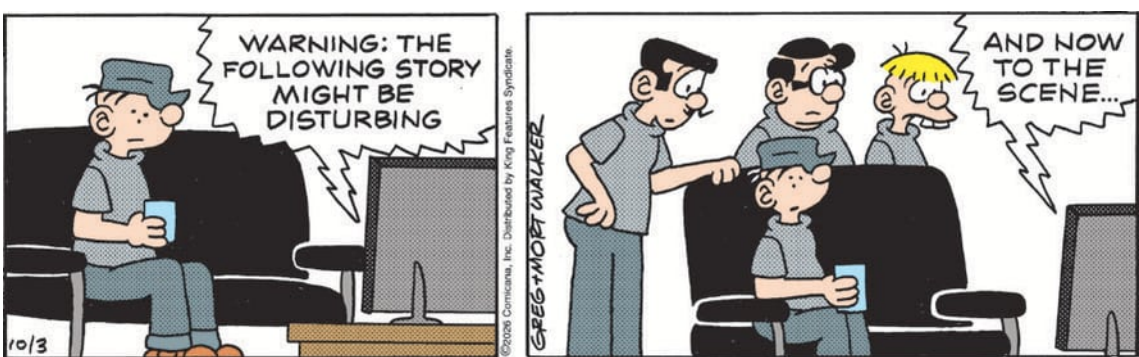
BIL KEANE

REPLY ALL LITE



DONNA A. LEWIS

BEETLE BAILEY



GREG, BRIAN & NEAL WALKER

TELEVISION									
10/3/26	7:00	7:30	8:00	8:30	9:00	9:30	10:00	10:30	11:00
4.1 WRC (NBC)	• Big Ten	• College Football Washington at USC (Live)						• NEWS..	
4.2 WRC (IND)	Munsters	Munsters	Columbo				Columbo		
5.1 WTTG (Fox)	(5:30) • TBA	• College Football Texas Tech at Colorado (Live)							• Football
7.1 WJLA (ABC)	• Football	• College Football Miami at Clemson (Live)							• News
9.1 WUSA (CBS)	• Postga..	• UFC 332: Silva vs. Wang (Live)							• News
14.1 WFDC (UNI)	• Piensa rápido VIP		• Movie: Central Intelligence ★★ (2016)					• Orillese	• Familia
20.1 WDCA (MNTV)	• Family	• Family	• Fox 5 News (Live)		• Family	• Family	• FOX 5 News at		• FOX 5 ..
22.1 WMPT (PBS)	• Christina	• WildFoo..	• Foyle's War			• Life	• Disaster Strikes		• Austin
26.1 WETA (PBS)	• Bucks County, USA		• Hemingway				• Frontline		
32.1 WHUT (PBS)	• Here		• TacoMa..		• Luther	• Broadchurch		• Afropop: Cultural	
50.1 WDCW (CW)	• NASCAR • NASCAR O'Reilly Auto Parts Series Focused Health 302 (Live)						• College Football		
66.1 WPDW (ION)	(6:30) • NWSL Soccer	• NWSL.. /(:45) • NWSL Soccer					• NWSL... • Law-SVU		
A&E	Storage	Storage	Storage Wars		Storage Wars		Storage Wars		Storage
AMC	Movie: It ★★ ★ (2017)		Maine children unite to fight an ancient, evil clown.				Movie: Carrie ★★ (2013)		
Animal Planet	Dr. Jeff: RMV		Dr. Jeff: RMV		Dr. Jeff: RMV		Dr. Dee: Alaska Vet		Dr. Dee
BET	(6:00) Movie: The Equalizer ★★ (2014)				Movie: The Equalizer 2 ★★ (2018) (P)		(P)		
Bravo	Below Deck		Below Deck		Below Deck		Below Deck		Below Deck
Cartoon Network	Burgers	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Rick Morty	Rick Morty
CNN	CNN Newsroom		Real Time With		Have I Got		David Chang		Real Time
Comedy Central	(6:30) Movie: Daddy's Home (2015)		(:45) Movie: Step Brothers ★★ (2008)				Movie		
Discovery	Naked and Afraid		Naked and Afraid				Naked and Afraid		
Disney	Big City Toy Story		Big City	Big City	Big City	Greens	Big City	Big City	Big City
E!	(6:00) Movie: Oppenheimer ★★ ★ (2023) (P)						Movie: Oppenheimer (2023)		
ESPN	College Football BYU at TCU (Live)						Scorebo-ard (Live)	Football Baylor at Arizona State (Live)	
ESPN2	College Football Arkansas at Texas A&M (Live)						Scorebo-ard (Live)	College Football	
Food Network	Halloween Baking		Halloween Baking		Halloween Baking		Halloween Baking Championship		
Fox News	(5:00) Weekend (Live)	Life, Liberty (Live)		My View With (Live)		Saturday Night (Live)		Gutfield!	
Freeform	(:20) Movie: Monsters University ★★ ★ (2013) At first rivals, Mike and Sulley became the best of pals.				(:50) Movie: The Addams Family ★★ (1991)				
FX	Movie: Thor: The Dark World ★★ (2013) Thor must save the Nine Realms from an ancient enemy.				Movie: Ghostbusters ★★ ★ (1984)				
Hallmark	(6:00) Movie: October Kiss (2015)		Movie: A Knight to Remember (2026) (P)				Movie: Good Witch Halloween (2015)		
Hallmark M&M	(6:00) Curious Caterer Mysteries		Curious Caterer Mysteries				Murder, She Wrote		Murder ...
HBO	(6:20) Movie: Evil Dead Rise (2023)		Movie: Evil Dead Burn ★★ (2026) (P)				(:55) War	(:55) Youth	
HGTV	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters
History	World War II		World War II		World War II		(:05) World War II	WorldWar	
Lifetime	(6:00) Movie: Kidnapped in Her Own Home: M...		Movie: A Doctor to Die For: The Sarah Harris Story (2026) (P)				(:05) Movie: Kidnapped by a Killer: Heather Robinson Story (2025)		
MASN	Bensinger 2023		Fight Sports WCK		MMA		Fight Sp.	Charlie	Sail Kings
Monumental	NHL Hockey				Caps (Live)		NHL Hockey		
MSNBC	The Best of The		The Weekend		Connect With		Crooked on MS NOW Lovett		
MTV	Movie: Mean Girls ★★ ★ (2004)				Movie: Bring It On ★★ (2000)				
Nat'l Geographic	Africa Earth's Wild		Africa Earth's Wild		(:05) Africa Ear		(:05) Africa Ear	AfricaEar	
Nickelodeon	Movie: Despicable Me 2 ★★ ★ (2013)				Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends
NWSN	Batya		NewsNation (Live)		NewsNation (Live)		NewsNation (Live)		Batya
Paramount	(6:50) Yellowstone		(:05) Yellowstone		(:10) Movie: Forrest Gump ★★ ★ ★ (1994) A slow-witted Southerner experiences 30 years of history.				
Paramount+Sho	(:55) Movie: Godzilla ★★ (2014) Godzilla and his malevolent foe battle for supremacy.				Movie: Grizzly Night (2025) (P)		Movie: Argo ★★ ★ (2012)		
Syfy	(5:00)	Movie: The Boogeyman ★★ (2023) A family encounters a terrifying supernatural entity.				Movie: The Possession ★★ (2012) An antique box contains a malevolent spirit.			
TBS	(6:30) MLB Baseball TBA at Tampa Bay Rays (Live)						MLBClose [Movie: Twister (1996)		
TCM	(5:45) Movie: Monsieur Verdoux (1947)		Movie: Out of the Past ★★ ★ ★ (1947)				Movie: The Set-Up ★★ ★ (1949)		
TLC	90 Day: Hunt for Love		90 Day: Hunt for Love				90 Day: Hunt for Love		
TNT	(5:00) Movie: Aquaman ★★ (2018)		All Elite Wrestling: Collision (Live)				Men's International Soccer Friendlies USA vs. Mexico (Live)		
Travel	Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adv
TruTV	(6:30) MLB Baseball Division Series: Teams TBA (Live)						M. Friendlies USA vs. Mexico		
TV Land	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld
TV One	GoodTimes	GoodTimes	GoodTimes	GoodTimes	GoodTimes	GoodTim..	GoodTim..	GoodTim..	GoodTim..
USA Network	(6:00) Football Oregon State at Colorado State (Live)				Football Fresno State at Washington State				
VH1	(6:00) Movie: Little Ni...		Movie: Coming to America ★★ ★ (1988)				Movie: Escape Room...		
WNCB	Eye Bags? 24/ 7 Ne...		The National News Desk (Live)		Paid Prog. [WJLNe...		WJLANews [Attkisson		
LEGEND: Bold indicates new or live programs ♦ High Definition Movie Ratings (from TMS) ★★ ★ ★ Excellent ★★ ★ Good ★★ Fair ★ Poor No stars: not rated									

BIRTHDAY | OCTOBER 3: You're a strong-willed, focused, perfectionist. You take a direct and logical approach to life. This year exciting changes will give you increased personal freedom. Stay flexible. Let go of whatever impedes your growth and progress. Seek out new opportunities and be ready to act fast. Expect to travel.

Moon Alert: Caution! Avoid shopping (except for food and gas) and important decisions after 10:30 a.m. today for the rest of the day. The Moon is in Cancer.

ARIES
(March 21-April 19)
Do your best to keep the peace at home. Parents must be patient with their kids to avoid meltdowns and hissy fits. Respect your need for more rest. If possible, take a nap. Discussions with older family members and parents will be challenging. You might say goodbye to someone.

TAURUS
(April 20-May 20)
Domestic power struggles can make this a challenging day. Please know that things look worse than they are. The best way to deal with today's discouraging energy is to throw yourself into a project. Whether it's hands-on or mental work, stay busy.

GEMINI
(May 21-June 20)
You might feel that your finances look bleak today. Or perhaps a purchase disappoints you. Today might be frustrating because your ability to communicate is thwarted by someone. Your efforts to talk or handle appointments and short trips might be met with opposition.

CANCER
(June 21-July 22)
This is a challenging day because the Moon is in your sign at odds with Saturn. Proceed slowly and cautiously even though self-doubt and feelings of inadequacy might make you hesitate to act. Dealings with VIPs, parents, bosses and the police will be challenging.

LEO
(July 23-Aug. 22)
This is the classic day for an emotional confrontation with someone. No matter what you do to get ahead, you might encounter some kind of opposition or a power struggle with someone. This could be discouraging. If possible, enlist the aid of someone to help you. Don't try to go it alone.

VIRGO
(Aug. 23-Sept. 22)
A friend might disappoint you today, perhaps a female. Or this disappointment could occur with a group. Something going on behind the scenes is discouraging, and you might not know what to do. When you are this unsure, do nothing except seek the help of someone else.

LIBRA
(Sept. 23-Oct. 22)
This is a poor day to ask for permission or approval from authority figures. Your confidence is not strong. You might feel depressed, lonely or out of touch with others. Please be aware that things look worse than they are. Avoid power struggles with friends and groups.

SCORPIO
(Oct. 23-Nov. 21)
This is a poor day to deal with bosses, parents, teachers, VIPs and the police. Give these people a wide berth to avoid emotional confrontations and power struggles. You also might encounter

difficulty if traveling. Keep a low profile today.

SAGITTARIUS
(Nov. 22-Dec. 21)
Avoid controversial discussions with others, especially about politics, religion and racial issues, because today is full of angry energy and negative thinking. Children might feel like an increased responsibility. Remind yourself that this is a temporary dark cloud on your horizon.

CAPRICORN
(Dec. 22-Jan. 19)
Financial disputes might occur today about purchases, the ownership of something, or how to divide an inheritance or shared expenses. Meanwhile, discussions with partners, spouses and close friends might discourage you. Demonstrate grace under pressure.

AQUARIUS
(Jan. 20-Feb. 18)
Be patient with those who are closest to you today because everyone is prickly and short-tempered. However, some are feeling sad and lonely. (This is a challenging day.) Fortunately, you look good to others, and a chance to learn or travel will work well for you.

PISCES
(Feb. 19-March 20)
Conflict about pets or anything related to your job or your health might occur today. You also might be upset about the cost of something related to a social situation, sports or the care and education of kids. Being patient and loving make life easier for everyone.

— Georgia Nicols

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BRIDGE

N-S VULNERABLE
NORTH
♠ Q 6 3
♥ A K J 6
♦ K J 3
♣ Q 110

WEST
♠ A 7 2
♥ 10 4 3
♦ 10 9 8 6 2
♣ K 6

EAST
♠ 5 4
♥ 9 8 5 2
♦ Q 7 5
♣ A 7 5 2

SOUTH (D)
♠ K J 10 9 8
♥ Q 7
♦ A 4
♣ 9 8 4 3

The bidding:

SOUTH	PASS	WEST	1NT	NORTH	PASS	EAST	PASS
2 ♠				Pass	4 ♠		All Pass

Opening lead — ♦ 10

Simple Saturday columns focus on improving basic technique and logical thinking.

"We have reason to believe the victim was stabbed," a police report stated perceptively. "A sharp object was protruding from his chest."

Inferences from the bidding and play are available on most every deal, and defenders must act on them. In today's deal, North-South played at four spades after North opened 1NT in third position. West led the 10 of diamonds: jack, queen, ace.

Declarer next led the king of trumps, and West took his ace and continued with the nine of diamonds. South won in dummy, drew trumps and ran the hearts for 10 tricks.

West missed an easy inference. South had not opened the bidding but had the ace of diamonds, clearly the K-J of spades and maybe the queen of hearts. He was most unlikely to have the ace of clubs.

— Frank Stewart

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SUDOKU

Complete the grid so that every row, column and 3x3 box contains every digit from 1 to 9 inclusively.

5				6	2	7		
		4	8	1				
				1		5	8	
	5	7		6		3	9	
8	9		5					
			7	2	4			
	8	9	6					2

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★ ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ ★

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Game Break

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PREVIOUS SUDOKU SOLUTION

1	2	3	5	6	4	9	8	7
7	8	6	3	2	9	4	1	5
9	4	5	8	7	1	3	2	6
2	6	7	1	5	3	8	9	4
5	1	8	4	9	2	7	6	3
3	9	4	7	8	6	2	5	1
6	5	9	2	4	7	1	3	8
8	7	1	9	3	5	6	4	2
4	3	2	6	1	8	5	7	9

SCRABBLEGRAMS

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E

I

K

B

T

H

N

RACK 1

A

E

E

U

Q

M

S

R

Double Word Score

RACK 2

A

A

L

T

B

M

S

S

3rd Letter Triple

RACK 3

A

E

U

L

C

N

C

RACK 4

PAR SCORE 155-165

BEST SCORE 229

FOUR RACK TOTAL

TIME LIMIT: 20 MIN

DIRECTIONS: Make a 2- to 7-letter word from the letters in each row. Add points of each word, using scoring directions at right. Finally, 7-letter words get 50-point bonus. "Blanks" used as any letter have no point value. All the words are in the Official SCRABBLE® Players Dictionary, 5th Edition. SOLUTION TOMORROW

For more information on tournaments and clubs, email NASPA - North American SCRABBLE Players Association info@scrabbleplayers.org. Visit our website - www.scrabbleplayers.org. For puzzle inquiries contact scrgrams@gmail.com

10-03

JUMBLECROSSWORDS

by David L. Hoyt

10-3-26

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

CLUE ACROSS

ANSWER

1. Dry, barren region

ETRSED

5. Kinds

PYTSE

<



JARED C. TILTON/GETTY IMAGES

Alex Tuch, second from left, scored twice in his first game with Washington as the Capitals raced to a 4-0 lead and cruised to a season-opening win over the reigning champs.

A category 5 beatdown

BY DANIELLE ALLENTUCK

For the first two days of the NHL season, the Washington Capitals could only watch as most of their competitors played their season openers, and in some cases even got two games in. But that extra time, especially after a condensed training camp and shortened preseason slate, may have been exactly what the Capitals needed.

On Friday, when it was finally their turn to kick off their campaign, the Capitals came out firing, beating the Carolina Hurricanes, 5-2. After narrowly missing out on making the playoffs last season,

CAPITALS 5, HURRICANES 2

Tuch scores twice in Caps debut in season-opening win on road

the Capitals began a season with high expectations off on a winning note.

"All the additions, the new mix of guys, you are confident, you feel like we've got a really good team here and a lot of good players, we made some moves to bring in some significant guys this offseason, but

you still don't know how it's going to look when the pick drops," Coach Spencer Carbery told reporters. "So I just think starting on the road in Carolina against a really good team, playing well and showing that we're capable of being a really good hockey team this year.

Washington spent the offseason adding on size, speed and power to try to make up for their shortcomings last season. They made four offseason additions, acquiring forwards Alex Tuch and Jordan Kyrrou in trades and signing forward Boone Jenner and defenseman Vincent Desharnais.

SEE CAPITALS ON B11

With strong foundation, Mystics' future is bright

After disappointing end to record-breaking season, club basks in the positive

BY JAKE KAUDERER

For most of Wednesday's postgame news conference, Kiki Iriafeen stared dejectedly at the ground. She struggled to find words after what had just happened.

The Washington Mystics suffered a season-ending loss to the Atlanta Dream at CareFirst Arena. Iriafeen, still donning her crimson jersey and white headband, wasn't looking to talk. "Kiki, you haven't answered one [question]," fellow starter Sonia Citron said midway through the news conference, pushing Iriafeen to chime in.

The forward shook her head and looked away. She didn't speak until the final question was directed specifically at her.

"I thought I could escape without talking, but I guess

not," Iriafeen said, finally cracking a smile. "I'm still wrapping my mind through everything. It doesn't feel real."

That sense of disbelief was contagious among Washington's players after its historic season came to a screeching halt in a first-round sweep at the hands of the Dream. The Mystics haven't won a playoff game in nearly seven years. But they're primed to potentially snap that drought next season after exceeding expectations with the WNBA's youngest roster in 2026.

Washington won a franchise-best 28 regular season games. After beginning the season 12-12, it went 16-4 over the next 20 games to reach the post-season for the first time since 2023. It flipped a 16-28 record in 2025 to a 28-16 mark in 2026.

"I truly believe we have a really special group," Citron said. "Just to see the growth from last year to this year has been amazing."

The Mystics' average age is 24. Betnijah Laney-Hamilton, who Washington claimed off

SEE MYSTICS ON B11



SCOTT TAETSCH/GETTY IMAGES

"There was a giant chip on his shoulder," Coach Dan Quinn said of Commanders cornerback Amik Robertson. "And it ain't never left."

Robertson is flourishing after battling self-doubt

Resilient defensive back has been a bright spot in Commanders' secondary

BY TASHAN REED

WATFORD, ENGLAND — Amik Robertson was lined up across from arguably the best wide receiver in football. Jaxon Smith-Njigba ran a slant route and quarterback Sam Darnold immediately looked to throw his way. Before it even left Darnold's hand, Robertson was breaking on the ball. His anticipation allowed him to arrive just as the pass did and knock it out of Smith-Njigba's hands.

Robertson was seemingly everywhere in the Washington Commanders' 33-31 win over the Seattle Seahawks on Sunday. He led the team with six tackles, had four pass deflections and assisted linebacker Sonny Styles on a forced fumble. He was playing so well that, at one point, he mimicked LeBron James's "I'm crazy"

celebration by twirling his fingers around his temples.

There aren't many NFL cornerbacks playing better than Robertson this season. He has allowed just 5.2 yards per target through Week 3 — 13th among cornerbacks who have been targeted at least 10 times, according to Pro Football Reference. He doesn't have any interceptions, but he has six pass deflections (third in the NFL). He has also been effective in the run game and has 17 tackles (third on the Commanders).

Robertson, 28, has started every game and has been on the field for 99 percent of the defensive snaps. He has been the lone bright spot in a struggling secondary.

This isn't anything Robertson, his coaches and teammates didn't expect. But it wasn't always this way. Earlier in his career, he questioned whether he had what it took to stick in the NFL.

SEE COMMANDERS ON B10

Colts vs. Commanders

Sunday, 9:30 a.m., NFL Network

SPOTLIGHT: NBA

Trail Blazers fire new broadcaster for posts

Associated Press

PORTLAND, ORE. — The Portland Trail Blazers fired new play-by-play television broadcaster Braiden Bell on Thursday when inappropriate social media posts that he made as a teenager resurfaced just hours after the team announced his hiring.

“The Portland Trail Blazers have zero tolerance for racist, sexist, or harmful comments,” the team said in a statement Thursday night. “Social media posts made by our recently announced play-by-play broadcaster are in clear violation of team and league policies, as well as our values and expectations. Therefore, we will not be moving forward with this broadcaster.”

Bell had been the play-by-play announcer for the WNBA’s Phoenix Mercury and the G League’s Valley Suns before the Trail Blazers announced they had hired him on Thursday to replace longtime broadcaster Kevin Calabro.

Hours after the 29-year-old Bell was hired, posts surfaced that Bell made on his X account in 2012 and 2013, when the platform was known as Twitter.

The posts were first reported by KGW-TV in Portland.

Bell apologized in a social media post Friday.

“I am deeply sorry for the language that I used on Twitter. These tweets, while wrong, were written by me 14 years ago while I was only 15 years old and have no reflection of who I am today,” he said. “I do not take lightly any harm it causes now. I regret this being my first impression to many of you online, but I can take solace in knowing that the people who truly know me understand that this is not the kind of person I am. Again, I’d like to apologize to anyone who was hurt by my words and will continue to always treat people with kindness and respect.”

The Trail Blazers said in a statement: “We did not meet our own bar in this process, and for that we apologize to Blazers fans and to Rip City. We believe strongly that everyone who is a part of Rip City should feel welcome and safe and we will make sure that our new broadcaster reflects these values. We will do better.”



DAVID ROGERS/GETTY IMAGES

A scoring struggle

Ted Hill, left, and Bath Rugby avenged a loss to the Exeter Chiefs in last year’s PREM semifinals with a 26-10 victory in a rematch Friday.

DIGEST

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

Flames top Blue Hens in conference opener

Kam Davis rushed for 147 yards and two touchdowns to lead Liberty to a 30-14 victory over Delaware on Friday night in the Conference USA opener for both teams in Newark, Delaware.

Davis raced 56 yards for a touchdown on third and two for a 13-0 lead midway through the second quarter. He added a five-yard scoring run early in the fourth quarter to put the Flames (4-1, 1-0) up 30-0. The junior totaled 123 yards on nine carries in the first half.

Deshavn Purdie completed 13 of 20 passes for 157 yards for Liberty.

Sophomore **EJ Archfield Jr.** had 137 yards on 10-for-19 passing for the Blue Hens (2-3, 0-1) in his first collegiate start after **Nick Minnucucci** was injured last week in a 42-3 road loss to Virginia. ...

Former Yale football coach **Tony Reno**, who led the school to five Ivy League championships over 14 seasons, died, the school announced. He was 52.

No cause of death was given. Reno resigned as Yale’s coach in February because of health reasons and had been on medical leave since the end of last season.

“Today, we are deeply saddened by the loss of an extraordinary member of the Yale Athletics family,” Yale Athletic Director **Victoria Chun** said. “Tony Reno devoted his life to serving others and approached every day with humility, compassion, and purpose. He believed deeply in the power of mentorship and invested wholeheartedly in the success and well-being of his players, colleagues, and friends.”

BASEBALL

Nats prospect Rivero suspended 56 games

Washington Nationals catcher **Francisco Rivero** and free agent pitcher **Raudi Perez** were suspended for 56 games each following positive tests for a performance-enhancing substance under baseball’s minor league drug programs.

Both were disciplined following positive tests for Stanazolol, Rivero under the minor league program and Perez under the program for minor leaguers assigned outside of the U.S. and Canada.

Rivero, 18, signed with the Nationals in July and has not played in any minor league games.

Perez, 19, signed with the Padres in January for a \$25,000 bonus and was 0-4 with a 7.09 ERA and one save in six starts

and eight relief appearances in the Dominican Summer League. He was released Sept. 10, and his suspension will start when he signs with a major league organization.

PRO BASKETBALL

Bickerstaff says all is well with center Duren

The lengthy negotiations between the Detroit Pistons and star center **Jalen Duren** didn’t leave any lingering animosity, at least not in the mind of Coach **J.B. Bickerstaff**.

Duren, an all-NBA third team selection last season, agreed to a five-year, \$200 million contract Thursday. There were reports during the offseason that the restricted free agent sought sign-and-trade options and even felt disrespected by the front office.

Duren, who was not made available to the media, underwent a physical and other testing Friday and is expected to start practicing as early as this weekend. Bickerstaff brushed aside any suggestion that Duren might not be fully invested in rejoining the team.

“The most important thing for us was having JD back with us and I know JD wanted to be back,” Bickerstaff said. “All that stuff that was floating [around], we know what’s real. It’s a negotiating process and we went through the process and we knew he’d be back.”

Duren had little leverage, other than to sign a \$9.6 million qualifying offer — which expired on Thursday night — and become an unrestricted free agent after this season. President of basketball operations **Trajan Langdon** repeatedly stated he had no interest in dealing his starting center.

Duren was eligible for a five-year contract worth up to \$287 million but the fully guaranteed deal will still make him a top 10 center in annual salary.

GOLF

Smotherman leads in Utah after two rounds

Austin Smotherman made 10 birdies to match the lowest round of his PGA Tour career, a 9-under-par 62 that gave him a one-shot lead at a Utah Championship in which making birdies is the only way to make up ground.

Kevin Roy opened with a pair of 63s and broke by five shots his best 36-hole score. In perfect conditions at the Black Desert Resort in Ivins, that left him one shot behind Smotherman.

Smotherman, playing in his 100th PGA Tour event and still

looking for his first victory, made all but two of his 10 birdies from inside 10 feet. His longest was a 20-footer on the par-3 17th, part of a birdie-birdie-birdie finish that gave his second 36-hole lead of the year at 17-under 125. ...

A Lim Kim shot a 7-under-par 65 on a rainy and breezy Thursday at Hoakalei Country Club in Honolulu to take the first-round lead in the LPGA Tour’s Lotte Championship.

The 2024 tournament winner, Kim birdied Nos. 15-17 and closed her bogey-free morning round with a par on the par-5 18th.

The 30-year-old Kim has three LPGA Tour victories, also winning the 2020 U.S. Women’s Open and the 2025 Tournament of Champions.

In the afternoon, fellow South Korean player **Ina Yoon** pulled even with Kim at 7 under with a birdie on the par-4 third hole — her 12th of the day — before dropping back with a bogey on the par-4 sixth. She parred the final three for a 66. ...

Casey Jarvis of South Africa, already a two-time winner on the European tour this year, two-putted for birdie on his final hole at Kingsbarns for a 5-under 67 to take a one-shot lead in the Dunhill Links Championship.

Rocco Repetto Taylor of Spain had a 64 at Kingsbarns and was among three players one shot behind, while defending champion **Robert MacIntyre** kept his cool under a gray sky in Fife for a 65 to get within three shots.

The top names — Jarvis, MacIntyre, **Brooks Koepka** and **Tyrrell Hatton** — move on to the Old Course at St. Andrews on Saturday before the 54-hole cut is made in the tournament that pairs pros with amateurs over Kingsbarns, St. Andrews and Carnoustie.

SOCCER

Man. City files appeal amid financial scandal

Manchester City has lodged a “comprehensive” appeal, the club confirmed, following the publication of a report by an independent commission detailing large-scale financial rule-breaking by the Premier League giant in one of English soccer’s biggest scandals.

“The club’s firm position,” read a short statement from City, “is that, on multiple grounds, the opinion contains clear material errors, of law, principle and fact and is unsafe.”

City has protested its innocence throughout the long-running case, which dates back to 2018 and reached a milestone Tuesday, when the Premier League published a verdict say-

ing the Abu Dhabi-controlled club was “guilty of all charges related to serious breaches” of the competition’s financial rules from 2009-18.

City has yet to receive a punishment. According to the Premier League, potential sanctions could be a reprimand, fine, points deduction or, in the worst case, expulsion from the competition. No team has ever been expelled from English soccer’s top flight.

City officials said they would lodge an appeal and that was filed on Thursday evening, the club said, ahead of Friday’s deadline.

“The club is innocent of the accusations made by the Premier League and a comprehensive body of irrefutable evidence exists in support of all of its positions, relating to this case,” City said, using language from previous statements on the case.

TENNIS

Djokovic moves on to China Open quarters

Novak Djokovic rallied to beat **Bu Yunchaokete** and maintain his flawless record at the China Open despite again needing a medical timeout.

The sixth-ranked Djokovic won, 4-6, 7-6 (7-2), 6-2, to reach the quarterfinals and extend his record to 31-0 at the Beijing tournament, which he has won six times, the last in 2015.

“I had to play very well. I had to serve well in the right moments,” Djokovic said. “He was so solid. I struggled to really find holes in his game and was hitting his spots really well with his serve.

“Credit to him for playing well. The atmosphere was amazing. Packed stadium again for three hours — what a match to be a part of.”

Djokovic will play either top-seeded **Alexander Zverev** or China’s **Juncheng Shang** in the quarterfinals.

In a first-round match, sixth-seeded **Daniil Medvedev** eased past **Pablo Carreño Busta**, 6-4, 6-2, and will next face **Jan-Lennard Struff**.

In the women’s tournament, second-seeded **Aryna Sabalenka** took just 62 minutes to defeat **Renata Zarazua**, 6-1, 6-3, in Sabalenka’s first match since losing the U.S. Open final to **Elena Rybakina**.

In contrast, it took **Naomi Osaka** exactly double that time to see off **Maria Timofeeva**, with the No. 12 seed eventually prevailing, 6-3, 3-6, 6-3.

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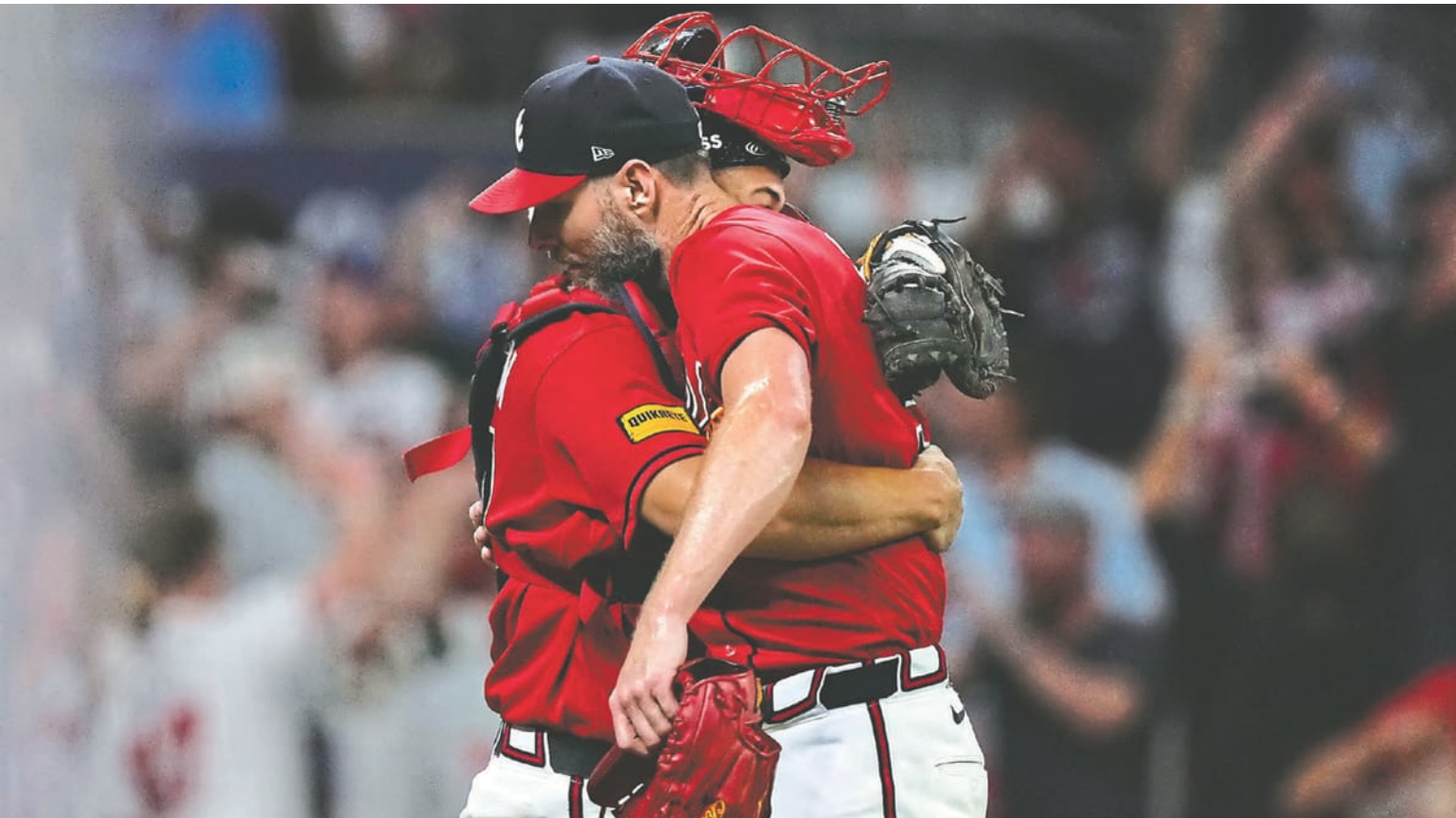
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S0115-6x1



BRYNN ANDERSON/AP

Two days after starting the series opener, Atlanta’s Chris Sale came on to get the last four outs Thursday to eliminate the Phillies in Game 3.

With ‘warrior’ effort, Sale helped Braves advance

BY CHARLES ODUM

ATLANTA — Atlanta Braves Manager Walt Weiss reported to Truist Park on Thursday determined to avoid asking ace starter Chris Sale whether he would be available for relief duty only two days after making a start in the National League first-round series opener.

“I didn’t want to put him in that position because I knew that even if he was hanging, he would tell me yes,” Weiss said. “So I was not going to bring it up.”

Weiss didn’t have to worry. Sale was not going to make Weiss ask.

“Literally as soon as I stepped in my office this afternoon, he was sitting in the chair across from my desk, and he looked at me and he said ‘I feel amazing.’ That’s what he said. I said, ‘Well, let’s talk.’”

That talk led to Sale recording the final four outs of the Braves’ clinching 6-2 win over the Philadelphia Phillies on Thursday night.

Sale, the starter in Atlanta’s 5-3 win in Tuesday’s series opener, struck out Bryce Harper to end the eighth and closed out the win in the ninth by strik-

ing out Bryan De La Cruz and pinch-hitter Otto Kemp.

“I was hoping he only had to go one, but he had to get to four outs,” Weiss said.

“But what a warrior, man. This guy, I’ve run out of superlatives for Chris Sale. Been talking about him all year. He’s one of the best I’ve ever been around. When you take everything into consideration, teammate, competitor, performer, work ethic, all those things, he’s as good as I’ve ever been around.”

Weiss said the discussion with Sale in his office did not include any mention of how pitching in relief Thursday night could affect the left-hander’s availability for a possible start on Sunday in Game 2 of the NL Division Series at the Los Angeles Dodgers.

Even without the work in relief to close the first-round series, four days’ rest would be less than Sale often was given in the regular season, when he was 14-9 with a 2.16 ERA. Sale, 37, often was given extra rest and that helped him stay strong and record 200 strikeouts in 162 2/3 innings.

When asked whether Sale was an option for Sunday’s game, Weiss said “I don’t know. I have no idea. We weren’t even wor-

ried about that. We haven’t even talked about that. We didn’t look past tonight.”

The Braves had Sale and Tyler Mahle start the first two games against the Phillies. Mahle allowed only one run in seven innings in Wednesday’s 4-3 loss in 10 innings despite suffering an abdominal pull during his pre-game warmup. Weiss was concerned Mahle wouldn’t be able to make the start and said Mahle felt better Thursday though still felt some discomfort.

Reliever Ray Kerr allowed only one hit in 3 1/3 scoreless innings as the opener on Thursday night and probably will be part of the Braves’ plans against the Dodgers.

Kerr’s strong performance against the Phillies was an important boost for the Braves’ depleted rotation.

“I was feeding off the crowd from the first pitch of the game,” Kerr said. “They motivated me to keep going, throw even harder, throw even more. Every time I threw a strike, they were yelling, so I have to give it up to the fans.”

Left-hander Martín Pérez would have been part of the postseason rotation before landing on the 15-day injured list

Sept. 24 with lower back inflammation. The Braves also have lost starting pitchers Spencer Schwellenbach, Spencer Strider, Reynaldo López and Hurston Waldrep this season.

Weiss said “There’s nobody on the planet that had us” in the postseason when the injuries included such projected frontline starters as Schwellenbach and Strider.

“Nobody had us making the playoffs,” Weiss said. “These guys have overcome so much. ... It’s guys like Ray Kerr and everybody else that step up and perform when the stakes are highest. It’s such a great group.”

Right-hander Bryce Elder threw off the mound on the Braves’ workout on Monday before the start of the Wild Card Series and could be close to returning from the injured list after having surgery on his right knee on Sept. 7. Other possible options include AJ Smith-Shawver and JR Ritchie.

Following games Saturday and Sunday in Los Angeles, the best-of-five division series shifts to Atlanta on Tuesday and Wednesday, if necessary. A fifth game, if necessary, would be played in Los Angeles.

— Associated Press

MLB NOTES

Yankees’ Cole gets start for Game 1 vs. the Rays

Associated Press

Gerrit Cole will start for the New York Yankees against Drew Rasmussen and the Tampa Bay Rays in Saturday night’s American League Division Series opener.

Cole was set to start Game 3 of the Wild Card Series against Boston on Thursday but the Yankees swept their division rival. The 36-year-old right-hander, a six-time all-star, was 10-9 with a 3.61 ERA in 22 starts this season after recovering from Tommy John surgery that caused him to miss the 2025 season.

Rasmussen was 16-5 with a 2.67 ERA for the Rays and made the all-star team for the second straight season. The 31-year-old right-hander twice had surgery for a torn ligament in his elbow in college and needed an internal brace procedure in July 2023 that forced him to miss more than a year.

He is 5-2 with a 1.81 ERA in 10 starts and one relief appearance against the Yankees, striking out 70 in 59 2/3 innings.

Tampa Bay led the AL with 98 wins, earning a bye and home-field advantage at renovated Tropicana Field. They had to play their 2025 home games across the bay in Tampa at Steinbrenner Field — the spring training home of the Yankees — following damage to the Trop caused by Hurricane Milton on Oct. 9, 2024.

The Rays haven’t won a postseason series since 2020, when they lost the World Series to the Los Angeles Dodgers. They beat the Yankees 3-2 in the Division Series and won the franchise’s second pennant. ...

Yankees captain Aaron Judge remains uncertain for the series against the Rays as he recovers from a calf injury.

The three-time AL MVP, who hasn’t played since Sept. 16, took live batting practice Thursday at Yankee Stadium and worked out Friday at the team’s spring training ballpark in Tampa. New York must submit its 26-man roster to Major League Baseball by 10 a.m. Saturday, about 10 hours before the opener.

Tropicana Field has artificial turf, which factors into whether Judge will be ready to return to right field.

• **RED SOX:** Boston first base-



ADAM HUNGER/AP

The Yankees’ Gerrit Cole, 36, will get the start in Game 1 of the ALDS against the Rays.

man and catcher Mickey Gasper underwent what the team says was a successful repair of his right biceps tendon.

The club made the announcement on Friday. The procedure was performed by Matthew Leibman at MassGeneral Brigham in Boston.

Gasper started Boston’s final regular-season series against the Chicago Cubs on Sept. 25 at catcher but was replaced in the sixth inning after experiencing discomfort in his biceps.

He was placed on the injured list and was not on the Red Sox’s roster for their Wild Card Series loss to the Yankees.

The 30-year-old New Hampshire native played a career-high 67 games in his third major league season, batting .251 with 10 home runs and 24 RBI.

SATURDAY’S COLLEGE FOOTBALL TV GAMES

EARLY SHIFT

Noon	Navy at Air Force » WUSA (Ch. 9), WJZ (Ch. 13), WFED (1500 AM)
Noon	Michigan at Minnesota » WTTG (Ch. 5), WBFF (Ch. 45)
Noon	Alabama at Mississippi State » WJLA (Ch. 7), WMAR (Ch. 2)
Noon	Boston College at SMU » WDCW (Ch. 50), WNUV (Ch. 54)
Noon	West Virginia at Iowa State » TNT
Noon	Notre Dame at North Carolina » ESPN
Noon	Stanford at Wake Forest » ACC Network
Noon	Middle Tennessee at Kansas » ESPNU
Noon	UCF at Houston » ESPN2
Noon	Syracuse at Connecticut » CBS Sports Network
12:30 p.m.	Michigan State at Wisconsin » Big Ten Network
12:45 p.m.	Vanderbilt at Georgia » SEC Network
1 p.m.	Towson at Monmouth » Monumental Sports Network

A visit from Alabama usually means a bad day for Mississippi State. But quarterback Kamario Taylor’s dynamism and recent effectiveness in the clutch has the Bulldogs’ cowbell-ringing fans hoping this time will be different from every other time these teams have played since 2007. The past six meetings haven’t been close, with the Crimson Tide winning each by at least 23 points. **No. 7 Alabama** also has dominated its first four opponents this season. **No. 16 Mississippi State** has had to weather a little more adversity so far, winning its two SEC games by a single touchdown.

SWING SHIFT

3:30 p.m.	Virginia at Florida State » ESPN2, WSNB (630 AM)
3:30 p.m.	Florida at Missouri » WJLA (Ch. 7), WMAR (Ch. 2)
3:30 p.m.	Ohio State at Iowa » WUSA (Ch. 9), WJZ (Ch. 13)
3:30 p.m.	Wyoming at North Dakota State » WDCW (Ch. 50), WNUV (Ch. 54)
3:30 p.m.	Tennessee at Auburn » ESPN
3:30 p.m.	Louisville at North Carolina State » ACC Network
3:30 p.m.	California at UNLV » CBS Sports Network
3:45 p.m.	Marshall at James Madison » ESPNU
4 p.m.	Maryland at Nebraska » Fox Sports 1, WJZ (105.7 FM), WTEM (980 AM)
4:15 p.m.	Kentucky at South Carolina » SEC Network
4:15 p.m.	Purdue at Illinois » Big Ten Network

Kinnick is no picnic. That said, Coach Ryan Day said **No. 5 Ohio State** will be better for going through the experience — if his team is able to leave Kinnick Stadium with a win over **No. 14 Iowa**. In 2017, the previous time these teams met in Iowa City, the Hawkeyes won in a blowout and eliminated the then-No. 3 Buckeyes from College Football Playoff contention. Ohio State won the past two meetings by a combined 89-17 at the Horseshoe in Columbus. Keeping star wide receiver Jeremiah Smith under control — he tied a program record with four touchdown catches last week against Illinois — will be a challenge for Iowa.

LATE SHIFT

6 p.m.	Oregon State at Colorado State » USA Network
7 p.m.	BYU at TCU » ESPN
7 p.m.	Arkansas at Texas A&M » ESPN2
7:30 p.m.	Washington at USC » WRC (Ch. 4), WBAL (Ch. 11)
7:30 p.m.	Miami at Clemson » WJLA (Ch. 7), WMAR (Ch. 2)
7:30 p.m.	Temple at South Florida » ESPNU
7:30 p.m.	Utah State at Boise State » CBS Sports Network
7:45 p.m.	McNeese at LSU » SEC Network
8 p.m.	Indiana at Rutgers » Big Ten Network
9:30 p.m.	Fresno State at Washington State » USA Network
10:30 p.m.	Texas State at San Diego State » WDCW (Ch. 50), WNUV (Ch. 54)
10:30 p.m.	Baylor at Arizona State » ESPN
10:30 p.m.	Eastern Washington at UC Davis » ESPN2
11 p.m.	Cincinnati at Arizona » WTTG (Ch. 5), WBFF (Ch. 45)

Coach Kalani Sitake and **No. 10 BYU** treated last week just like any other, except they didn’t have a game. After an early open date, the Cougars have nine games over nine weeks in their push to get back to another Big 12 championship game, a stretch that begins at **TCU**. After just missing the CFP last season as the Big 12 runner-up, BYU could secure a third straight 4-0 start for the first time. On the flipside, the Horned Frogs are trying to avoid their first 0-2 start in conference play since 2013.

— Associated Press

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PROFESSIONAL FOOTBALL

PERSPECTIVE

For Ravens’ Minter, negotiating learning curve is all part of the coaching process

BY MIKE PRESTON

This season has gone as expected, even in only three games. The Baltimore Ravens beat the Indianapolis Colts convincingly in the season opener, were upset by the New Orleans Saints in Week 2, and then survived a poorly coached Dallas Cowboys team, 34-31, last weekend in Brazil. Baltimore is 2-1, but that's much better than 1-2. The “shake-up,” which was suggested nearly a month ago, continues as the Ravens host Tennessee on Sunday. The Titans are scary because they haven't won yet. They'll eventually win two, maybe three games. But it's less about Tennessee than it is about the Ravens. First-year coach Jesse Minter is still going through a growth spurt, which is part of the process.

“I don't really like the word comfortable, because I don't think you're ever comfortable,” Minter said. “I challenge the coaches every week to be better in our processes of how we get guys ready to play, be better in our processes of how we game plan. I think especially when you have new coordinators with new position coaches that haven't worked together, it does take time for that to really gel and to make sure that the process of preparing is the best that it can be. That's what we're chasing. “I do think we have a bunch of really good players. I think we're figuring out where guys fit best and what they do best as we go, which is going to obviously be an ongoing thing. But yes, I don't think there's ever a comfort in any of that stuff.” Maybe after five or six games, Minter will have more definite plans, but he is still shuffling players and devising schemes. While he chooses to speak more about the Ravens' offensive problems, it's the defense that has been exploited. The Cowboys have explo-



Captions: Coach Jesse Minter has the Ravens at 2-1 as he navigates the ups-and-downs of his first season in charge but poor tackling is a vexing issue.

sive weapons in wide receivers George Pickens and CeeDee Lamb, and Dallas quarterback Dak Prescott completed 25 of 40 passes for 276 yards and a touchdown against Baltimore. The Ravens are ranked 14th in both total and rush defense, allowing 398.7 total yards and 167.3 rushing yards per game. Dallas running back Javonte Williams rushed 19 times for 98 yards. That's embarrassing. So one of the major focuses this week will be tackling, which has been atrocious so far. “If you miss, it's okay. Your other guys are going to be there.

Right now, we're playing in a way where [there is] one missed tackle, and other guys are reacting to that, rather than like, ‘Man, we need 11 hats at the ball every play,’ Minter said. “I feel really good about the direction that's going. We've had a couple of good meetings to shake some things out with the defense. But again, it will be how we play on Sunday. It's easy to talk about what we're going to do. It's an action-based solution that we're looking for right now. [We are] just one day in. [I am] happy with the way the guys responded and how we practiced that

today.” It's been a season of ups and downs, with more of a positive upswing. But safety Kyle Hamilton questioned the Ravens after the game, suggesting the offense shouldn't have to score 30 points to win. He was correct, and maybe some of the former first- and second-round draft picks in recent years need to step up, like safety Malaki Starks, the first-round pick out of Georgia in his second season, or outside linebackers Mike Green (second season) and Zion Young (rookie). They have time to grow, but

the Ravens need them to step up fast. The same can be said for veteran middle linebacker Roquan Smith, who leads the team in tackles with 28 but is more of a free-roaming, fast-runner type than Ray Lewis, who could shock and shed as well as run. The Ravens have to find ways to keep opposing offensive linemen off Smith and get more out of veterans such as outside linebacker Trey Hendrickson (four tackles) and safety Jaylinn Hawkins (14). Time has become more important now with every team in the AFC North sitting at 2-1 en-

tering Thursday night. The season is down to 14 games. Offensively, quarterback Lamar Jackson looks comfortable, and the Ravens got a big jolt Sunday with the return of slot receiver Zay Flowers, whose speed opens up space over the middle. But injuries have hampered the offensive line, with three centers suffering long-term injuries: Danny Pinter, Jovaughn Gwyn and Ethan Pocic. At least left tackle Ronnie Stanley was on the practice field Wednesday, and rookie right guard Vega Ioane is expected to start at center, where he played just 17 snaps at Penn State. “No matter where it is, it is just like we will never stop putting in that work getting ready for the game,” Ioane said. “It is nonstop hours of coaching on little things of this and that. I would say making the calls, IDs, and things like that. Center is definitely a hard job.” But if receiver Rashod Bateman steps up, it will make it easier for Flowers. If the Ravens could find a blocking tight end, they might be able to run both Jackson and running back Derrick Henry off the corner or the edge. But it still comes down to the learning curve. The Titans are in that state with new coach Robert Saleh, 47, even though he compiled a 20-36 record as New York Jets coach from 2021 through 2024. Tennessee hired new offensive coordinator Brian Daboll, who coached the New York Giants from 2022 through last season. “If we can stay out of our own way, how good could we be, really, in all three phases?” Minter said. “That starts with me and just the plan and our processes of how we get to everything.” Minter never becomes comfortable, and maybe that's a good thing. Of course, like everything else in the NFL, it all comes down to wins and losses. — Baltimore Sun

NFL NOTEBOOK

In a mutual separation, Romo leaves role at CBS

Associated Press CBS Sports and Tony Romo have officially parted ways, one month after the former Dallas Cowboys quarterback pleaded no contest to charges of operating a vehicle while intoxicated. Romo had been on leave since his July 23 arrest in Wisconsin. He had been the lead game analyst for CBS' NFL coverage since 2017. “CBS Sports and Tony Romo have mutually agreed to part ways,” CBS Sports said Friday in a statement. “We thank Tony for his contributions over the past nine years and wish him the best moving forward.” Analyst JJ Watt had joined play-by-play announcer Jim Nantz and sideline reporter Tracy Wolfson on CBS Sports' lead NFL team during Romo's absence. Watt will continue in that role now and all other CBS teams will remain the same. “I'm proud of what I accomplished at CBS Sports over the last nine years,” Romo said in a statement. “I approached my role as a game analyst the way I've approached everything in my life — with a desire to win and be the best that I can be. I'm going to use this time to take a break, something I've never done before, and focus on my health and my family before moving on to my next opportunity. I am grateful for my time with CBS Sports and for the continued support of my family and friends, as well as the NFL community and fans.” Romo was arrested following a traffic stop as he was driving south on Interstate 43 in Wisconsin. He pleaded no contest to a charge of operating while intoxicated on Sept. 1 and issued a statement apologizing for the actions that led to his arrest. · **49ERS:** The NFL suspended San Francisco owner Jed York for six games following his arrest earlier this year in a prostitution sting in Ohio. The league announced that York also was fined \$500,000 for violating the league's personal conduct policy. York has not attended any games or league meetings so far this season and was credited with three games served. He is eligible to return Oct. 20, following the team's game the previous night against Washington. The NFL's fall league meetings begin that day

Robertson is thriving after journey of self-discovery

COMMANDERS FROM B7

“I nearly lost myself. My confidence was gone,” Robertson told The Washington Post. “I was close to giving up on football.” Robertson eventually overcame that and found his conviction, but the edge that he developed along the way hasn't gone anywhere. “There was a giant chip on his shoulder,” Coach Dan Quinn said, “and it ain't never left.” Swatting away doubt The seventh-year veteran has had no shortage of personal challenges. His father was incarcerated when Robertson was born and wouldn't become a part of his life until more than a decade later. He and his two siblings were raised by their mother, and they moved frequently around Thibodaux, Louisiana, as she worked to support them. Then, when he was just 16, Robertson had his first child. He had to balance helping his mother and siblings with raising a child of his own. Throughout it all, football was his refuge. Immersed in the sport, Robertson was free from his burdens. From youth football to Louisiana Tech, that was where he thrived. And then came the NFL. The Las Vegas Raiders took Robertson in the fourth round of the 2020 draft. He had expected to go much higher, but questions about his size — he's only 5-foot-9 — contributed to his fall down draft boards. That knock was something that he had always dealt with and found easy to shake off. He had supreme confidence that his play would silence the critics, and it almost always did. That's not how his first few years in the league played out. Robertson was never a Week 1 starter across four seasons with the Raiders. He started nine games from 2021 to 2022, but he was repeatedly benched and couldn't carve out a consistent role. This time, he couldn't block out the criticism he faced. It ate away at him. Following his third season, Robertson isolated himself. He spent that offseason alone in Dallas. More than the physical elements of his game, he pushed himself to be more resilient mentally. “It just came to a point where I had to go back to my roots,” Robertson said. “All of the negativity that I was seeing, I was



Captions: “I nearly lost myself. My confidence was gone,” said Commanders defensive back Amik Robertson of his early years in the NFL.

like, ‘Just feed off of that. Don't get offended by it. Use it as fuel.’ And that's what I did. I built myself back together.” Robertson started 12 games the following season and showed he had potential. At the time, his experience with the Raiders made him miserable. But he's now grateful for it. “It molded me into the man I am today,” Robertson said. “It taught me how to how to handle adversity. I never lose my confidence. ... That journey, man, I still carry with me till this day. I'm always out there playing with that fire because I know how I felt. I felt worthless, and I just never want to feel like that again.” Rising up Robertson's next step was to show he could become an impact player, not merely a replacement-level starter. Seeking that opportunity, he entered free agency for the first time in 2024 and signed with the Detroit Lions. He won the starting nickelback job following a training camp position battle. When cornerback Carlton Davis was injured late in the season, Robertson moved outside to replace him.

In the final game of the season, Robertson limited superstar wide receiver Justin Jefferson to two catches in a win over the Minnesota Vikings. After he earned the game ball, his post-game speech went viral. “They tried to bury me,” a tearful Robertson said, “but they can't bury what comes from the dirt.” That was a turning point for Robertson. He felt like himself again, and the emotion was a culmination of all the obstacles he'd faced. “If any other player would have got dealt the same card that I had, he probably would've broke,” Robertson said. “But I didn't because I already came from the bottom. I've made it through the worst situation already. ... If I could make it from Thibodaux, Louisiana, man, I could do anything.” After starting 10 games in Detroit last season, Robertson hit free agency once again. The Commanders' pass defense struggled in 2025, and cornerback stood out as a major need entering the offseason. So they signed Robertson to a two-year, \$16 million deal — partially because the coaching staff was confident he could help others in the

secondary rise up. “That's what the coaching staff told me: ‘Look, we want you to come in here and be you,’” Robertson recalled. “‘We need guys like you. That energy and that the passion you play with is contagious, and we want guys to see that.’” By the end of the offseason, Robertson asserted himself as the leader of the cornerback room. “I'm a highly competitive guy,” Robertson said. “I'll tell the guys on the defense, ‘Hey, let's see who got the most energy out here today. Let me see if y'all going to match mine.’ It's contagious.” Aiming higher Robertson is playing the best football of his career. He has put in work to sharpen his technique, discipline and attention to detail. But he also gives credit to defensive coordinator Daronte Jones's aggressive, zone coverage-heavy scheme. “Of course, I can play man, but it helps just having that vision on the quarterback,” Robertson said. “It allows you to be able to really go after the ball. You can't catch what you can't see.” The Commanders have leaned on Robertson more than anticipated since cornerback Trey Amos (ankle) has been on injured reserve. But while Robertson has stepped up, his performance hasn't been enough to stop Washington's pass defense from remaining among the worst in the NFL. The Commanders are allowing opponents to complete 70.6 percent of their passes (29th) and giving up 8.6 yards per attempt (28th). They have surrendered 12 passing touchdowns — the most in the league. The secondary's issues — frequent miscommunication, blown assignments, poor execution — have been multifaceted. Even though Robertson has been playing well, he still takes ownership of those problems. His individual success isn't enough. He said they're “headed in the right direction” and hopes that, over time, the secondary can put it all together. And when it comes to his own play, Robertson knows there's still plenty of room for improvement. After all, he wants to be regarded as one of the best cornerbacks in the NFL. “I sit at the table with the 1 percent that made it to the league,” Robertson said. “I want to sit at that *other* table.”

SCOREBOARD

PRO FOOTBALL

NFL

NFC					
EAST	W	L	T	PCT	PF PA
Philadelphia.....	2	1	0	.667	55 69
N.Y. Giants.....	2	1	0	.667	46 55
Dallas.....	1	2	0	.333	88 82
Washington.....	1	2	0	.333	75 92

SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF PA
Carolina.....	1	2	0	.333	89 83
New Orleans.....	1	2	0	.333	81 83
Atlanta.....	1	2	0	.333	51 68
Tampa Bay.....	0	3	0	.000	62 79

NORTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF PA
Minnesota.....	3	0	0	1.000	71 41
Detroit.....	2	1	0	.667	61 61
Chicago.....	2	1	0	.667	89 53
Green Bay.....	1	2	0	.333	56 91

WEST	W	L	T	PCT	PF PA
San Francisco.....	3	0	0	1.000	98 50
Seattle.....	2	1	0	.667	75 63
L.A. Rams.....	1	2	0	.333	61 63
Arizona.....	1	2	0	.333	63 81

AFC					
EAST	W	L	T	PCT	PF PA
Buffalo.....	3	0	0	1.000	101 76
N.Y. Jets.....	2	1	0	.667	64 61
New England.....	1	2	0	.333	56 51
Miami.....	0	3	0	.000	36 86

SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF PA
Jacksonville.....	2	1	0	.667	82 36
Indianapolis.....	1	2	0	.333	72 81
Tennessee.....	0	3	0	.000	37 59
Houston.....	0	3	0	.000	54 75

NORTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF PA
Cleveland.....	3	1	0	.750	81 95
Baltimore.....	2	1	0	.667	92 76
Cincinnati.....	2	1	0	.667	80 63
Pittsburgh.....	2	2	0	.500	77 87

WEST	W	L	T	PCT	PF PA
Kansas City.....	3	0	0	1.000	88 50
Las Vegas.....	3	0	0	1.000	88 54
Denver.....	2	1	0	.667	60 70
L.A. Chargers.....	0	3	0	.000	44 76

WEEK 4
THURSDAY'S RESULT
at Cleveland 27, Pittsburgh 24

SUNDAY'S GAMES

Indianapolis vs Washington in London, 9:30 a.m.
Tennessee at Baltimore, 1
Arizona at N.Y. Giants, 1
Dallas at Houston, 1
Green Bay at Tampa Bay, 1
Jacksonville at Cincinnati, 1
L.A. Rams at Philadelphia, 1
N.Y. Jets at Chicago, 1
New England at Buffalo, 1
Miami at Minnesota, 4:05
Denver at San Francisco, 4:25
Kansas City at Las Vegas, 4:25
L.A. Chargers at Seattle, 4:25
Detroit at Carolina, 8:20

MONDAY'S GAMES

Atlanta at New Orleans, 8:15

WEEK 5

THURSDAY'S GAME

Tampa Bay at Dallas, 8:15

SUNDAY, OCT. 11

N.Y. Giants at Washington, 1
Baltimore at Atlanta, 8:20
Philadelphia vs. Jacksonville in London, 9:30 a.m.
Chicago at Green Bay, 1
Cincinnati at Miami, 1
Cleveland at N.Y. Jets, 1
Houston at Tennessee, 1
Indianapolis at Pittsburgh, 1
Las Vegas at New England, 1
Minnesota at New Orleans, 1
Denver at L.A. Chargers, 4:05
Detroit at Arizona, 4:25
San Francisco at Seattle, 4:25
Open: Kansas City, Carolina

MONDAY, OCT. 12

Buffalo at L.A. Rams, 8:15

Browns 27, Steelers 24

PITTSBURGH.....	7	3	0	14	— 24
CLEVELAND.....	0	21	0	6	— 27

FIRST QUARTER

PITTSBURGH: R.Wilson 12 pass from Rodgers (Boswell kick), 2:56. Drive: 17 plays, 78 yards, 9:48. Key Plays: Rodgers 15 pass to Metcalf on 3rd-and-11; Rodgers 7 pass to Metcalf on 3rd-and-3; Rodgers 11 pass to Warren; Rodgers 9 pass to Pittman on 3rd-and-16; Homer 2 run on 3rd-and-1.

SECOND QUARTER

CLEVELAND: McLaughlin 28 run (Smytk kick), 12:14. Drive: 4 plays, 56 yards, 1:57. Key Plays: Ward 0 interception return to Cleveland; 4; D.Watson 13 pass to Fannin; D.Watson 12 pass to Jenkins.

CLEVELAND: Jenkins 2 run (Smytk kick), 8:28. Drive: 4 plays, 74 yards, 2:10. Key Play: D.Watson 60 pass to Boston.

CLEVELAND: Fannin 2 pass from D.Watson (Smytk kick), 1:22. Drive: 11 plays, 62 yards, 3:59. Key Plays: D.Watson 9 pass to Boston on 3rd-and-6; D.Watson 25 pass to Concepcion.

PITTSBURGH: FG Boswell 31, :08. Drive: 7 plays, 59 yards, 1:14. Key Plays: Wetjen kick return to Pittsburgh 28; Rodgers 49 pass to R.Wilson.

FOURTH QUARTER

PITTSBURGH: D.Washington 21 pass from Rodgers (pass failed), 10:10. Drive: 6 plays, 77 yards, 3:59. Key Plays: Spears-Jennings 0 interception return to Cleveland 23; Rodgers 43 pass to Metcalf; Rodgers 13 pass to Warren; Warren 2 run on 3rd-and-1.

CLEVELAND: FG Smytk 44, 6:37. Drive: 8 plays, 40 yards, 2:33. Key Plays: Corley kick return to Cleveland 34; D.Watson 17 pass to Jenkins; D.Watson 21 run on 3rd-and-5; D.Watson 7 run on 3rd-and-9.

PITTSBURGH: Flemerthus 3 pass from Rodgers (Rodgers run), 1:42. Drive: 8 plays, 81 yards, 1:50. Key Plays: Rodgers 13 pass to R.Wilson; Rodgers 22 pass to Metcalf; Rodgers 28 pass to Metcalf.

CLEVELAND: FG Smytk 56, :10. Drive: 8 plays, 36 yards, 1:32. Key Plays: R.Sanders kick return to Cleveland 26; D.Watson 17 yards to Judy; D.Watson 12 pass to Fannin; D.Watson 10 pass to Judy.

AT 68:156.

	Pit	Cle
FIRST DOWNS.....	24	22
Rushing.....	8	6
Passing.....	11	14
Penalty.....	5	4
THIRD DOWN EFF.....	4-13	5-10
FOURTH DOWN EFF.....	0-0	0-0
TOTAL NET YARDS.....	361	372
Total Plays.....	22-40	22-40
Avg Gain.....	5.6	6.0
NET YARDS RUSHING.....	92	112
Rushes.....	19	27
Avg per rush.....	4.842	4.148
NET YARDS PASSING.....	269	260
Sacked-Yds lost.....	5-30	2-8
Gross-Yds passing.....	299	268
Completed-Att.....	22-40	24-33
Had Intercepted.....	2	1
Yards-Pass Play.....	5.978	7.429
KICKOFFS-EndZone-TB.....	5-2-1	6-2-2
PUNTS-Avg.....	5-11.8	4-6.275
Plays blocked.....	0	0
FGs-PATs blocked.....	0-0	0-0
TOTAL RETURN YARDAGE.....	126	109
Punt Returns.....	2-30	2-10
Kickoff Returns.....	4-96	4-90
Interceptions.....	1-0	2-0
PENALTIES-Yds.....	8-50	14-88
FUMBLES-Lost.....	0-0	2-1
TIME OF POSSESSION.....	31:11	28:49

RUSHING
PITTSBURGH: Warren 17-93, Homer 2-(minus 1), Cleveland: Jenkins 17-53, McLaughlin 1-28, D.Watson 7-22, R.Sanders 2-9.

PASSING
PITTSBURGH: Rodgers 22-40-2-299, Cleveland: D.Watson 24-33-1-268.

RECEIVING

PITTSBURGH: Metcalf 5-115, R.Wilson 3-74, Warren 3-33, Washington 3-27, Flemerthus 3-17, Pittman 2-15, Bernard 2-11, Skowronek 1-7, Cleveland: Jenkins 6-43, Concepcion 5-64, Boston 4-89, Judy 3-36, Fannin 3-27, R.Sanders 2-7, Bond 1-2.

PUNT RETURNS

PITTSBURGH: Wetjen 2-30, Cleveland: Concepcion 2-10.

KICKOFF RETURNS

PITTSBURGH: Wetjen 4-96, Cleveland: R.Sanders 3-66, Corley 1-33.

TACKLES-ASSISTS-SACKS

PITTSBURGH: Spears-Jennings 6-1-0, P.Wilson 5-2-1, Brisker 4-3-0, Watt 4-0-1, Heyward 3-4-0, Queen 3-2-0, Everett 3-0-0, Black 2-3-0, Benton 2-1-0, Sawyer 2-1-0, Herbig 1-1-0, Highsmith 1-0-0, Ramsey 1-0-0, Joseph-Day 0-2-0, Dean 0-1-0, Holcomb 0-1-0, Samuel 0-1-0, Cleveland: Campbell 6-1-0, Deloit 4-2-0, Schwesinger 3-6-0, Ward 3-1-0, Collins 2-2-1, McGuire 2-1-1, Harden 2-1-0, Hickman 1-4-0, Huntington 1-2-1, McNeil-Warren 1-2-0, S.Williams 1-1-1, Verse 1-1-0, Hall 1-0-1, Blackman 1-0-0, Mascarenas-Armold 1-0-0, Q.Williams 0-4-0.

INTERCEPTIONS

PITTSBURGH: Spears-Jennings 1-0, Cleveland: Deloit 1-0, Ward 1-0.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

PITTSBURGH: Boswell 48.

OFFICIALS

Referee Clete Blakeman; **Ump** Scott Walker, **HL** Andy Warner, **LJ** Kent Payne, **FJ** Karina Tovar, **SJ** James Coleman, **BJ** Jonathan Monroe, **Replay** Chad Adams.

BASEBALL

MLB playoffs

FIRST ROUND

Best of three; x-If necessary

BRAVES ELIMINATED PHILLIES, 2-1
Game 1: at Atlanta 5, Philadelphia 3
Game 2: Philadelphia 4, at Atlanta 3 (10)
Game 3: at Atlanta 6, Philadelphia 2

WHITE SOX ELIMINATED ASTROS, 2-0
Game 1: Chi. White Sox 6, at Houston 3
Game 2: at N.Y. Yankees 9, Boston 2

YANKEES ELIMINATED RED SOX, 2-0
Game 1: at N.Y. Yankees 9, Boston 0
Game 2: at N.Y. Yankees 9, Boston 2

PADRES ELIMINATED CUBS, 2-0
Game 1: at San Diego 8, Chi. Cubs 0
Game 2: at San Diego 4, Chi. Cubs 1

DIVISION SERIES

Best of five; x-If necessary

NATIONAL LEAGUE
PADRES VS. BREWERS
Saturday's game: San Diego at Milwaukee, 8:30
Sunday's game: San Diego at Milwaukee, 4
Tuesday's game: Milwaukee at San Diego, 9:30
x-Wednesday's game: Milwaukee at San Diego, 10
x-Thursday's game: San Diego at Milwaukee, 4:30

BRAVES VS. DODGERS
Saturday's game: Atlanta at L.A. Dodgers, 4
Sunday's game: Atlanta at L.A. Dodgers, 8
Tuesday's game: L.A. Dodgers at Atlanta, 6
x-Wednesday's game: L.A. Dodgers at Atlanta, 6
x-Friday's game: Atlanta at L.A. Dodgers, 8

AMERICAN LEAGUE

YANKEES VS. RAYS
Saturday's game: N.Y. Yankees at Tampa Bay, 6:30
Monday's game: N.Y. Yankees at Tampa Bay, 8
Wednesday's game: Tampa Bay at N.Y. Yankees, 8
x-Thursday's game: Tampa Bay at N.Y. Yankees, 8
x-Saturday, Oct. 10: N.Y. Yankees at Tampa Bay, 8

WHITE SOX VS. GUARDIANS

Saturday's game: Chi. White Sox at Cleveland, 1
Monday's game: Chi. White Sox at Cleveland, 5
Wednesday's game: Cleveland at Chi. White Sox, 4
x-Thursday's game: Cleveland at Chi. White Sox, 5
x-Saturday, Oct. 10: Chi. White Sox at Cleveland, 5

CHAMPIONSHIP SERIES

NATIONAL LEAGUE

Best of seven; starts Oct. 11

AMERICAN LEAGUE

Best of seven; starts Oct. 12

WORLD SERIES

Best of seven; starts Oct. 23

Braves 6, Phillies 2

Late Thursday							
PHILLIES	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	AVG
Turner ss.....	3	0	1	0	1	0	.091
Schwarber dh.....	3	1	2	0	1	0	.364
Harper rf-1b.....	4	0	1	0	0	2	.231
Bohm 1b-3b.....	4	0	1	1	0	0	.333
Stott 2b.....	4	0	0	0	0	2	.154
De La Cruz lf-rf.....	4	0	1	0	0	1	.222
Sosa 3b.....	4	0	0	0	0	2	.226
Marsh ph-lf.....	1	0	0	0	1	0	.400
Kemp ph.....	1	0	0	0	1	0	.000
Realmon c.....	3	0	0	0	0	0	.200
Crawford c.....	2	0	0	0	0	0	.143
Hill ph-cf.....	1	1	1	0	0	0	.200
TOTALS	31	2	6	2	2	6	

BRAVES	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	AVG
Baldwin cf.....	4	0	0	0	0	0	.154
Aculia rf.....	3	1	1	0	1	0	.111
Olson 1b.....	3	2	1	1	1	0	.182
Harris cf.....	3	1	3	0	1	1	.455
Dubin ss.....	3	0	0	0	0	0	.223
Yastrzemski lf.....	4	0	0	0	0	2	.111
Riley 2b.....	2	1	0	0	2	0	.222
Albies 2b.....	3	1	1	2	1	1	.333
Smith dh.....	3	0	0	0	1	1	.400
TOTALS	29	6	6	5	6	5	—

PHILLIES.....:000 :001 :010 :— :2 :6 :0
BRAVES.....:000 :200 :10X :— :6 :6 :0

LOB: Phillies 5, Braves 5. **2B:** Harper (1), 3B: Hill (1). **HR:** Harris (1), off Nola; Albies (1), off Wheeler; Olson (1), off Bowlan. **RBI's:** Bohm (3), Turner (1), Harris (3), Albies 2 (3), Olson (3). **SF:** Turner.

Runners left in scoring position: Phillips 3 (Kemp, Stott 2); Braves 1 (Smith). **RISP:** Phillies 0 for 6; Braves 1 for 2.

Runners moved up: Bohm 2. **GIDP:** Crawford, Baldwin.

DP: Phillips 1 (Bohm, Turner, Bohm); Braves 1 (Albies, Dubin, Olson).

PHILLIES	IP	H	R	BB	SO	ERA
Nola.....	1 1/3	2	3	3	2	16.20
Mayza.....	1	0	0	0	0	0.00
Wheeler.....	4	2	2	3	3	4.50
Bowlan.....	1	1	1	0	0	9.00
Duran.....	1	0	0	0	2	9.00

BRAVES	IP	H	R	BB	SO	ERA
Ker.....	3 1/3	1	0	1	2	0.00
Holmes.....	2	1	1	1	1	4.50
Suarez.....	1	0	0	0	0	0.00
Fuentes.....	1	0	0	0	0	3.00
Dodd.....	1/3	1	1	0	0	13.50
Sal.....	1	0	0	0	3	3.52

WP: Holmes (1-0); **LP:** Nola (0-1).

Inherited runners scored: Mayza 1-0, Holmes 1-0, Suarez 1-1. **HPB:** Bowlan (Harris). **WP:** Holmes T: 2:46, A: 41,731 (41,149).

GOLF

PGA Tour

BANK OF UTAH CHAMPIONSHIP

At Black Desert Golf Course; In Ivins, Utah
Purse: \$6 million
Yardage: 7,421; **Par:** 71

FIRST ROUND — THURSDAY'S RESULTS

Zachary Bachou.....	31-31	62	-9
Nick Dunlap.....	32-31	63	-8
Steven Fisk.....	32-31	63	-8
Stephan Jaeger.....	32-31	63	-8
David Lipsky.....	33-30	63	-8
Kevin Roy.....	33-30	63	-8
Jordan L. Smith.....	31-32	63	-8
Austin Smotherman.....	32-31	63	-8
Sudarshan Yellamrathi.....	33-30	63	-8
Christian Bezdienhout.....	32-32	64	-7
Michael Brennan.....	34-30	64	-7
Garrick Higgo.....	36-28	64	-7
Robyn Choi.....	34-30	64	-7
Nick Taylor.....	32-32	64	-7
John VanderLaan.....	31-33	64	-7
Joel Dahmen.....	33-32	65	-6
A.J. Ewart.....	34-34	65	-6
David Ford.....	32-33	65	-6
Doug Chim.....	35-30	65	-6
Emiliano Grillo.....	33-32	65	-6
Max Homa.....	34-34	65	-6
Benjamin James.....	31-34	65	-6
Max McGreevy.....	34-31	65	-6
Erk Van Rooyen.....	35-30	65	-6
Zac Blair.....	34-32	66	-5
Eric Cole.....	34-32	66	-5
Trae Crowe.....	32-34	66	-5
Patrick Fitzhugh.....	34-32	66	-5
Billy Horschel.....	34-34	66	-5</

Doubt cast on Trump’s ‘military complex’ plan for arch

BY DAN DIAMOND

Trump administration officials said Tuesday that they were unaware of specific plans to convert President Donald Trump’s planned triumphal arch into a military complex, more than a week after Trump announced plans to put snipers, drones and ammunition at the site.

Senior officials at the Advisory Council on Historic Preservation (ACHP) and the National Park Service told advocacy groups that they were proceeding with existing plans for the arch’s design and features, including that it will be open to tourists,

according to three people with knowledge of the remarks.

The officials also told the groups that the administration had received no additional information from the Defense Department about militarizing the project, the people said.

Administration officials met with the advocates as part of a required process to evaluate the planned arch’s harm on nearby historic sites. Trump officials are hoping to build the 250-foot-tall arch in Memorial Circle, a traffic roundabout tucked inside Washington’s boundaries and near Arlington National Cemetery.

Spokespeople for ACHP and

THE PRESIDENT SAID IT WOULD FEATURE DRONES, SNIPERS

Officials said they were unaware of specific plans for that

the Interior Department, which oversees the Park Service, did not immediately respond to questions about the meeting.

Trump on Sept. 20 said on Truth Social that the arch would be converted into a “military complex” that would “house, store, and have the rapid ability to use large numbers of drones,

military and national security needs to expedite his construction projects and other priorities, including his planned White House ballroom. Administration officials are hoping to begin construction on the arch as soon as November.

In this case, however, the addition of military features could complicate the plans. Veterans groups, historic preservationists and local advocates who have urged Trump to move, shrink or halt the project, say Trump’s plan to militarize the arch would mean beginning a new process to analyze its impact on nearby sites.

“A new or supplemental review would be required,” Rebecca Miller, the executive director of the DC Preservation League, wrote Tuesday to the administration. The letter was shared with The Washington Post.

Democrats have signaled that they will seek to delay or stop the project if they regain control of one or both chambers of Congress after November’s midterm elections.

Sen. Jeff Merkley (D-Oregon), the top Democrat on the Senate Appropriations subcommittee that oversees money for federal parks, on Monday night intro-

SEE ARCH ON B15

A stroll around the grounds



TIERNY L. CROSS/REUTERS

Douglas Bradburn, director of George Washington’s Mount Vernon, gives a tour of the first president’s estate Thursday to Britain’s Prince Edward.

Charges cannot be refiled against former Olympian, judge says

The Reflecting Pool case against him was dismissed with prejudice

BY JASMINE GOLDEN AND LIAM BOWMAN

A judge Thursday said federal prosecutors cannot refile charges against a former Olympian who had been accused of damaging the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool only to have the case abruptly dropped weeks later.

“The Court respects the authority of the Office of the United States Attorney to decide which cases to prosecute and which to dismiss,” D.C. Superior Court Judge Todd E. Edelman said in his court order. “However, in the exceptional circumstances posed by this case, the government has no right to retain the ability to compound the errors it has al-



MARK SCHIEFELBEIN/AP

David Hearn, center, stands with his attorneys outside a D.C. courthouse last month.

ready made, or even to threaten to do so, at Mr. Hearn’s expense.”

The decision comes three months after David Hearn was arrested after he reached for a piece of liner floating in the Reflecting Pool. President Donald Trump blamed vandals for damaging the newly renovated landmark.

The Justice Department later would suggest the damage was from a “botched” and rushed installation. A Washington Post analysis found the peeling paint was probably caused by application flaws.

At a hearing in September, Assistant U.S. Attorney Michael Spence told the judge that if new evidence were to arise, the choice should be up to a grand jury whether to indict Hearn.

But Edelman on Thursday sided with Hearn’s attorneys, who had argued the case should be dismissed with prejudice, meaning the government cannot bring

SEE REFLECTING POOL ON B14

TODAY’S WEATHER

8 a.m.	Noon	4 p.m.	8 p.m.
61°	64°	66°	63°

High today at approx. 12 a.m.: 67°
Precip: 55% Wind: NNE 7-14 mph
For weather news, go to **B18**

MARYLAND
Ocean City mayor’s tram revival pitch draws pushback. **B15**

OBITUARY
Esther Rantzen, a British broadcaster and campaigner, was 86. **B16**



Case against former Olympian dismissed with prejudice

REFLECTING POOL FROM B13

charges against Hearn in the future.

In his order, Edelman wrote that Trump’s criticism of the decision to drop the case and repeated personal attacks against Hearn put him at risk of “a meritless, politically driven prosecution in the future.”

“Mr. Hearn faces the unique possibility that the government will revive this case — one that it has already announced to be meritless — based on political pressure brought by the President of the United States upon his subordinate officers,” Edelman wrote.

Edelman said prosecutors appeared to base their arguments that they should be free to charge Hearn again on “an entirely theoretical possibility that evidence may somehow appear that undermines its current well-founded conclusion that no crime was committed,” adding that it was unlike any case he could recall.

The White House declined to comment on the decision, referring The Post to previous social media posts by the president. The U.S. attorney’s office for D.C. did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

“This decision is a victory for the rule of law and for an inno-

“This decision is a victory for the rule of law and for an innocent American seeking justice.”

David Hearn’s attorneys,
Norm Eisen, Steve Levin, Mary Dohrmann and Michael Bromwich, in a statement Thursday

cent American seeking justice,” Hearn’s attorneys — Norm Eisen, Steve Levin, Mary Dohrmann and Michael Bromwich — said in a statement Thursday.

Hearn was one of at least four people arrested near the Reflecting Pool this summer and accused of vandalizing the pool basin.

U.S. Attorney Jeanine Pirro vowed to crack down on the alleged vandalism and secured a felony indictment against Hearn in July and misdemeanor charges against the others.

But weeks later, Pirro’s office unexpectedly moved to drop the cases, including Hearn’s

felony charge, after federal prosecutors claimed evidence from the Interior Department suggested the damage was due to faulty installation and not vandalism.

Trump blasted Pirro for dropping the charges and has continued to blame vandals.

Edelman dismissed the case against Hearn in August but reserved judgment on whether prosecutors should retain the option to resurrect the case.

Hearn’s attorneys said prosecutors should not be able to. They argued prosecutors were aware of problems with the installation at the Reflecting Pool all along, but pressed to indict

Hearn anyway.

During a status hearing in September, Edelman appeared skeptical of the government’s arguments for why federal prosecutors should be allowed to reopen the case, even as they conceded there was no probable cause to charge Hearn.

Edelman also pressed the government as to why it moved forward with a “rapid indictment” of Hearn.

Spence, the government attorney, said prosecutors had witness testimony and probable cause at the time of Hearn’s indictment. Federal prosecutors argued in court filings that they acted “in good faith.”



People walk outside the Kennedy Center on Sept. 24. The building closed last month amid a legal battle over whether President Donald Trump can add his name to the center.

THE DISTRICT

Following Kennedy Center’s closure, Trump will not rule out demolishing it

BY AMY B WANG

President Donald Trump is refusing to rule out demolishing the Kennedy Center, which closed last month amid a legal battle over whether Trump can add his name to the building.

“I’m not committing to anything,” Trump said in an interview with Time magazine that published Thursday. “We’re going to see how it plays out in court.”

Trump and his allies have argued that the Kennedy Center was structurally unsafe and

needed to be closed to undergo a two-year, \$250 million renovation. Trump, however, has said he won’t allow renovations to start unless he can put his name on the building.

“It’s in terrible shape. I’d be willing to save it, but it’s in ter-

rible, terrible shape. Only I can save it,” Trump told Time magazine.

Trump also compared the Kennedy Center to the White House, whose East Wing he demolished last year to begin constructing a 90,000-square-foot

ballroom that he has argued is necessary for national security.

“When I took it over, [the Kennedy Center] was in extremely bad shape physically. The steel was rusted and rotted,” Trump told the magazine. “The place was a dirty — like

the White House. I fixed the White House, you know.”

A federal judge has said the center must give at least 30 days’ notice of any demolition plans, and the center’s leader has declared in court the building won’t be torn down.

VIRGINIA

Richmond City Council asks mayor to formalize noncooperation with ICE

BY SAMUEL B. PARKER
Richmond Times-Dispatch

The City Council on Monday passed a resolution requesting that Mayor Danny Avula’s administration develop regulations forbidding city departments, agencies and employees from voluntarily cooperating with federal immigration enforcement.

Those regulations would “limit disclosure of information regarding citizenship or immigration status information held by the city, unless required by law, court order, subpoena, judicial warrant or authorized by the individual concerned.”

Already, Avula and Richmond police Chief Rick Edwards have vowed not to assist in federal

immigration enforcement in any capacity.

City Council’s request — which was brought by council member Nicole Jones and passed unanimously — would take that noncompliance a step further, providing city departments and agencies “clear guidance on how to handle sensitive information” and establishing “uniform standards for confidentiality, information access, employee conduct and transparency.”

“Residents of the city of Richmond should be able to access city services, programs, housing assistance, public health resources, public health resources, schools, emergency services and other governmental functions without fear that their personal information will be unnecessar-

“By clearly defining how information is shared and safeguarded, we are reinforcing our commitment to safety and dignity for all of our residents.”

Mayor Danny Avula,
who expressed eagerness to amend regulations, in a statement

ily disclosed or used for federal immigration enforcement,” the resolution read.

In a statement following the vote, Avula expressed eagerness to amend the regulations — an act he referred to as passing a “trust policy” — noting that “many cities across the country”

have codified such policies to “build the level of trust in the way their government serves immigrant communities.”

“By clearly defining how information is shared and safeguarded, we are reinforcing our commitment to safety and dignity for all of our residents,” he said.

City code’s administrative regulations do not apply to “any officer elected pursuant to the Virginia Constitution,” such as Richmond Commonwealth’s Attorney Colette McEachin and Sheriff Antionette Irving.

McEachin previously said she had “no authority to prosecute violations of federal law, including violations of any immigration laws,” but stopped short of explicitly clarifying whether her office would or would not cooperate with U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement.

The extent of Irving’s cooperation with ICE, meanwhile, is not clear.

In March, the Times-Dispatch reported that Irving’s office had declined to honor detainer requests from federal immigration

officers. A detainer is a request that federal, state or local law enforcement agencies notify ICE before releasing an immigrant without proper legal status and, in some cases, hold the person for up to 48 hours to allow ICE time to arrange for the apprehension.

Despite that refusal to execute detainers, a member of the public defender’s office told the newspaper that ICE had detained 13 of his office’s clients at the city jail “immediately before or after their release” from the sheriff’s custody. Those were the figures as of March.

Irving did not respond to questions on where her office had coordinated those arrests or admitted immigration enforcement personnel into the jail.



The Guide to Offers
The Washington Post

Enter for the chance to win a pair of tickets to Jessie Ware: The Superbloom Tour October 10

Join seven-time *Brit Award* and two-time *Mercury Prize* nominee Jessie Ware for an unforgettable night of live music. Seamlessly blending the intimate storytelling of her early hits like “Wildest Moments” with the high-fashion, groove-heavy disco revival of her latest chart-topping albums. Jessie Ware delivers a live performance that is both deeply moving and utterly exhilarating. Don’t miss your chance to see one of the UK’s finest vocalists and songwriters live.

See details at [washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388](https://www.washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388)



A



A view of Memorial Circle, where President Donald Trump plans to build his arch. The National Park Service has acknowledged “adverse effects” of the proposed arch on Arlington National Cemetery.

VIRGINIA

State calls halt of consultation on the effects of Trump’s arch ‘indefensible’

BY MICHAEL MARTZ
Richmond Times-Dispatch

Virginia is challenging what it calls the “premature and indefensible” decision by a federal historic preservation advisory council to halt consultation with the state over the harm that a triumphal arch proposed by President Donald Trump would pose to Arlington National Cemetery and surrounding historic resources.

Roger Kirchen, director of the Virginia Department of Historic Resources, said Tuesday that the decision by the Advisory Council on Historic Preservation last week “will silence the voices of the States, consulting parties and the public at a point in the review of the undertaking when the [National Park Service] has barely begun to meaningfully address and consider those views.”

The National Park Service has acknowledged “adverse effects” of the president’s proposed 250-foot-tall triumphal arch on

Arlington National Cemetery as part of a national district that also includes the former home of Confederate Gen. Robert E. Lee and the Memorial Bridge, which directly links the historic site to the Lincoln Memorial across the Potomac River in the District of Columbia.

“It is [the state agency’s] opinion that termination of the consultation after only three months of review of this undertaking is premature and indefensible,” Kirchen said in a three-page letter to Travis Voyles, vice president of the advisory council and previously Virginia secretary of natural resources under then-governor Glenn Youngkin (R).

Voyles abruptly ended consultation with the state and other parties last week because he said further discussion “is unlikely to result in agreement” on a memorandum of agreement that the Park Service had proposed, but both Virginia and the District had rejected.

He recognized “the public’s

significant concerns regarding the adverse effects the undertaking would pose to historic properties” but said alternatives to the Trump administration’s plan to mitigate those effects “would alter the fundamental nature of the proposed undertaking and fail to achieve its goals.”

Trump has insisted on the construction of a triumphal arch that would be taller than the Arc de Triomphe in Paris and has refused to alter its design or move it to a different site. Most recently, he has cited national security justifications for the arch, which he said could serve as a repository for drones and as a base for military snipers.

As proposed, the arch would stand two-and-a-half times taller than the Lincoln Memorial, blocking a view between the memorial and Arlington House, Lee’s former home, that a commission envisioned more than a century ago as a symbolic reconciliation between the North and South after the Civil War. It would also stand at the entrance

to Arlington National Cemetery, where more than 400,000 American military veterans and family members are buried.

Kirchen, in a letter last week that formally rejected the Park Service’s proposed plan, said, “The proposed arch is grossly incompatible with these intentionally designed and reverent landscapes.” Virginia had notified the federal agency earlier last week that it would not sign the proposed agreement.

In his letter to Voyles on Tuesday, the historic resources director said the Trump administration had rushed the review — required under Section 106 of the Historic Preservation Act — but said the state agency “has never indicated that we believe an agreement to resolve adverse effects could not be reached.”

“It is [the state’s] opinion that agreement in the case of this undertaking, due to the significance of the resources and the numerous adverse effects, would take time to negotiate and require that the Federal Agency

uphold their responsibility to consult in good faith and meet their obligations” under federal law and regulation.

Kirchen said the National Park Service had “repeatedly requested comments without arbitrary and unreasonably short time frames” without justification and had compressed the review process without the agreement of the state historic preservation office.

“The process thus far does not reflect a lack of potential for agreement but a lack of consultation in good faith under the current, enacted regulations,” he said.

Kirchen cited the public’s “significant concerns about the adverse effects of this undertaking and its potential to radically change this nationally significant, thoughtfully planned and designed, and solemn commemorative space.”

“We have been advocating for meaningful consideration of the effects to historic properties in Virginia, which we consider to

be some of our Nation’s most sacred and nationally significant memorial spaces,” he said.

Instead, Kirchen said the Trump administration’s rushed review over the state’s objections and “unwillingness to consider any alternatives” has shown that “this consultation has not been conducted with any attempt to seek concurrence.”

“The most prominent design and location was chosen for this monument with no regard for the impacts to memorial spaces that millions of Americans visit for solemn contemplation,” he said. “The rationale for this project’s location is refutable, the refusal to seek a more appropriate location is baseless, and the project’s exigency is manufactured.”

Kirchen called the decision to halt the review “unjustified” but noted that the law allows the council to end consultation “if it determines that further consultation will not be productive.”

Virginia “strongly disagrees that further consultation will not be productive,” he said.

MARYLAND

Tram revival pitch draws pushback in Ocean City

Mayor has made bringing it back a centerpiece of his reelection campaign

BY JOSH DAVIS
Baltimore Sun

Ocean City Mayor Rick Meehan said the City Council “gave up a little too early” in ending the Boardwalk tram’s 60-year run last year. He has now made reviving it a centerpiece of his reelection campaign.

The renewed push follows the August 2024 death of a 2-year-old boy who was struck by a city tram while crossing the Boardwalk tram pad. A police investigation found multiple equipment violations, including brake problems and a Jeep towing more than three times its permitted weight, while raising questions about driver licensing. Ocean City later paid the child’s family \$400,000 to settle all claims.

Except during the pandemic-disrupted 2020 season, the open-air tram ran each summer for six decades along a 2.4-mile route, becoming one of the Boardwalk’s most recognizable and popular traditions.

In October 2025, City Manager Terry McGean announced by email that the trams would not return in their prior form. The item was absent from that evening’s council agenda, and no separate public vote was taken to permanently end the service. Meehan’s campaign adver-

tisement last month declared, “It’s time to bring back the Boardwalk tram.” It incorrectly dates the fatal crash to 2023.

The Sun contacted Meehan and all seven council members. In addition to the mayor, only Council President Matt James and Councilman Will Savage responded, and both council members said the ad surprised them.

Meehan’s stance on the tram marks a shift from last October, when he called state transportation and licensing requirements “unsurmountable” and said the town was “not able to do at this time.” He later added, “The book is open” if a new path emerged.

In an interview Tuesday, Meehan said, “I think the council gave up a little too early.”

He proposed smaller, low-speed electric vehicles — possibly privately operated — to serve riders and Boardwalk businesses.

“I’m saying I think it is doable,” Meehan said. “I think if we really want to do that, I think it’s something we could do.”

The idea was not new. Residents at the Oct. 20, 2025, council meeting and the Ocean City Development Corporation in December urged officials to pursue a smaller, safer replacement, citing mobility needs and customer flow to businesses at both ends of the Boardwalk.

Any replacement, however, would still have to address the legal and regulatory concerns that contributed to the decision to end the previous service. Meehan said one obstacle was

the Boardwalk’s designation as a state roadway, but Maryland Department of Transportation spokesperson Charlie Gischlar disputed that.

“No, it is not,” Gischlar said when asked whether the Boardwalk is a state roadway.

Del. Marc Korman said a consultant raised the designation among several issues affecting the tram. Korman recalled telling Meehan that changing it would be worth discussing if doing so benefited Ocean City, but said their conversation was not limited to restoring the tram.

The renewed push follows the August 2024 death of a boy who was struck by a city tram.

James identified the consultant as LJM & Associates, a global inspection and risk-management firm. Its eight-page report cited seven incidents in 2024 and found the existing tram would “continue to present a risk to public safety.” Without a dedicated lane, “the only acceptable option is to cease operations,” it said.

James said the mayor and council heard the findings and alternatives but gave no direction to pursue them.

“Since the accident, the may-

or and the city council have met nearly 100 times, and not once has Mayor Meehan brought up his desire to bring back the tram service on the boardwalk,” James said.

James said he would welcome a proven safe option but added, “It feels like it’s a bit of a political play when we’re a month out from an election.”

Ocean City lawyer Tom Maronick, who praised Meehan’s Stop Offshore Wind work, warned of legal risk without substantial study and safeguards.

“It’s something that could expose Ocean City to major liability if something were to happen again,” Maronick said. “They know that this has created a dangerous situation, and it obviously can’t go back in the form it was in — and I don’t know that it can ever go back.”

Savage said officials found no fiscally responsible way to restore the tram legally and safely.

“I was actually shocked to see this brought back up as a campaign issue for the Mayor’s race,” Savage told the Sun.

“To date I’m not aware of any new plan the Mayor may have,” he said. “Until I have that information, I consider this political posturing.”

Meehan did not immediately respond to a request for comment on the suggestions by James and Savage that the mayor is bringing up the tram for political purposes before next month’s election.

The Sun requested the full consultant’s report under Maryland’s Public Information Act.

Officials unaware of specific plans for ‘military complex’

ARCH FROM B13

duced legislation to deny funding for planning or construction of the arch at Memorial Circle. Merkley asked senators to immediately pass the measure by unanimous consent, meaning that a single lawmaker could block the bill. The effort was blocked by Sen. Mike Lee (R-Utah), a staunch Trump ally.

“The Trump Arch is a monumentally bad idea, and it is abundantly clear there is no authorization from Congress for this massive arch,” Merkley said in a statement after his bill was blocked.

Preservationists have crit-

icized the administration for moving to terminate a required consultation process with local advocates and pushing forward with plans to build the arch.

Elizabeth Merriitt, deputy general counsel of the National Trust for Historic Preservation, urged Trump officials to set aside a “substantial mitigation fund” that could be used to change or even tear down the project.

“The mitigation fund should be kept available for future demolition of the Arch, and the amount of the fund should be sufficient to cover that cost,” she wrote Tuesday. The letter was shared with The Post.

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MARYLAND

DOJ sues over mask, ID rules for law enforcement

BY TODD KARPOVICH
AND TINASHE CHINGARANDE
Baltimore Sun

The U.S. Department of Justice sued Maryland and two of its largest counties Thursday, challenging state and local laws that restrict all law enforcement officers, including federal agents, from wearing masks, and require them to identify themselves in certain circumstances.

The lawsuit names Maryland Attorney General Anthony G. Brown, the Maryland Police Training and Standards Commission, Prince George's County and Montgomery County. The department contends the laws unconstitutionally interfere with the federal government's authority over its law enforcement officers.

The mask provision was part of legislation that passed the General Assembly during the 2026 legislative session. The measure generally bars law enforcement officers from wearing face coverings while on duty, with exceptions for undercover work and health or religious reasons. Brown's office warned in February that applying the law to federal agents, including ICE officers, could raise constitutional concerns.

The state law took effect Thursday. Prince George's County passed emergency legislation

in April. Montgomery County's ban took effect in May. The Justice Department argues that the supremacy clause of the U.S. Constitution prevents states and local governments

“The Federal Government, not state and local governments, gets to decide which equipment federal officers may or may not wear when performing their official duties.”

Brett A. Shumate,
assistant attorney general in the Justice Department's Civil Division, in a statement

from regulating the federal government. The department also argues that the requirements put federal officers at risk amid what the department describes as an increase in harassment,

doxing and violence against federal law enforcement personnel.

“The Federal Government, not state and local governments, gets to decide which equipment federal officers may or may not wear when performing their official duties,” Assistant Attorney General Brett A. Shumate of the Justice Department's Civil Division said in a statement.

Rhyan Lake, a spokesperson for Gov. Wes Moore, said Maryland “will always defend transparency, accountability, and due process.”

Brown's office did not respond to requests for comment by deadline Thursday. The Maryland Police Training and Standards Commission, Prince George's County and Montgomery County also did not respond to requests for comment.

House Speaker Joseline A. Peña-Melnyk said lawmakers knew a legal challenge was possible and wrote the law to “apply broadly to law enforcement while respecting legitimate safety and operational concerns.”

“We stand behind the values that guided its passage: public safety, accountability and trust between law enforcement and the communities they serve,” she said in a Thursday statement.

Republicans who opposed the ban said the DOJ is likely to succeed.

Senate Minority Whip Justin

Ready said the DOJ's lawsuit is “not a surprise,” adding that he long believed a face mask ban was unenforceable. He argued that the state has “no role in keeping federal agencies accountable” outside of reporting through “proper channels.”

“The General Assembly Democratic leadership should've been cutting people's energy bills and getting to the bottom of the multi-billion dollar audits of the Moore administration instead of pretending state laws have any impact on federal agencies,” he said in a text to the Sun.

The lawsuit is the eighth brought by the Justice Department against a state or local government over laws or policies governing federal law enforcement officers, according to the department. Similar lawsuits have been filed in New York, Virginia, Connecticut, New Jersey and California, as well as against Philadelphia and Milwaukee.

The department said courts have granted preliminary relief in each case that has reached a ruling on mask bans or identification requirements.

Former Attorney General Pamela Bondi directed the Civil Division to identify state and local laws, policies and practices that the department says interfere with federal law enforcement operations.

DEATH NOTICE

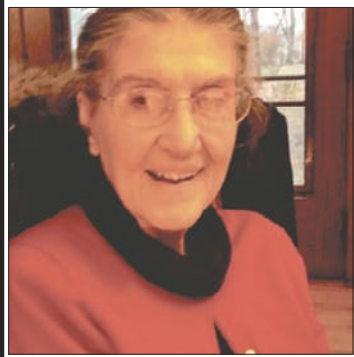
BANKS



YVONNE M. BANKS (Age 91)
Yvonne M. Banks transitioned on September 10, 2026. She is survived by her daughter Orrie, two sons Maurice III, Layard, seven grandchildren and four great-grandchildren. A celebration of life will be held on October 3, 2026, at First Baptist Church of Deanwood, 1008 45th Street, NE, Washington, DC 20019. Visitation from 10:00 am until memorial services at 11:00 am.

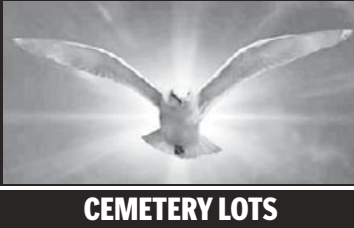
DEATH NOTICE

BROAD



MARY LAVERY BROAD (Age 98)
Mary Lavery Broad died on April 16, 2026 in Bloomington, Illinois. Mary was descended from Irish ancestors including a Belfast scribe and musician, and is survived by five children, four grandchildren, and countless cousins, nieces and nephews. Mary outlived her husband Stu Broad, two sisters, Ann Tyson and Lolly Lawton, and many friends she knew and loved. Mary lived with purpose, devotion, and a sense of adventure. She was devoted to her family, and became an expert in education and training, reflecting her life and legacy as well. Remembering Mary with love, respect, and gratitude, we plan a memorial for her on 10/11/2026 at 1:00 pm at Sidwell Friends Lower School, 5100 Edgemoor Lane, Bethesda, Maryland.





CEMETERY PLOTS
Cemetery plots for sale - National Memorial Park A 1/2 acre, ready-to-plant plot for sale in Falls Church at National Memorial Park for \$4950 or best offer. Call Richard Honaker at 214-532-1420.

DEATH NOTICE

CARROLL



JAMES DOUGLAS CARROLL
"Jim" (Age 102)
Entered peacefully into eternal life on September 27, 2026. He was predeceased by the love of his life, Margaret Weiners Carroll ("Sis") whom he married on September 20, 1947, in St. Mary's Church in Alexandria, VA. After her passing in 2021, Jim longed to be reunited with her in eternal life. He was also predeceased in 2025 by his only son, Daniel Patrick Carroll, whom he missed greatly. His sister Wanda Carroll Davis (Stephen) also predeceased him. Jim leaves his loving daughter Theresa Carroll Daly, devoted son-in-law John Daly, and numerous family members and friends.
He was born in Bluemont, VA, on November 1, 1923, to William Douglas Carroll and Sybil

DEATH NOTICE

Chappell Carroll. They moved the family to Alexandria during the early 1920s, and Jim became a lifelong resident of the city. After his enlisted service in the United States Coast Guard during World War II, Jim began a career with Southern Railway (now Norfolk Southern Corporation) and retired as Assistant to the President in 1985. During the early post-war years in Alexandria, he rowed for Old Dominion Boat Club and became a lifetime member of ODBC. Jim always had a heart for the good, the true, the beautiful. He loved to use his hands to create things and applied his carpentry talents to every room of the family home. He enjoyed gardening, hunting, fishing, and the mountains of Virginia where he spent summers as a young boy with his grandfather. His greatest joy in life was being a loving husband and father who taught his children by example the importance of faith, humility, patience, hard work, generosity, and dedication to excellence. "If something is worth doing, it's worth doing well," he often said. Jim will be greatly missed by all who love him.
The family thanks the team of dedicated caregivers who helped care for him in the last years of his life.
Family will receive visitors at Everly-Wheatley Funeral Home, 1500 W. Braddock Rd., on Monday, October 5, from 4:30 to 7 pm, with Rosary at 6 pm. A Funeral Mass will be celebrated at the Basilica of St. Mary, Alexandria, on Tuesday, October 6, at 10:30 am with interment in St. Mary's Cemetery. The deceased requested that no flowers be sent.
www.everlywheatley.com



Esther Rantzen at Buckingham Palace in London for a reception in 2006.

ESTHER RANTZEN, 86

A British broadcaster and campaigner

BY PAN PYLAS
Associated Press

Esther Rantzen, the British broadcaster and campaigner who became a prominent voice in the recent attempt to get assisted dying legalized in Britain, has died. She was 86.

In a statement, her three children said their “adored mother” died on Wednesday.

“We will always remember her endless capacity for joy, her ability to comfort every heartache, her beautiful way with words and her expert guidance in all things,” her children Miriam, Rebecca and Joshua Wilcox said.

Over the decades, Ms. Rantzen became one of the most respected figures within British media, helping her to establish charities that helped both the young and old.

She was perhaps most famous for fronting the BBC consumer affairs program “That’s Life!” for 21 years from 1973 to 1994. Over the years, the show branched out beyond consumer affairs to investigate life-and-death issues, including an investigation into how a boarding school employed pedophiles and a critique

“We will always remember her endless capacity for joy, her ability to comfort every heartache, her beautiful way with words and her expert guidance in all things.”

Ms. Rantzen's children,
Miriam, Rebecca and Joshua Wilcox

of Britain's lack of organ donors. It could also be lighthearted, blending satire and farce with the more hard-hitting segments.

The program led her to set up Childline in 1986, a helpline for children in danger or distress that was open 24/7 throughout the year. She later launched the Silver Line in 2012, which aimed to tackle loneliness in older people.

“Her legacy of compassion and understanding will live on in her charities Childline and The Silver Line, and through those of us who were lucky enough to love and be loved by her,” her children said.

Ms. Rantzen was appointed a dame in 2015 by Queen Elizabeth II for services to children and older people through Childline and The Silver Line.

In later life, Ms. Rantzen became a strong proponent for assisted dying, after she was diagnosed with stage four lung cancer in 2023. She openly discussed her own plan to “buzz off to Zurich” because assisted dying is legal in Switzerland, and she criticized the “messy and cruel” law in England and Wales that would criminalize loved ones who tried to help in any

endeavor to do so.

In September, ahead of a vote in Parliament where the latest effort to legalize assisted dying was defeated, Ms. Rantzen said it was too late for her to travel, because she had become “too physically fragile to make the journey.”

Tributes poured in for Ms. Rantzen, with particular praise for her campaigning and charitable work.

“Through her decades of campaigning, including founding Childline and the Silver Line, she changed countless lives and gave a voice to people who often went unheard,” British Prime Minister Andy Burnham said. “And I will always admire the characteristic courage and openness with which she spoke about her illness, making us all think about the difficult questions we face at the end of life.”

Ms. Rantzen was married to Desmond Wilcox, a television producer and documentary maker, who died in 2000.

“We are grateful she is finally at rest with her beloved husband, Desmond Wilcox, but we will miss her immeasurably,” her children said. “She was our sunshine.”

The Washington Post

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THE WEATHER

WASHINGTONPOST.COM/WEATHER

Cloudy skies, possible showers

We'll have mostly cloudy skies and a possibility of showers. Temperatures will go up to the high 60s, and some winds can be expected. In the evening, the cloudiness remains and temperatures will drop to the low 60s. It's likely we'll see showers in the early morning.

AccuWeather FORECAST

Today

Shower



67° 61°

REALFEEL®: 70°
CHANCE PRECIP: 55%
WIND: NNE 7-14 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

Sunday

Rain



65° 60°

REALFEEL®: 65°
CHANCE PRECIP: 90%
WIND: ENE 6-12 mph
HUMIDITY: High

Monday

Partly sunny



75° 50°

REALFEEL®: 75°
CHANCE PRECIP: 10%
WIND: NNW 8-16 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

Tuesday

Sunny



66° 48°

REALFEEL®: 69°
CHANCE PRECIP: 5%
WIND: N 6-12 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

Wednesday

Sunny



70° 51°

REALFEEL®: 72°
CHANCE PRECIP: 5%
WIND: SSE 4-8 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

Thursday

Sunny

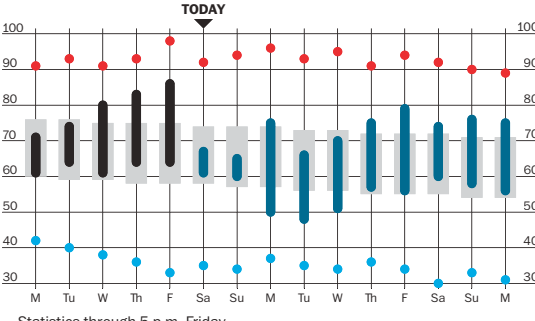


75° 57°

REALFEEL®: 77°
CHANCE PRECIP: 10%
WIND: S 4-8 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

OFFICIAL RECORD

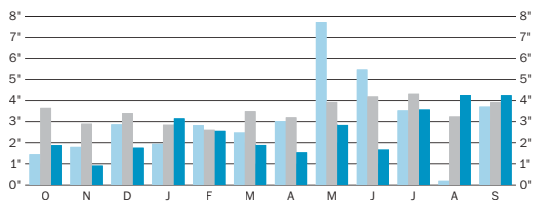
Temperatures



	National	Dulles	BWI
High	86° 4:59 p.m.	89° 4:31 p.m.	88° 2:00 p.m.
Low	64° 7:00 a.m.	60° 7:39 a.m.	62° 7:31 a.m.
Historical Average	75°/58°	73°/51°	74°/52°
Record high	98° 2019	96° 2019	98° 2019
Record low	33° 1899	32° 1997	35° 1997

Difference from 30-yr. avg. (National): this month: +7.9° yr. to date: +0.5°

Precipitation



	National	Dulles	BWI
Past 24 hours	0.00"	0.00"	0.00"
Total this month	0.00"	0.00"	0.00"
Historical Average (month)	0.24"	0.26"	0.27"
Total this year	25.82"	33.20"	29.35"
Historical Average (year)	32.08"	33.42"	34.49"

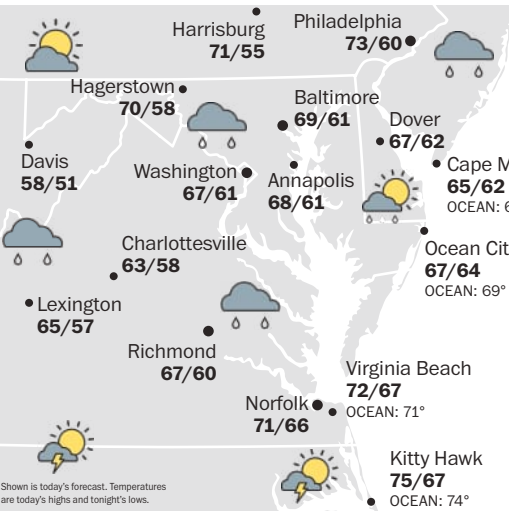
Moon Phases



Solar system

	Rise	Set
Sun	7:06 a.m.	6:48 p.m.
Moon	none	2:52 p.m.
Venus	9:42 a.m.	7:23 p.m.
Mars	1:28 a.m.	3:55 p.m.
Jupiter	2:55 a.m.	4:44 p.m.
Saturn	6:57 p.m.	7:15 a.m.

REGION TODAY



Pollen: Moderate
Observed ratings on 10/2
Grass Low
Trees Moderate
Weeds Low
Mold Moderate

Air Quality: Good
Main pollutant: Particulates

UV: Moderate
4 out of 11*

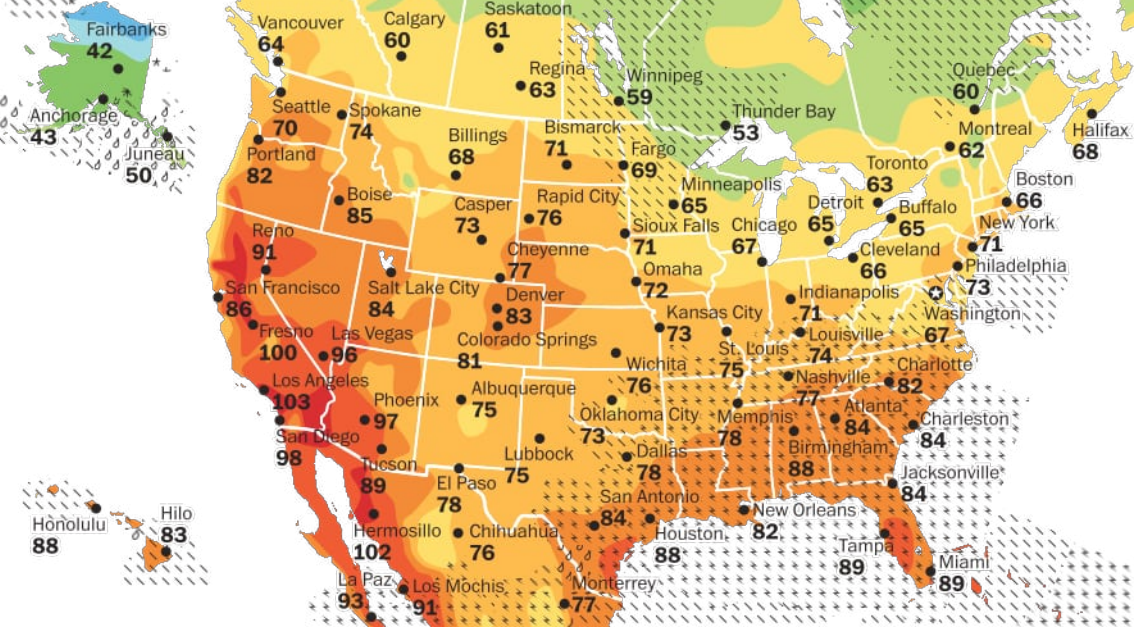
Blue Ridge: Shenandoah National Park: Today, partly sunny, cooler, a couple of showers. High 59. Winds northeast 4-8 mph. Tonight, a shower early, then a little rain. • **Great Smoky Mtns. National Park:** Today, cooler, showers, a heavier thunderstorm. High 65. Winds south-southeast 4-8 mph. Tonight, a thunderstorm, fog late. Low 61.

Atlantic beaches: Ocean City, MD: Today, a little rain in the morning, breezy, cooler. High 67. Winds north-northeast 10-20 mph. • **Virginia Beach:** Today, breezy in the morning, a thunderstorm around in the afternoon, humid. High 72. Winds north 10-20 mph.

Waterways: Upper Potomac River: Today, a little morning rain, cloudy, then partly sunny. Wind north 4-8 knots. Waves under a foot. • Lower Potomac and Chesapeake Bay: Today, a little morning rain, mainly cloudy. Wind north 7-14 knots. Waves 1-2 feet on the Lower Potomac; 2-4 feet on the Chesapeake Bay. • River Stages: The stage at Little Falls will be around 3.00 feet today, falling to 2.80 Sunday. Flood stage at Little Falls is 10 feet.

Today's tides	(Shown are high tides in Bold and low tides.)
Washington	1:09 a.m. 8:59 a.m. 1:59 p.m. 8:47 p.m.
Annapolis	5:53 a.m. 10:37 a.m. 4:58 p.m. none
Ocean City	12:55 a.m. 7:07 a.m. 1:39 p.m. 8:21 p.m.
Norfolk	2:57 a.m. 9:03 a.m. 3:32 p.m. 10:24 p.m.
Point Lookout	2:17 a.m. 6:53 a.m. 12:45 p.m. 8:03 p.m.

NATION TODAY



Yesterday's National
High: Corona, CA 105°
Low: West Yellowstone, MT 27°
For the 48 contiguous states

Yesterday's World
High: Abu Samra, Qatar 111°
Low: Ilirine, Russia 19°
Excludes Antarctica

NATIONAL	Today	Tomorrow
Albany, NY	66/43/s	66/52/pc
Albuquerque	75/56/s	79/53/s
Anchorage	43/37/sh	48/41/r
Atlanta	84/71/t	75/69/r
Austin	84/72/t	84/71/t
Baltimore	69/61/pc	64/58/r
Billings, MT	68/44/s	74/53/s
Birmingham	88/72/t	78/67/r
Bismarck, ND	71/38/pc	67/43/s
Boise	85/55/s	89/58/s
Boston	66/53/s	62/53/c
Buffalo	65/45/s	67/49/s
Burlington, VT	61/41/s	67/53/s
Charleston, SC	84/74/t	82/71/t
Charleston, WV	68/60/pc	69/53/r
Charlotte	82/61/t	68/63/r
Cheyenne, WY	77/45/s	74/51/s
Chicago	67/52/s	71/50/s
Cincinnati	71/52/pc	75/51/s
Cleveland	66/46/s	71/51/s
Dallas	78/70/sh	83/67/c
Denver	83/49/s	81/54/s
Des Moines	69/54/s	68/45/s
Detroit	65/49/s	70/47/s
El Paso	78/59/s	81/59/s
Fairbanks, AK	42/22/s	43/30/c
Fargo, ND	69/42/sh	66/41/pc
Hartford, CT	70/46/pc	65/53/c
Honolulu	88/74/pc	87/75/r
Houston	88/74/t	82/72/t
Indianapolis	71/49/pc	76/50/s
Jackson, MS	87/72/t	80/69/t
Jacksonville, FL	84/74/t	87/74/t
Kansas City, MO	73/55/s	75/47/s
Las Vegas	96/75/t	96/73/s
Little Rock	75/66/t	84/60/pc
Los Angeles	103/77/s	103/75/s
Louisville	74/57/pc	78/55/s
Memphis	78/69/t	82/61/c
Miami	89/80/t	90/78/t
Milwaukee	63/50/s	68/44/c
Minneapolis	65/50/s	65/46/s
Nashville	77/66/t	80/58/c
New Orleans	82/76/t	82/74/t
New York City	71/57/pc	65/58/r
Norfolk	71/66/t	74/66/r
Oklahoma City	73/61/pc	82/56/pc
Omaha	72/53/s	70/46/s
Orlando	89/76/t	91/74/t
Philadelphia	73/60/pc	66/59/r
Phoenix	97/78/s	100/79/s
Pittsburgh	68/54/pc	71/51/s
Portland, ME	67/43/s	61/50/pc
Portland, OR	82/53/s	83/56/s
Raleigh, NC	77/63/t	70/62/r
Reno, NV	91/54/s	88/56/s
Richmond	67/60/t	68/61/r
Sacramento	100/60/s	97/60/pc
St. Louis	75/53/s	79/54/s
St. Thomas, VI	90/80/c	90/80/pc
Salt Lake City	84/58/pc	87/64/pc
San Diego	98/72/s	96/72/s
San Francisco	86/61/pc	83/60/pc
San Juan, PR	90/78/t	90/79/sh
Seattle	70/52/s	73/52/s
Spokane, WA	74/46/s	77/48/s
Syracuse	65/42/s	65/52/s
Tampa	89/77/t	91/76/t
Wichita	76/56/pc	78/52/s
World	Today	Tomorrow
Addis Ababa	77/53/pc	77/53/pc
Amsterdam	67/53/pc	67/52/c
Athens	72/62/c	73/60/pc
Auckland	63/51/pc	61/45/r
Baghdad	91/74/pc	93/76/c
Bangkok	92/79/r	94/80/r
Beijing	74/53/pc	70/47/c
Berlin	67/52/pc	69/48/pc
Bogota	65/48/r	68/48/sh
Brussels	69/52/pc	69/50/s
Buenos Aires	61/52/sh	70/58/pc
Caracas	87/67/pc	85/67/pc
Cairo	79/68/r	79/66/t
Copenhagen	62/52/pc	61/51/pc
Dakar	88/78/t	88/77/t
Dublin	60/46/s	66/60/c
Edinburgh	72/50/r	70/51/pc
Frankfurt	73/57/sh	74/52/sh
Geneva	73/57/sh	74/52/sh
Ham, Bermuda	84/76/s	83/78/s
Helsinki	60/47/pc	59/44/c
Ho Chi Minh City	90/77/t	92/77/r
Hong Kong	86/81/sh	88/77/r
Islamabad	93/71/pc	91/72/s
Istanbul	72/59/pc	71/58/s
Jakarta	79/60/s	78/60/s
Johannesburg	72/51/s	69/51/c
Kabul	84/63/pc	88/61/pc
Kingston, Jam.	89/79/r	93/76/c
Kolkata	94/79/s	96/79/s
Kyiv	64/47/s	66/50/pc
Lagos	85/77/r	84/75/r
Lima	79/71/pc	80/70/s
Lisbon	81/65/pc	82/64/c
London	69/53/pc	70/52/pc
Madrid	70/61/t	74/60/t
Manila	94/80/t	94/80/t
Mexico City	75/57/r	73/58/r
Montreal	62/42/s	65/54/c
Moscow	51/35/c	53/46/c
Mumbai	99/80/s	98/80/s
Nairobi	83/60/s	81/61/pc
New Delhi	97/75/s	97/77/s
Oslo	61/45/sh	60/50/c
Ottawa	61/40/s	61/47/pc
Paris	74/58/pc	70/55/s
Prague	70/44/s	68/48/pc
Rio de Janeiro	71/68/sh	82/74/sh
Riyadh	103/80/s	103/81/pc
Rome	81/60/s	79/58/s
San Salvador	83/69/r	83/69/r
Santiago	69/47/sh	68/50/c
Sarajevo	73/39/pc	75/41/s
Seoul	75/57/pc	79/59/s
Shanghai	70/67/sh	72/65/r
Singapore	92/79/sh	92/79/pc
Stockholm	61/50/c	57/48/pc
Sydney	73/58/t	74/60/s
Taipei City	86/76/r	91/75/r
Tehran	85/66/pc	83/62/s
Tokyo	74/63/s	74/65/pc
Toronto	63/51/s	68/49/pc
Vienna	75/45/s	75/46/s
Warsaw	71/47/pc	68/48/pc

Key: s=sunny, pc=partly cloudy, c=cloudy, r=rain, sh=showers, t=thunderstorms, sf=snow flurries, sn=snow, f=fog
Sources: AccuWeather.com; US Army Centralized Allergen Extract Lab (pollen data); airmow.gov (air quality data); National Weather Service
* AccuWeather's RealFeel Temperature® combines over a dozen factors for an accurate measure of how the conditions really "feel."

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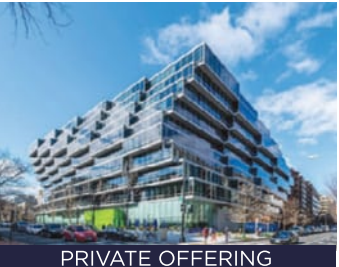
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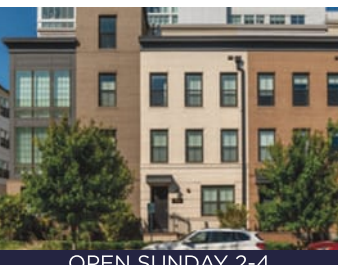
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